

A Study on the Effects of Houghton Mifflin Harcourt's *Journeys* Program: Year 2 Final Report

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Executive Summary

As the basis of written communication, reading and writing are an integral part of a person's life. Developed and mastered, effective reading skills allow for opportunities to learn new information about the world, people, and events. Unfortunately, it has become increasingly apparent that elementary level children are failing to learn to read at a rate that will adequately sustain them if they are to succeed in future academic pursuits or the workforce.

In order to more fully prepare students with the literacy skills they need to become successful readers and writers, Houghton Mifflin Harcourt developed a new elementary reading/language arts program – Journeys (2012). The Journeys program is a comprehensive K-6 literacy program that targets key elements of literacy including reading comprehension, vocabulary, fluency, grammar, writing, and at grades K-2, phonics and phonemic awareness. Aligned to the Common Core State Standards, Journeys contains all the resources needed to integrate the five elements of reading into daily instruction.

To determine the efficacy of the Journeys program, Planning, Research, and Evaluation Services (PRES) Associates, Inc. conducted a two year randomized control trial (RCT). This study, which commenced in the Fall of 2011, was conducted in the K-2nd grades during the 2011-2012 school year, and followed these students into the 1st-3rd grades during the 2012-2013 school year. This report presents the final results for the two year study.

A total of 6 elementary schools participated in the study. The final sample consisted of 700 students who participated in both years of the study (313 control; 387

treatment) in 46 classes (20 control and 26 treatment). Teachers were randomly assigned to conditions prior to the 2011-12 school year (either use of the Journeys program or continued use of the reading/writing curricula currently available at the school).

Major findings, organized by the key evaluation questions, include:

Do reading/language arts skills improve over the course of participating in the Journeys program? Does this vary by different types of students and levels of implementation?

Results showed significant growth overall across both study years as measured by the national, standardized ITBS reading and language arts test. Specifically, students using the Journeys program showed significant growth from Fall 2011 to Spring 2013 on all outcome measures -- thus, student skills in reading comprehension, vocabulary, word analysis, spelling, and language grew notably over the course of the school year. Such findings are consistent with those observed in the first year of the study.

In addition, analyses were performed to examine whether gains were different during the first year of Journeys use (Fall 2011 to Spring 2012) and the second year (Spring 2012 to Spring 2013). Results showed that growth rates were largest in the second year for spelling and language arts and strongest in the first year for word analysis. These findings suggest a cumulative gain of the Journeys program on spelling and language skills, with higher levels of growth observed following two years of exposure to the program as compared to one year of exposure. However, the cumulative gains were not constant across all outcomes as observed on the word analysis subtest.

Furthermore, all subpopulations of students using Journeys showed significant learning gains on multiple reading and language arts subtests as well. Over the course of two years, the Journeys program worked just as well with K-3rd graders, females and males, White and minority students, special education and non-special education students, English Language Learners and non-ELLs, students of varying reading ability levels, students receiving free/reduced lunch and those not receiving such assistance.

Consistent with Year 1 findings, analysis by Journeys implementation level showed that there was a relationship between teacher's level of implementation of the program and learning gains. Specifically, students whose teachers implemented the Journeys program with moderate and/or high fidelity showed the highest levels of gains as compared to teachers who used the program with low levels of fidelity -- as measured by the reading comprehension, vocabulary, word analysis, and language subtests. No significant relationship was observed in spelling, though the trend is also similar.

Do changes in reading performance among Journeys students differ depending on years of usage? That is, did students who used other reading/language arts programs during 2011-12 demonstrate different growth trends than when they used Journeys in 2012-13?

A small subset of students (n=78) changed conditions from the control condition (2011-12) to the treatment condition (2012-13). Analysis of trends in reading/language arts performance over time showed that students experienced accelerated growth in spelling and language arts after they began using the Journeys program during the 2nd year of the study as compared to Year 1. Thus, Journeys

was associated with a positive effect on students following their usage of this program.

Do gains in reading/language arts skills differ between students using Journeys as compared to similar students not using the program?

Comparisons of growth rates over the two year study period between students using Journeys and students using other elementary language arts programs showed that Journeys students significantly outperformed control students on several measures. Specifically, significant positive effects (at the $p < .05$ level) were observed in reading comprehension and vocabulary. Marginally significant positive effects (at the $p < .10$ level) were also observed in spelling and word analysis. Thus, Journeys students demonstrated accelerated learning gains on four out of the five outcome measures analyzed in Year 2. Furthermore, in Year 1, Kindergarten students were administered the Reading Words subtest (note this grade level did not participate in Year 2). Results from these Kindergartners showed a significant effect with Journeys students outperforming control students. As well, in the prior year's report which included a larger sample, Journeys students also showed significant effects on the reading comprehension, vocabulary, and spelling subtests.

The effect sizes obtained can be classified as small to moderate ($d = .15$ to $.39$). While the majority of these can be classified as small effects, it should be noted that such small effects are typical of educational curricular research conducted in real-world applied settings, particularly when comparisons are being made across core curricula covering similar content matter implemented across classrooms following comparable pacing guidelines. These effect

sizes translate to Journeys students performing 7 percentile points higher than the average of control students on vocabulary and comprehension skills, and 6 percentile points higher on spelling and word analysis skills than control students. In addition, during Year 1 in which the Reading Words subtest was administered to Kindergarten students, Journeys students scored 15 percentile points higher than the average of control students.

Do effects of the Journeys program on student performance vary as a function of different student or school level characteristics? That is, do study findings vary across different types of students, at different grade or ability levels, from diverse educational contexts or settings?

Analysis of subgroup differences also showed statistically significant positive effects on reading/language arts performance. In all cases, Journeys students showed greater learning gains than control students from the same subgroup. Significant differences¹ in the overall growth rates from Fall 2011 to Spring 2013 were observed for the following groups:

- Free/reduced lunch eligible (on 2 outcomes)
- Limited English Proficient student (on 2 outcomes)
- Hispanics (on 1 outcome)
- African Americans (on 1 outcome)
- Whites (on 2 outcomes)
- Low reading level (on 1 outcome)
- Average reading level (on 2 outcomes)
- High reading level (on 2 outcomes)
- Third graders (on 3 outcomes)
- Second graders (on 1 outcome)
- 1st graders (on 1 outcome)

¹ At $p < .05$ or $p < .10$ level.

In sum, all significant subgroup differences based on student demographic characteristics found between treatment and control conditions were in favor of the Journeys program (i.e., Journeys students outperformed control students). Moreover, similar patterns of positive effects were observed during the previous 2011-12 school year. The consistency in findings across different outcome measures, study years and student populations combined with the fact that virtually all treatment effects observed were in favor of Journeys lend credence to the conclusion that Journeys is an effective program which positively impacts student reading, spelling, vocabulary and word recognition skills.

Does participation in the Journeys program result in other positive student outcomes (e.g., positive attitudes towards reading, student engagement/interest, etc.)?

While the main focus of the Journeys program is to improve upon reading and language arts skills, other measures were included to explore if Journeys was associated with positive impacts on student and teacher attitudes, and classroom practices. Results showed that Journeys students and teachers felt their program had a positive impact on student vocabulary skills to a greater extent than the control group. Additionally students using the Journeys program reported a greater liking for reading and vocabulary activities than students in the control group. Journeys teachers also reported being more prepared to use small, leveled groups, teach strategies for decoding new words and provide differentiated instruction than control teachers. Furthermore, Journeys teachers reported being more prepared to teach grammar, phonics, and phonemic awareness than control teachers.

Journeys teachers also tended to emphasize phonics, phonemic awareness and vocabulary over the control teachers. Students in treatment classrooms were significantly more likely to engage in Common Core related activities such as spelling and decoding strategies. Indeed, Journeys teachers reported significantly greater assistance with their program in connecting to the Common Core State Standards as compared to control teachers. With respect to differentiated instruction, Journeys teachers also reported that their program provided more assistance with instruction to above average and average students as compared to teachers using other elementary programs.

What do users of Journeys think about the program?

All (100%) teachers reported that they liked the Journeys program and would like to use it again in the upcoming school year. Teachers indicated that the program was user-friendly and included everything they needed to teach reading effectively. A trend was also observed where Journeys students enjoyed their reading/language arts program to a greater extent than students using other programs. Indeed, Journeys students indicated that they liked the reading program, stories read and flash cards used significantly more than control students. As well, 100% of Journeys teachers reported that their students spoke highly of the program and enjoyed it.

Teachers reported that they liked the comprehensiveness of the Journeys program and its focus on multiple target areas (e.g., phonics, phonemic awareness, comprehension, fluency, spelling, writing, and grammar). Furthermore, Journeys teachers reported that the alignment of the program to the Common Core State Standards was a major strength of the

program as it allowed them to meet these standards without taking much planning or preparation time. As well, despite some critiques regarding the Journeys writing component, a few teachers commented that they liked that spelling, grammar and writing components were integrated in the program and the target skills were consistent.

In sum, results from this two-year RCT show that students who use the Journeys program perform significantly better than students using other reading programs in multiple areas of literacy skills. Such positive treatment effects were observed across different outcome measures, subpopulations of students, and study years. This consistency of positive effects in favor of the Journeys program supports the conclusion that the Journeys program has a positive impact on student performance relative to other elementary reading/ language arts programs.

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Project Background

“Putting our current challenges into historical context, it is obvious that if today’s youngsters cannot read with understanding, think about and analyze what they’ve read, and then write clearly and effectively about what they’ve learned and what they think, then they may never be able to do justice to their talents and their potential. Indeed, young people who do not have the ability to transform thoughts, experiences, and ideas into written words are in danger of losing touch with the joy of inquiry, the sense of intellectual curiosity, and the inestimable satisfaction of acquiring wisdom that are the touchstones of humanity. What that means for all of us is that the essential educative transmissions that have been passed along century after century, generation after generation, are in danger of fading away, or even falling silent.”

*–Writing to Read, a report from
Carnegie Corporation of New York.*

In recent years it has become increasingly apparent that elementary level children are not learning to read at a rate that will adequately sustain them if they are to succeed in future academic pursuits or the workforce. The 1999 National Reading Panel Report indicates that early intervention is paramount for students struggling with reading; students who fall behind in the first three years of their schooling may never become fluent readers and will continue to fall behind over the course of their educational career. Results from the most recent National Assessment of Education Progress (2011) indicated that 67% of fourth graders were unable to reach a proficient level in reading, including 33% who could not perform basic reading tasks.

Indeed lack of reading and language arts proficiency hinders more than academic attainment. A deficiency in reading skills produces societal repercussions that go beyond individual successes and ultimately affects the nation as a whole. As a recent study by the American Society for Training and Development concluded, “these forces are creating a human capital deficit that threatens U.S. competitiveness and acts as a barrier to individual opportunities for all Americans.” According to statistics from the National Right to Read Foundation:

- 90 million adults are, at best, functionally literate;
- Adult illiteracy costs taxpayers \$224 billion a year in welfare payments, crime, job incompetence, lost taxes, and remedial education; and
- U.S. companies lose nearly \$40 billion annually because of illiteracy.

With the far-reaching impact of poor literacy rates, it comes as no surprise that there’s been a nearly nationwide push for increased accountability for literacy education. Indeed the majority of states have adopted the Common Core State Standards, which place a significant emphasis on reading and literacy skills.

“Reading proficiently by the end of third grade is a crucial marker in a child’s educational development. Failure to read proficiently is linked to higher rates of school dropout, which suppresses individual earning potential as well as the nation’s competitiveness and general productivity.”

*– A KIDS COUNT Special Report from
the Annie E. Casey Foundation*

These new, rigorous, statewide standards in reading and literacy skills, has increased the necessity to learn “what works” in reading and language arts education.

Accordingly, as educators strive to achieve better results in reading and language arts, there's an increased need for documented, evidence based, research-proven programs that have demonstrated positive impacts on student reading and language arts achievement.

In an effort to determine the efficacy of a new elementary reading program, Planning, Research, and Evaluation Services (PRES Associates²) conducted a two-year randomized control trial (RCT) designed to examine the effectiveness of the Houghton Mifflin Harcourt Journeys program in helping elementary students improve their reading and language arts skills and understanding. *Journeys* is a comprehensive K-6 literacy program that targets key elements of literacy including reading comprehension, vocabulary, fluency, grammar, writing, and at grades K-2, phonics and phonemic awareness. Designed to meet the diverse needs of all students, every lesson allows the student to develop comprehension and fluency by focusing on a target skill and strategy in a relevant short story and non-fiction story companion. The Journeys Student Edition includes vocabulary instruction that takes students through key steps in acquiring, practicing and applying a rich vocabulary. The Journeys program also includes weekly interactive lessons, Leveled Readers by Irene Fountas, Vocabulary Readers and intervention support for struggling readers.

The national two year randomized control trial (RCT), which commenced in the Fall of 2011, was conducted in the K-2nd grades during the 2011-12 school year and followed these students through the 1st – 3rd

² PRES Associates, Inc. is an external, independent, educational research firm with over 20 years of experience in applied educational research and evaluation.

grades in 2012-13. This report presents summative findings from the two-year RCT (2011-13).

Project Overview

The overarching purpose of this study is to rigorously evaluate the effectiveness of the Journeys program in helping elementary students attain critical reading and language arts skills. Specifically, this study is designed to address the following research questions:

- ◆ Do reading/language arts skills improve over the course of participating in the Journeys program? Does this vary by different types of students and levels of implementation?
- ◆ Do changes in reading performance among Journeys students differ depending on years of usage? That is, did students who used other reading/language arts programs during 2011-12 demonstrate different growth trends than when they used Journeys in 2012-13?
- ◆ Do gains in reading/language arts skills differ between students using Journeys as compared to students not using the program?
- ◆ Do effects of the Journeys program on student performance vary as a function of different student characteristics? That is, do study findings vary across different types of students, at different grade or ability levels and from diverse settings?

- ◆ Does participation in the Journeys program result in other positive student outcomes (e.g., positive attitudes towards reading, student engagement/interest, etc.)?
- ◆ What do users of Journeys think about the program? What aspects of the program do they find most useful? Least useful? What, if any, suggestions for program improvement do they have?
- ◆ How do teachers use the Journeys program and how should the program best be used in order to maximize its impact on student performance?

This report presents descriptive information and results of the two year RCT. Specifically, the remainder of this report includes: 1) a description of the design and methodology; 2) sample and site information, including descriptions of Journeys implementation; 3) results of the two year evaluation; and 4) conclusions. In addition, Appendix A contains detailed statistical results of all baseline, attrition and assessment analyses conducted, including the analytical goals and framework employed.

Design & Methodology

Research Design

The present study was designed to address all standards and criteria described in the What Works Clearinghouse (WWC) Study Review Standards (2008) and the Joint Committee on Standards for Educational Evaluation's Program Evaluation Standards (1994). The research design consisted of a two-year randomized

control trial, with random assignment of teachers to a treatment (i.e., use of Journeys) or control group (i.e., use of other elementary reading/language arts program) *within* schools³. Other important design and methodological features include:

- ◆ The study was conducted in the K-2nd grades during the 2011-2012 school year and followed these students through the 1st-3rd grades during the 2012-13 school year.
- ◆ Random assignment occurred at the teacher level. Teachers at all grade levels (K-3rd) were assigned to treatment or control conditions at the beginning of the study.
- ◆ Clear site selection criteria were established along with accompanying rationale.
- ◆ To the extent possible, the control programs to which Journeys was compared were selected to be as distinct as possible given the common content taught.
- ◆ Extensive background data⁴ was collected on instructional activities and materials employed in both

³ There are a number of reasons why random assignment to treatment conditions was done at the teacher level. The most important reason for selecting this level of assignment is that such a design provides an opportunity to help establish *causality* by eliminating the threat that school level factors could have potentially contributed to differences between treatment and control groups. An important issue to be considered with this design option, however, is that procedures must be put into place to ensure that the treatment and control classes are not contaminated through teachers sharing of Journeys materials. Indeed, this was accomplished through stringent guidelines provided to the teachers and close monitoring of their instruction and use of resources by researchers.

⁴ Descriptive information was obtained so that, even if not all extraneous variables related to the outcome measures can be controlled, they can at least be measured and used as covariates in subsequent analyses.

treatment and control conditions so that distinctive pedagogical elements could be described given the common content taught.

- ◆ The threat of differential attrition was addressed via: 1) the initial site selection process⁵; 2) random assignment within schools, at the teacher level, to help ensure that attrition is relatively constant across both treatment and control groups; and 3) the characteristics of students who dropped out were statistically compared between treatment and control groups.
- ◆ Extensive implementation guidelines

and monitoring procedures⁶ were embedded to ensure the fidelity of treatment implementation.

- ◆ A battery of assessments aligned to national reading standards and offering a broad-range of content matter was used in order to enhance the sensitivity of the study to picking up treatment effects.
- ◆ The study employed pre/post measures of, among other things, (1) student performance; (2) school, teacher and reading-related attitudes; (3) teacher practices; and (4) teacher knowledge and characteristics.
- ◆ Student assessments, surveys, and

Table 1. Journeys RCT: Timeline of Activities

YEAR ONE: 2011-12	Aug.	Sept.	Oct.	Nov.	Dec.	Jan.-Feb.	Mar.	April	May	June
Training and Program Implementation Begins	◆	◆								
Follow Up Trainings Occurred			<i>Varied for each site</i>							
Assessments and Surveys Administered		◆	◆						◆	◆
Site Observations			◆	◆				◆	◆	
Teacher Logs*		◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆
YEAR TWO: 2012-13	Aug.	Sept.	Oct.	Nov.	Dec.	Jan.-Feb.	Mar.	April	May	June
Program Implementation Begins	◆	◆								
Follow Up Trainings Occurred			<i>As needed</i>							
Assessments and Surveys Administered		◆	◆						◆	◆
Site Observations				◆			◆	◆	◆	
Teacher Logs*		◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆	◆

*Note that teachers completed monthly teacher logs that monitor instructional activities and the use of program and other resources.

⁵ Sites that historically had more than 20% student attrition were not used in the study.

⁶ Training provided and implementation guidelines reflect how the Journeys program should typically be used in schools.

classroom observation forms are valid and reliable as shown by technical documentation and statistical analyses performed.

- ◆ The study employed the use of statistical controls as well as random assignment to establish initial group equivalence⁷.
- ◆ Analyses of assessment data were primarily conducted via multilevel modeling (MLM) with student and teacher level data to take into account dependency issues. In addition, the teacher level of analysis used in MLM matches the unit of random assignment.

Table 1 displays the timeline for the important study activities during the two years of the RCT. More detailed information on these activities, as well as measures being used are discussed in the following section.

Measures

This section reviews the outcome and assessment measures that were administered, including descriptions of the items, and available reliability and validity information.

Student Assessments: In order to enhance the sensitivity of the RCT to detect any effects associated with the Journeys program, the Iowa Test of Basic Skills (ITBS) – Form C was selected. Assessment selection was based on a thorough literature review of existing assessments to identify tests that were valid, reliable, measured various reading/language arts skills (e.g.,

phonemic awareness, phonics, comprehension, spelling, grammar, etc.), and that included content that reflected important concepts and skills in major reading textbook series, literature, and national reading/language arts standards.

The ITBS is a norm-referenced achievement test composed of tests in several subject areas developed by the faculty and professional staff at Iowa Testing Programs at The University of Iowa. Public and non-public schools participated in a series of pilot studies to standardize test scores and develop the 2000 and 2005 norms.

During Year 1, Kindergarten students were administered the reading comprehension, reading words, word analysis and vocabulary sections of the ITBS Level 6 test. In Years 1 and 2, students in 1st and 2nd grades were administered the vocabulary, word analysis, reading comprehension, spelling and language sections of the ITBS Levels 7 and 8 tests, respectively. During Year 2, 3rd grade students were administered the same subtests but at level 9. Each level of the tests were designed to be developmentally appropriate for young children and are multiple-choice. As well, all tests were untimed and, except for the reading and vocabulary tests at Levels 7 and 8, are read aloud by the teacher. The following describes each of the ITBS subtests that are used as outcomes:

- ◆ **Reading Comprehension (K-3).**
The Reading Comprehension score includes *Reading Sentences*, *Reading Picture Stories* and *Reading Stories*. *Reading sentences* involves a sentence completion task in which students select the most appropriate word out of four options. In *Reading*

⁷ Random assignment helps to create group equivalence. However, it must be noted that with small sample sizes random assignment in and of itself does not assure initial group equivalence (Lipsey, 1990).

Picture Story, students demonstrate reading comprehension by answering multiple choice questions about a picture, and in *Reading Story* students read a brief passage and answer multiple choice questions about the passage.

- ◆ **Reading Words (K).** The Reading Words score measures word recognition and includes *Reading Words*, *Reading Pictures* and *Reading Word Attack*. In *Reading Words*, the teacher says a word aloud and students demonstrate word recognition by selecting the appropriate word. In *Reading Pictures*, the student identifies the word indicated by a picture. In *Word Attack*, students use print, context, and picture cues to identify unfamiliar words.
- ◆ **Word analysis (K-3).** The Word Analysis subtest assesses students' ability to recognize letters and letter-sound relationships.
 - At the kindergarten level, students are asked to identify letters, letter sounds and rhyming words by selecting the appropriate letter, word or picture.
 - At the 1st through 3rd grades, students are asked to identify words, letter sounds, vowel sounds, consonant sounds and rhyming words by selecting the appropriate letter, word, or picture.
- ◆ **Vocabulary (K-3).**
 - At the kindergarten level, the vocabulary subtest measures listening vocabulary. Students hear a word and chose one of three pictorial response options that mean the same thing as the spoken word.

- The vocabulary test in 1st through 3rd grades measures reading vocabulary. Students respond to a pictorial or writing stimulus to identify the appropriate word.

- ◆ **Spelling (1-3).** The teacher reads 3 pairs of words aloud, then reads these words in a sentence. The student identifies which of the three words is spelled incorrectly.
- ◆ **Language (1-3).** The language test assesses students' ability to use the conventions of standard written English. The subtest includes capitalization, punctuation, and skill in usage and expression in writing.

The ITBS has demonstrated reliabilities ranging from .78 to .97 in the Fall. Scale scores, percentile ranks, and grade equivalents are available. However, for all analyses, the standardized scale score was used.

Student Survey: In an effort to examine other potential areas that may be influenced by the Journeys program, a student survey was developed primarily to measure:

- ◆ Attitudes about school (*e.g. I like school.*)
- ◆ Attitudes about reading-related activities (*e.g. I like reading.*)
- ◆ Perceived reading ability (*e.g. I can read well.*)
- ◆ Effort and motivation (*e.g., I try hard in class.*)

The survey also included items on parental knowledge and support, teacher support, classroom experiences, and in the Spring surveys, satisfaction with their reading program. These scales were included in order to obtain measures of the impact of the Journeys program on affective student outcomes and to measure potential variables

that may serve as covariates as needed (e.g., parental support). While some items were created by PRES Associates, others were derived from scales with published reliability and validity⁸. Internal consistency of the scales measuring attitudinal constructs range from .53 to .78. High scores represent a very positive attitude or strong agreement (scales are from 1 to 5 on the 2-3 grade survey and 1 to 3 on the K-1 survey).

Teacher Survey: Information was collected via surveys from all participating teachers. In addition to obtaining teacher background and demographic information, the survey was developed to measure:

- ◆ Classroom and instructional practices
- ◆ Reading/language arts-related preparation and knowledge
- ◆ Teacher knowledge of effective teaching practices (including those aligned to Common Core State Standards)
- ◆ Organizational factors/context
- ◆ Attitudes about reading/language arts curriculum

These measures were obtained to examine affective outcomes as well as to gather background information (e.g., years of experience, education, etc.). Some items

⁸ For the most part, student surveys for elementary children that are reliable and valid are difficult to find. In addition, they tend to be old. Therefore, a subset of items were selected from the entire survey and modified to be consistent with today's language. Survey information can be obtained from the following sources: Hogan, T. P. (1975). *Manual for Administering and Interpreting the Survey of School Attitudes*. New York: Hartcourt Brace; Johnson, O. G. (1976). *Tests and Measurements in Child Development: Handbook II*. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass; Marsh, H. (1990). The structure of academic self-concept: The Marsh-Shavelson model. *Journal of Educational Psychology*, 82, 623-636.

were obtained from existing scales, while others were developed for the study⁹. Internal consistency of the scales measuring attitudinal constructs range from .80 to .91. High scores represent a very positive attitude or strong agreement (scales are from 1 to 5).

Classroom Observations: A classroom observation form was developed to guide observations. This form was largely based on existing protocols that have been used across the nation¹⁰. Modifications were made to reflect content and practices typical of elementary reading/language arts classes, as well as to examine implementation of key components of the Journeys program. Researchers conducting site visits and using classroom observation forms were trained extensively until a high level of agreement was demonstrated among observers on the various quantitative and qualitative items.

Procedures

To ensure that all treatment teachers participating in the study had sufficient knowledge and skills to successfully implement Journeys, teachers were provided with both implementation guidelines and Journeys training prior to implementation in year one of the study. In addition, monitoring procedures (via monthly instructional logs completed by teachers,

⁹ Items in this survey were developed by PRES Associates and modified from the *Trends in International Mathematics and Science Study (TIMSS) 2003 Teacher Questionnaire Science Grade 8* (Washington, DC: National Center For Education Statistics) and the *2000 National Survey of Science and Mathematics Education Science Questionnaire* (Rockville, MD: Westat).

¹⁰ The Classroom Observation Form was derived from the following protocols: Horizon Research's *Local Systematic Change Professional Development Classroom Observation Protocol*, and the *Texas Collaborative for Excellence in Teacher Preparation Classroom Observation Protocol*.

classroom observations and interviews) were instituted to measure the extent to which teachers were implementing a similar instructional model as outlined by the Journeys program implementation guidelines.

The following section presents the procedures used to assist teachers in implementing the Journeys program, the monitoring procedures used by evaluators to determine treatment fidelity, methods used to obtain program feedback, and the test administration and scoring procedures employed.

TRAINING

The training model for the Journeys study was designed to provide teachers with the necessary background and practical experiences to begin implementing the program with fidelity at the start of the 2011-2012 school year and to continue using the program with increased confidence and familiarity through the 2012-2013 school year. It should be noted that the focus of these trainings was not on general reading and language arts professional development, but rather on the vision of the Journeys program, use of the materials and implementation of the key components, and how the program could best be used to effectively help students learn reading and language arts.

Teachers met with a Houghton Mifflin Harcourt professional trainer for approximately 5-6 hours at the start of the 2011-2012 school year. During the training, trainers clearly described the philosophy of the program, provided an overview of all program components and indicated key components teachers were required to use based on the implementation guidelines. The Houghton Mifflin Harcourt professional trainer also assisted teachers in

understanding the daily structure of the Journeys program and specifically addressed how to incorporate key elements into centers and small group activities. A strong emphasis was placed on which components were key and required, versus those that were strongly encouraged or just recommended. Handouts (including the implementation guidelines) were also provided. These included materials lists, and specific instructions on lesson flow for each day of the week. Trainers also modeled a sample lesson for one or two days in order to demonstrate how teachers should fully implement the program (this included lesson flow, related components and language to use).

In addition to the initial in-depth training, one half-day follow-up session was conducted at each site during the 2011-2012 school year, with one exception. Site F declined the half day follow up training as they felt they did not need additional training. The follow-up training sessions were somewhat less formal than the initial training and allowed opportunities for teachers to ask questions and receive additional training on Journeys technology or program components. While the initial training was geared towards ensuring teachers were ready to begin implementing the program with fidelity at the start of the school year, the follow up training allowed teachers to focus on areas and components where, after having used the program for a few months, they still felt they required additional training in order to implement them to the highest degree possible. The follow up training timeline allowed teachers adequate time to discern areas of weakness and to compile questions based on applied implementation (i.e. during the initial training it is feasible that teachers might not know what questions to ask since they have not used the program yet). As well, the

follow up session also allowed teachers the time for additional training on resources that were recommended for use, but not required, since many teachers had become comfortable and proficient using the majority of key components by the time the follow up training occurred. In some cases, during the follow up session trainers observed the teachers using the Journeys program in their treatment classes and then conducted targeted training based on their observations and teacher input.

In year two of the study only School E requested an additional follow up training. This follow up training session took place over two days as the teachers had a limited amount of time available for the training each day. The training was specifically focused on addressing teachers' questions about program components and implementation. As well, the training allowed teachers additional instruction on using the Journeys program digital components. The remaining schools were provided with ongoing support from the publisher during year 2 of the study. Table 2 shows training received by each site during years 1 and 2 of the study.

Table 2. 2011-12 and 2012-13 Training Sessions by Site

	Initial Full Day Training	Half Day Follow-up Training	Yr 2 Follow Up Training
Site A	7/28	9/23	
Site B	7/27	9/23	
Site C	7/26	9/14	
Site D	8/16	12/6	
Site E	8/11	2/28	3/5 & 3/7
Site F	10/11	NA	

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

Journeys teachers were provided with detailed implementation guidelines at the onset of the study in order to ensure they had a concise understanding of the essential program components and an understanding of the foundation of the Journeys program. Teachers that were new to the study in Year 2 were provided with the implementation guidelines at the beginning of the school year. Implementation guidelines were based on key program components and pedagogy as identified by HMH product managers and trainers. The guidelines were developed by PRES Associates with final input and revisions from HMH. These offered detailed direction on how the program should be used in the classroom, as well as what parts of the program were considered key (and required), versus what program elements were considered optional. Given that each Journeys lesson takes one week to complete, teachers were asked to complete whole group reading, small group reading, and language arts activities as outlined below:

A. Whole Group Reading Activities

- ➔ **The Big Idea and Essential Question**
- ➔ **Opening Routines** – This activity is meant as a quick “wake-up” for students. Do daily.
- ➔ **Teacher Read Aloud** - There are typically three skill areas that appear: a) Modeling Fluency, b) Vocabulary, and c) Listening Comprehension—we ask that you instruct/demonstrate at least one skill area.
- ➔ **Words to Know / Vocabulary** – High frequency words/target vocabulary words are identified and repeated throughout the lesson.
- ➔ **Phonemic Awareness (Grades K-2; Letter Naming-K) and/or Phonics**

– These are done 4 days a week (Monday-Thursday).

➔ **Comprehension Skills/Strategies**

➔ **Main Selection Story**

- ◆ **Develop Comprehension** – Throughout the selection, Develop Comprehension questions are numbered.

Teachers should ask all the questions that have a checkmark next to them as these pertain to the Target Skill.

- ◆ **Stop and Think** – (Grades 1-3) This applies the concept taught in the lesson to the selection.

- ◆ **Your Turn** – This section promotes critical thinking skills.

➔ **Fluency**

➔ **Deepen Comprehension**

➔ **Paired Selection / Making Connections.**

➔ **Vocabulary Strategies** – This section helps students develop strategies to learn vocabulary words in the lesson.

B. Small Group Reading Activities

- ➔ **Small Group activities** are an important part of the Journeys program and should occur 5 days of the week. Teachers were free to use the suggested Journeys activities or other Journeys materials, along with small group activities that have worked for your students in the past. However, they were asked to use the **Journeys Leveled Readers** as part of their small groups.

C. Language Arts

- ➔ Language Arts activities occur on Days 1-4 of each lesson. Teachers were asked to complete sections of the **Grammar, Spelling and Writing activities**.

D. Assessments

- ➔ The Journey's program includes many options for student progress monitoring and teachers were free to select any method available from the Journeys program.

- ◆ Teachers were asked to administer the **Unit Benchmark Assessment** (3 times over the course of the year).

For a full description of these key components, please see Appendix C.

PROGRAM MONITORING

Teacher Logs. Online teacher logs were used so that program implementation could be monitored on a real-time basis and to identify any issues or local events that had the potential to influence study results. Teachers were instructed to complete these on a monthly basis from September through May/June of each school year in which they participated in the study. The primary purpose of the teacher logs was to monitor program implementation and fidelity among Journeys classes. Researchers also collected monthly logs from control classes so instructional activities and content covered could be noted and also to monitor the extent to which any contamination may have occurred. Such background information provided researchers with a detailed data source on what was occurring in treatment and control classrooms with respect to reading instruction and practices. It also

allowed researchers to identify areas of overlap in terms of content taught and instructional activities. The extent to which there are similarities and differences between classrooms can have an impact on observed differences between treatment and control classes and effect sizes thus, it is important to take these factors into consideration when interpreting study results. Information obtained via these logs included changes in student rosters, typical classroom activities, use of other print resources and related exercises (including homework and independent practice), time spent on various instructional activities, and for treatment classes, use of key Journeys program components.

Results showed that teachers had, on average, a 96% completion rate in Year 2 and 97% in Year 1. The ranges were 67% to 100%¹¹. Teachers were contacted after failure to complete teacher logs each month. In cases of noncompliance, the school liaison was asked to consult with the teacher to see if there was anything that could be done to assist the teacher in completing the logs and for the most part this was an effective practice and log completion was relatively high with teachers, at most, missing only one log.

Classroom Observation. Classroom observations were conducted for treatment and control classes during Year 1 of the study in the Fall (October-November, 2011) and the Spring (April-May, 2012), and during Year 2 of the study in Fall (November, 2012) and the Spring (March and May, 2013). The purpose of these observations was to better understand the instructional approaches and materials used by teachers with their students and to identify differences and similarities between

classes taught by teachers that were randomly assigned to treatment or control conditions. Specifically, observations focused on how classroom activities were structured, what and how materials were used, and characteristics of the class including student engagement, classroom environment and culture, and teacher-student interactions. In addition, teachers were interviewed after the observations to obtain more specific information on the representativeness of the lesson, resources used, ability levels of the students, assessment practices, pacing, independent practices, test preparation strategies and feedback related to the program. The observations also allowed researchers to examine the extent to which class and teacher level differences could have influenced study results and to examine the threat of possible contamination between treatment and control classes.

TEST/SURVEY ADMINISTRATION AND SCORING

Assessments were administered during four time periods over the course of the study: (1) Fall (September through October 2011); (2) Spring (May through June 2012); (3) Fall (September through October 2012 for new students only)¹²; and (4) Spring (May through June 2013)¹³. For the ITBS, the test publisher's standard testing procedures were followed. Teachers were instructed to contact PRES Associates if they needed additional guidance related to assessment administration. Assessment data

¹¹ Calculation based on 9 months in which teachers were asked to report on their activities.

¹² Administration of Fall Assessments in Year 2 occurred only for those students new to the Journeys study.

¹³ Administration dates depended on the school's start and end date. Teachers within each school followed a similar testing schedule. Generally, administration occurred within 1 month after the school year commenced (pretest) and within 1 month prior to the end of the school year (posttest).

was entered by data entry staff who were blind to assigned treatment conditions.

Student and teacher surveys were completed during the same time periods as the assessments [i.e., Fall 2011/2012 (for new students/teachers only) and Spring 2012/2013].

Site Selection Criteria

Criteria for developing an initial list of schools to be contacted for possible inclusion in the study included geographical diversity across different states, and public schools in urban or suburban areas so that a sufficient number of teachers would be available for purposes of random assignment. Schools meeting the aforementioned criteria were contacted and, of those, 60 indicated initial interest. Of these, 6 met additional criteria for study participation as indicated below and were selected to participate in the research study.

- Schools had to be willing to do teacher level random assignment;
- Historically low student mobility rates (less than 20%) as a means of helping control for the threat of attrition;
- Willingness/commitment to fully participate in all aspects of the study (e.g., random assignment and data collection).

Other major criteria included: 1) that there be no other major reading initiative(s) at the school; and 2) the typical reading/language arts curricula employed by the school fell under the “comparison” programs which provided a contrast to the Journeys program.

Sample Description

Site Characteristics

Six schools participated in the study. Schools were located in urban and suburban areas and were geographically dispersed across the U.S in the states of Arizona, Rhode Island, and Louisiana, and the District of Columbia. A detailed case study of each of the schools is available in Appendix D.

Table 3 on the following page shows the school-wide characteristics of each of the participating sites. As shown, school populations were ethnically diverse, and with the exception of one school, the majority of students were classified as economically disadvantaged. Characteristics specific to the study participants are provided in Table 4.

Table 3. School-Wide Student Demographics

School	School Size	Ethnic Breakdown	% Special Education	% of Limited English Proficient	% Economically Disadvantaged	% by Gender
<i>Site A Arizona Grades K-5</i>	317	46% White, not Hispanic 35% Hispanic 3% American Indian/Alaskan Native 11% Black, not Hispanic 5% Asian/Pacific Islander	NR	7%	57%	49% Male 51% Female
<i>Site B Arizona Grades K-5</i>	315	38% White, not Hispanic 20% Hispanic 7% American Indian/Alaskan Native 34% Black, not Hispanic 1% Asian/Pacific Islander	15%	9%	73%	46% Male 54% Female
<i>Site C Arizona Grades K-5</i>	407	9% White, not Hispanic 86% Hispanic 1% American Indian/Alaskan Native 4% Black, not Hispanic 0% Asian/Pacific Islander	NR	28%	95%	51% Male 49% Female
<i>Site D District of Columbia Grades K-8</i>	531	62% Black, not Hispanic 36% Hispanic 2% Other	17%	38%	87%	49% Male 51% Female
<i>Site E Louisiana Grades K-5</i>	1520	52% White, not Hispanic 39% Black, not Hispanic 5% Asian/Pacific Islander 4% Hispanic 1% American Indian/Alaska Native	NR	NR	31%	49% Male 51% Female
<i>Site F Rhode Island Grades K-2 and 3-5</i>	215 (K-2) 243 (3-5)	33% White, not Hispanic 47% Hispanic 7% American Indian/Alaskan Native 12% Black, not Hispanic <1% Asian/Pacific Islander	NR	NR	84%	51% Male 49% Female
<i>National Population</i>		White-53.5% Hispanic-21.9% African Am.-17.6% Asian/Pacific Islander-5% Native American 1.2% Other 0.5%	13.2%	9.6%	45.4%	Male-50.8% Female-48.0%

Data on National Population was obtained from the U.S. Department of Education, National Center for Education Statistics, Common Core of Data (CCD). Figures represent distributions across all grade levels and reported for 2009. School data obtained from respective State Department of Education websites. NR=Not Reported

Student Characteristics

The final analytical sample consisted of 700 students who participated in both years of the study (313 control; 387 treatment) in 46 classes (20 control and 26 treatment). Students participating in both years of the study were in Kindergarten to 2nd grades in 2011-12 and 1st -

3rd grades in 2012-13. Table 4 presents the demographic distribution among study participants. As shown, the sample was diverse (60% minority), with a range of ability levels. Note that only students who remained in the study throughout *both* school years are included in this table and in the main outcome analyses.

Table 4. Overall Student Demographics Distributions (2011-2013)*

Characteristics		Control (n=313)		Journeys (n=387)		Total (n=700)		National
		Count	Percent	Count	Percent	Count	Percent	Percent
Gender ($\chi^2(1)=2.60$, $p=.11$)	Male	157	51.0%	174	49.0%	331	49.9%	50.8%
	Female	151	49.0%	181	51.0%	332	50.1%	48.0%
Ethnicity ($\chi^2(5)=12.24$, $p=.03$)	White	121	39.3%	146	41.2%	267	40.3%	53.2%
	Hispanic	102	33.1%	84	23.7%	186	28.1%	21.9%
	African American	55	17.9%	94	26.6%	149	22.5%	17.6%
	Other	30	9.7%	30	8.5%	60	9.1%	1.7%
Grade ($\chi^2(2)=1.57$, $p=.46$)	1st	84	26.8%	110	28.4%	194	27.7%	--
	2nd	99	31.6%	144	37.2%	243	34.7%	--
	3rd	130	41.5%	133	34.4%	263	37.6%	--
Subpopulations								
($\chi^2(1)=2.48$, $p=.12$)	Free/Reduced Lunch Status	146	47.6%	185	53.0%	331	50.5%	45.4%
($\chi^2(1)=2.66$, $p=.10$)	Limited English Proficiency	69	22.7%	58	17.0%	127	19.7%	9.6%
($\chi^2(1)=0.58$, $p=.45$)	Special Ed Status	26	8.7%	20	6.0%	46	7.3%	13.2%
($\chi^2(2)=1.39$, $p=.50$)	Low Reading Level	103	32.9%	137	35.4%	240	34.3%	--
	Mid Reading Level	112	35.8%	116	30.0%	228	32.6%	--
	High Reading Level	98	31.3%	134	34.6%	232	33.1%	--

*Counts (and percents) do not include missing information. Ability level was determined by taking the average on the ITBS subtests during pre-testing and categorizing students. Students scoring at the top 33rd percentile were classified as high, students scoring at the bottom 33rd percentile were classified as low, and students scoring at the middle 66th percentile were classified as mid level.

Preliminary analyses¹⁴ were performed to examine whether baseline differences existed as a function of student demographics. Chi-square analyses on the demographic characteristics noted in Table 5 showed one significant difference, $p < .05$ ¹⁵. Specifically, there was a higher proportion of control students who were Hispanic than Journeys students. Conversely, there was a lower proportion of control students who were African American and White than Journeys students.

Differences in baseline reading performance were also examined based on analyses of pretest scores. Student level t-test analyses revealed no significant differences on all the ITBS subtests, $p > .05$, see Table 5. Differences on other student characteristics were also examined. Results showed no significant differences between treatment and control students in self-reported reading and

writing abilities, and school engagement.

Attrition Analysis

Both measurement attrition (i.e., missing data due to students not completing assessments) and dropout attrition (i.e., missing data due to students leaving the study) were examined. Details on the attrition analysis are presented in Technical Appendix A, and are summarized herein. There was an overall dropout attrition of 22.3% (n=233) due to students leaving school or moving from treatment to control classes (or vice versa) over the two year study period. This rate is due in large part to the reorganization that occurred at one participating school district – approximately half of the year 1 study participants could not participate in year 2 as they were transferred to another school that was not participating in the study.

Table 5. Sample Size, Means, Standard Deviations, and t-test (Student Level) Results for Assessments at Pre-testing

Pretest*	Group	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	t	Sig. Level
ITBS Word Analysis	Control	313	139.69	21.16	-0.18	.91
	Journeys	385	139.87	21.04		
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Control	313	142.94	16.31	-0.01	.99
	Journeys	387	142.95	21.23		
ITBS Spelling	Control	238	151.49	16.53	-0.47	.64
	Journeys	296	152.15	15.60		
ITBS Language	Control	231	144.27	13.56	-1.03	.31
	Journeys	284	145.59	15.17		
ITBS Vocabulary	Control	310	140.19	17.79	-1.41	.16
	Journeys	384	142.28	20.55		

¹⁴ All details regarding analyses on baseline and attrition analyses are provided in Technical Appendix A.

¹⁵ “Significant” means that we can be 95% or more confident that the observed differences are real. If the significance level is less than or equal to .05, then the differences are considered statistically significant. If this value is greater than .05, this means that any observed differences are not statistically significant and may be interpreted as inconclusive. However, at times this may be referred to as “marginally significant.” In this case, the criterion is more liberal and means that we can be 90% or more confident that the observed differences are real.

While there was no evidence for differential dropout attrition, there was some evidence for baseline performance differences among those who left the study; however the relationship depended on when dropout occurred. Students who left the study in the 2012-13 school year ($n=79$) tended to have higher literacy than students who participated in both years. In contrast, students who left in the summer of 2012 ($n=154$) had lower literacy scores than students who participated in both years. Furthermore, these differences were consistent between groups and as noted there were no significant interactions between group and dropout status across 10 comparisons. As such, the threat to internal validity is minimized. Additionally, there is no evidence of baseline performance differences for those who changed status between treatment and control conditions and those that remained in the same condition during both years.

Teacher and Class Characteristics

During the first year of the study, there were 44 K-2nd grade teachers (23 treatment and 21 control) who participated in the RCT. During the second year, there were 46 1st – 3rd grade teachers (26 treatment and 20 control) who participated in the study. The following presents descriptive information and baseline analyses for the teachers participating during the 2012-13 school year; this includes 1st and 2nd grade teachers who participated in 2011-12, and 3rd grade study teachers who formally participated in the study during the 2012-13 school year. For information on the teachers participating in 2011-12, the reader is referred to the First Year Final Report.

Results showed that 100% of teachers were female and 77% were Caucasian. In regards to educational background, 65% of teachers held a Bachelor's degree and 35% of teachers held a Master's Degree, primarily in Education or Early Childhood Education. Teacher experience ranged from 1 to 34 years, with the average

number of years taught being 7. No significant differences were observed among treatment and control teachers in terms of these demographic and background variables.

Control and treatment teachers were also very similar in terms of their preparation to teach via “best practices” strategies, according to Common Core State Standards, and important literacy elements such as phonics, vocabulary, comprehension, grammar, etc., and perceptions of barriers placed on their teaching, $p>.05$. However, one difference did emerge in that control teachers reported greater perceptions of control over their teaching than treatment teachers as measured by the pre-survey, $p<.05$

Implementation of various typical activities that occur in elementary classrooms were also analyzed based on information collected from the teacher logs and teacher surveys. Results showed no significant differences between treatment and control classrooms in terms of instructional time spent on reading (whole group and small group), language arts (including writing, grammar and spelling), and in emphasis placed on specific reading areas such as phonics, comprehension, vocabulary, fluency, and phonemic awareness. No differences were observed in the amount of homework assigned (in minutes), percentage of students who turn in homework, provision of differentiated instruction, diversity of student activities, and assessment use, $p>.05$. The only significant difference observed among all the comparisons conducted was in the provision of enrichment activities, with treatment teachers reporting doing this activity to a greater extent than control teachers at baseline, $p<.05$.

In summary, randomization was quite successful in producing equivalent treatment and control groups in terms of student, classroom, and teacher characteristics.

Instructional Curricula

The focus of this study was to examine the effects of an entire core curriculum and as such, it must be compared to other core curricula that teach the same content area. With this in mind, researchers tried, to the extent possible, to select schools to participate in the study that used a control program that differed pedagogically from the intervention under study. For the Journeys RCT, participating schools used seven distinct published reading/language arts programs. However, schools A, B, C and F had some control teachers that used a mixed reading/language arts curricula, drawing upon numerous resources and materials for instruction.

Teachers involved in the study all taught concepts essential to reading and language arts instruction. Depending on the school and grade level, teachers paced their classes according to their program, followed a school or state pacing guide to meet required standards, and/or taught according to student needs. Teachers that used the Journeys program, however, followed the scope and sequence of the Journeys program which is aligned to the Common Core State Standards.

JOURNEYS

Houghton Mifflin Harcourt's Journeys program is a comprehensive reading and language arts program designed for Kindergarten to 6th grade. Aligned to the Common Core State Standards, this program contains all the resources needed to integrate the five elements of reading each day. Organized around six themed units, each unit contains five lessons, each with a daily instructional plan. Lessons contain whole group reading and language arts activities as well as options for small group instruction. Each lesson theme follows an overarching Big Idea and Essential Question that is referenced throughout -- the program encourages teachers to review these

with students in every lesson. Generally, the pacing of the program is about one lesson per week or 5 weeks per unit.

The literature selections in the Journeys program are designed to engage students in a blend of literary genres including fiction, poetry, nonfiction and informational text. The paired selection stories integrate nonfiction and informative text selections consistent with the unit themes. These selections develop skill and appreciation for different types of reading. The literature opportunities are available to students via their student textbook/anthology and a series of leveled readers, developed and leveled by Irene Fountas under the Readers Workshop model of instruction. As well, a series of decodable readers and vocabulary readers are provided for additional reading selections. Leveled trade books are also provided in the 3rd grade in lieu of leveled readers for the last unit of the program.

Language arts instruction includes comprehensive writing and grammar activities that are integrated within the program literature. Weekly writing instruction has students practicing the writing process of pre writing, drafting and revising everyday with writing prompts related to reading selections.

Assessment activities in the Journeys program include a dynamic assessment program with diagnostic, formative, and summative assessment opportunities that inform instruction for every student. Daily progress monitoring with opportunities to monitor student progress and provide corrective feedback is also provided. As well, the Journeys digital site includes teacher planning and management, instruction and student activities.

Specific resources available include:

Student Resources

- Student Edition
- Leveled Reader

Teacher Resources

- Teacher's Edition
- Grab n Go Blackline Masters and Additional Resources
- Decodable Reader Stories
- Vocabulary Reader
- Read Aloud Book (Kinder)
- Big Book (Kinder - 1)
- Interactive Instructional Flip Chart (Kinder)
- Ready Made Work Stations
- Leveled Practice Book
- Vocabulary in Context Cards
- Focus Wall poster
- Progress Monitoring Assessments
- Benchmark Tests and Unit Tests (Grades 1-3)
- Diagnostic Assessment (1-3)
- Comprehensive Literacy Guide
- Language Support Cards
- Student Book Audio Text CD
- Instructional Card Kit (Grades 1-3)

- Reading Tool Kit (1-3)
- ExamView CDROM (1-3)

Digital Resources

- Student & Teacher Edition
- Teacher One-Stop
- Assessment Resources
- Phonemic Awareness/Phonics Activities
- Leveled Readers Online

For a more detailed description of the program's key features and materials, see Appendix C-Implementation Guidelines.

CONTROL CURRICULA

The type of control curricula used by teachers varied between teachers and sites. Table 6 shows the programs used at each of the sites. Some teachers at schools A, B, and C and F did not follow a published program but rather used a mixture of resources and only

Table 6. Primary Control Curricula by Site

	Program 1	Program 2	Program 3	Program 4	Program 5	Program 6	Program 7	Mixture of Resources
Site A: AZ	First & Third Grade (2001 Ed.)	Kindergarten & Second Grade (2004 Ed.)						Kindergarten, Second Grade Third Grade
Site B: AZ	First & Second (Yr 1) Grade (2006 Ed.)	Kindergarten, First Grade (Yr 2) & Second (Yr 2) Grade (2002 Ed.)						Second Grade (Yr 2) Third Grade
Site C: AZ			Kindergarten , Second Grade (2003 Ed.)	Second Grade (2000 Ed.)	First Grade (2003 Ed.)			Kindergarten First Grade (Yr 2) Third Grade
Site D: DC	Kindergarten, First, Second & Third Grade (2003 Ed.)							
Site E: LA						Kindergarten, First, Second & Third Grade (2003 & 2006 Ed.)		
Site F: RI							Third Grade (2000 Ed.)	Kindergarten, First, Second & Third Grade

occasionally supplemented with a textbook for supplemental reading and instructional purposes. The control teachers at schools D and E used primarily one basal program (programs 1 and 6 respectively) across all grade levels.

Most similar to Journeys, control program 1 is a traditional, basal program with a focus on literature, reading comprehension, phonemic awareness/phonics, vocabulary and writing. Control program 1 is organized around themed units and lessons. The program encourages students to read both fiction and non-fiction stories that fit within the unit theme. Each theme includes weekly lesson plans that are structured around a five day school week with a daily emphasis on reading, word work, writing and oral language. Additionally, the weekly lessons plans include an emphasis on cross-curricular activities including social studies, vocabulary, math, science, and technology. Read aloud books, leveled readers, vocabulary readers and a decodable text are provided in addition to the student textbook. This program was used primarily at schools D & B and an older edition was used by first and third grade teachers at school A.

Control program 2 is a phonemic awareness, phonics and spelling program that serves as a prevention program to help reduce reading and spelling failure. Lessons are organized as a 30-minute daily lesson that is integrated into language arts classroom instruction. The lessons focus on sequenced skills that include print knowledge, alphabet awareness, phonological awareness, phonemic awareness, decoding, vocabulary, fluency, and spelling. Additionally, the program emphasizes letter formation and handwriting practice. Control program 2 is recommended to be used in conjunction with a literature-based reading program. At school A and B, teachers used this program to supplement their core reading and language arts instruction.

Control program 3 is a comprehensive language arts program with all elements of

language integrated into spelling, writing and reading lessons. The program emphasizes a students' mastery of subskills to encourage a desire to read both academically and recreationally. The reading lessons are organized by three strands: literary appreciation, text structure and comprehension with an emphasis on writing and author's purpose. Students are viewed as active participants and the built-in observations and assessments allow teachers to tailor instruction around student's individual needs. Control program 3 also emphasizes a memorization of Rules of Pronunciation, Spelling and Language as well as phonograms. Similar to control program 2, this program can be used in conjunction with other literature based reading programs. At school C, where this program was used by the Kindergarten and 2nd grade teachers, they supplemented program 3 with other reading materials (e.g., program 4 below).

Similar to program 1, program 4 is a basal reading/language arts program organized around overall unit themes with 5 day/week daily lesson plans. The program is focused on literature that correlates with the overall unit theme. The literature available includes leveled readers, decodable readers, independent reading and big book (anthology) stories. Each day of the lesson includes daily oral language, word work, reading, and language arts. The lessons also include the development of background knowledge to enhance understanding and appreciation for the literature. This program was used by the 2nd grade control teachers at school C.

Control program 5 is a comprehensive basal reading/language arts program organized around overall themes and daily instructional plans. Similar to control programs 1 and 4, this program emphasizes a variety of literature including fiction, folktales, informational texts, nonfiction, plays and poems. Opportunities for literature include trade books, leveled readers,

student edition anthology stories and take home books. The daily lesson plans emphasize reading skills and strategies, phonics, writing, grammar and spelling. Also similar to control program 4, the lessons include development of background knowledge and reading strategies to enhance reading comprehension. This program was used by the 1st grade control teachers at school C.

Control program 6 is a comprehensive reading program designed to target the needs of beginning readers in the primary grade levels and develop more sophisticated reading skill in the secondary grade levels. Lessons are designed to be used for 90 minutes a day over a period of 5 days. At the primary levels the program includes systematic phonics instruction supported by decodable stories, along with instruction in fluency and comprehension. At the secondary levels the programs core instructional structures target vocabulary development, reading comprehension, fluency, oral language development and writing expression by providing students opportunities for narrative and expository text. Similar to control program 1, 4 and 5, control program 6 encourages a student's appreciation for reading by providing rich literature experiences. It is recommended that students using this program be assessed and grouped according to their level to ensure the receipt of focused instruction. This program was used by the control teachers at school E.

Similar to Control programs 1, 4, and 5 control program 7 is a traditional basal reading program. Organized around themed units with a weekly story and daily plan this program emphasizes independent reading, daily word routines and classroom routines. Opportunities for literature include the lesson story, leveled readers, phonics reader, and the trade book library as well as the titles included in the self-selected reading sections. Daily lesson plans emphasizes reading comprehension, vocabulary,

word study, oral language and writing/grammar. Similar to control programs 1 and 4, lessons require students to access prior knowledge and emphasize reading comprehension and vocabulary development. This program was used by the third grade control teachers at school F.

The control curricula, including resources available, are described in more detail in Appendix E.

COMPARISONS BETWEEN JOURNEYS AND CONTROL PROGRAM CONTENT, COVERAGE AND PRACTICES

With respect to the textbooks and the pedagogical approaches employed by the various reading/language arts curricula, there were some differences between control and Journeys programs. As previously noted, most control teachers used traditional, unit-based, teacher delivered programs as their main control curricula. These basal control materials were similar in their organization around theme based units and lessons, and emphasis on literature. However, there is a notable difference in the primary philosophy behind each program. Specifically, Journeys delivers lessons driven by a Big Idea and Essential Question and the specific skills and activities within the lesson support this larger concept. While control programs 1, 4, 5 and 7 followed a similar organizational structure around a unit theme, these programs did not incorporate an overarching concept. Similarly, lessons within control programs 2, 3 and 6 (School E) contain themes within their lessons, but these themes do not prompt students to think about the big picture. Another notable difference between Journeys and the control curricula is the emphasis of daily small group activities. Neither of the control programs used include lessons plans for small group activities. Furthermore, there is a greater emphasis on writing and grammar within the Journeys program at the early grade levels (K). Another distinction is the

greater cohesiveness between the different elements of the Journeys program (e.g., the writing, reading, vocabulary, and phonics components) as compared to the other basal control programs. As previously noted, Journeys is also aligned to the Common Core State Standards.

In addition to their main reading curricula, schools A, B and C supplemented their reading instruction using targeted language arts programs. Additionally, the second grade teacher at school A used a comprehensive toolkit that provides targeted instruction around fundamental comprehension strategies. School E used a targeted phonics based program that targets phonemic awareness, phonics and oral language development in the primary grades and comprehension and vocabulary in the secondary grades. In contrast to Journeys, these programs did not include student textbooks or anthologies, but rather instruction was teacher delivered and they utilized worksheets, decodable readers and trade books. Furthermore, unlike Journeys, as separate supplemental programs, the activities and targeted skills from these resources were not tied to the main reading selection and activities.

In terms of a typical lesson schedule, lessons in both control and treatment class were relatively consistent with a few exceptions as noted below. Lessons usually started with an opening routine and a homework check. This was followed by a review of the previous day's lesson and the introduction to the new lesson. Comprehension, vocabulary, writing, and spelling typically occurred daily with different skills/strategies targeted each week. Lessons included teacher read alouds, class discussions, collaborative or independent reading, response to reading and word/sentence structure activities. Students would also participate in small group activities or centers; however these occurred in greater frequency in treatment classes. The centers would typically include

independent and/or group reading with leveled readers or trade books, word practice, writing practice, computer games, differentiated instruction with the teacher, and academically orientated games. Both treatment and control teachers reported administering weekly quizzes, typically occurring on Fridays. With regards to homework activities, teachers reported assigning homework Monday through Thursday, and homework activities generally included independent reading and spelling/vocabulary/phonics activities.

In terms of specific instructional activities, there were some significant differences observed. While the teachers reported a similar flow in their lesson schedule over the course of the school year, treatment teachers reported a significantly stronger emphasis on phonics, phonemic awareness, vocabulary, grammar and spelling activities. Additionally treatment teachers were significantly more likely to introduce new vocabulary words, provide an intro/review to reading/writing strategies, read aloud to students and provide modeling. Teachers using the Journeys program were significantly more likely to have their students discuss reading, complete worksheets, read independently, participate in guided reading, re-read the same text, and complete hands on reading/writing activities. With regards to utilizing technology in the classroom, no significant differences were observed, however treatment teachers reported using technology in the classroom to reinforce instruction more than control teachers. These were the only notable differences observed across schools in terms of reading language arts instruction.

Such variations in what are likely program-specific teaching practices are to be expected when teachers are using and adhering to different curricula. Indeed, as previously noted, the Journeys program is distinct from the other programs – for example, its lessons continuously support the “Big Idea” and it

strongly emphasizes daily small groups. As such, comparisons between Journeys and other programs are likely to yield differences in pedagogical practices. Indeed, this is examined in greater detail in the results section.

FIDELITY OF IMPLEMENTATION

Three levels of implementation (low, moderate, and high) were assigned for teachers' implementation of key Journeys program components as noted in the implementation guidelines (see Appendix C). Triangulation of the available information¹⁶ showed that four teachers did not typically follow the implementation guidelines during year 2 with high fidelity. In particular, these teachers tended to skip over important components of day 2-4 activities such as the Your Turn, Fluency, Deepen Comprehension, use of Paired Selections, Leveled Readers and writing activities than the moderate and high implementers. The remaining 85% of treatment teachers implemented the program with adequate fidelity (high and moderate). Note that this is similar to last year's percentage of 87%.

When the average implementation for each of the key components is examined, results show that the majority of teachers tended to implement the Writing, Making Connections, Your Turn, and Paired Selections with less frequency than prescribed, with coverage occurring for approximately 75% of the lessons. Some teachers also conducted small groups 3-4 times per week as opposed to daily. Nevertheless, for the most part, participating treatment teachers did very well in implementing the program as noted in the implementation guidelines.

Appendix F provides a more detailed table describing the extent to which teachers utilized the various Journeys program components. For

¹⁶ Information was analyzed from teacher logs, class observations, and exit interviews.

more information on how teachers implemented the Journeys program in their classrooms, see Appendix D: Case Studies.

Table 7. Level of Journeys Implementation

Level of Journeys Implementation	Completion of Key Program Components
2011-12 Study Year	
High	90% or higher consistent completion of Journeys components= 13 teachers
Moderate	80%-89% consistent completion of Journeys components = 7 teachers
Low	Less than 80% of goals met = 3 teachers
2012-13 Study Year	
High	90% or higher consistent completion of Journeys components= 13 teachers
Moderate	80%-89% consistent completion of Journeys components = 9 teachers
Low	Less than 80% of goals met = 4 teachers

During Year 2, approximately 85% of classrooms were exposed to the key Journeys program components with a moderate to high level of fidelity.

No evidence of contamination was observed between teachers or in classrooms. That is, control teachers did not use any components of the Journeys program with their students. However, there was some movement of students from treatment to control classes (or vice versa) over both school years. While schools were asked, to the extent possible, to try to ensure first year treatment students remained with treatment teachers during the second year, this was not always accomplished due to scheduling conflicts. These students were excluded from the program effect analyses that are subsequently reported.

Through years of research experience, PRES researchers have found that the benefits of random assignment at the teacher level (hence,

controlling for school level factors) *with* careful monitoring of possible contamination, outweighs the risk of contamination. Procedures used to eliminate the threat of contamination included an in-depth study orientation with both treatment and control teachers, site visits made to both treatment and control classrooms to observe what was occurring in classrooms, and monthly teacher logs that monitored practices and materials used across both treatment and control classrooms.

Results

Do reading/language arts skills improve over the course of participating in the Journeys program?

In order to determine whether students who used Journeys showed significant literacy gains over the course of two years, analysis on outcomes were conducted via paired sample t-tests. Similar to last year's findings, results showed significant growth over the two year time period on all reading and language arts related outcomes as measured by the ITBS assessment, $p < .05$. That is, students who were taught with Journeys exhibited significant learning gains from pre (Fall 2011) to post-testing (Spring 2013) on vocabulary, word analysis, reading comprehension, spelling, and language arts. The biggest gains were observed in reading comprehension (36.3 points) followed by vocabulary (35.5 points), language arts (34 points), spelling (28.4 points) and word analysis (27.6 points).

In addition, analyses were performed to examine whether gains were different during the first year of Journeys use (Fall 2011 to Spring 2012) and the second year (Spring 2012 to Spring 2013). Results showed that growth rates were largest in the second year of Journeys usage for spelling and language arts and strongest in the first year for word analysis, $p < .05$. These findings suggest a cumulative gain of the

Journeys program on spelling and language skills, with higher levels of growth observed following two years of exposure to the program as compared to one year of exposure. However, the cumulative gains were not constant across all outcomes as observed on the word analysis subtest.

Figure 1. Pre- and Post ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest Performance of Journey Students

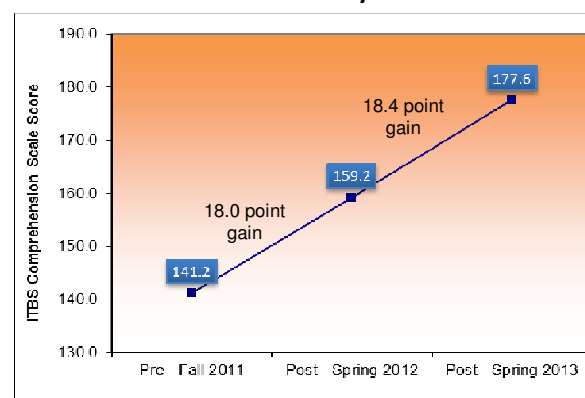


Figure 2. Pre and Post ITBS Vocabulary Subtest Performance of Journey Students

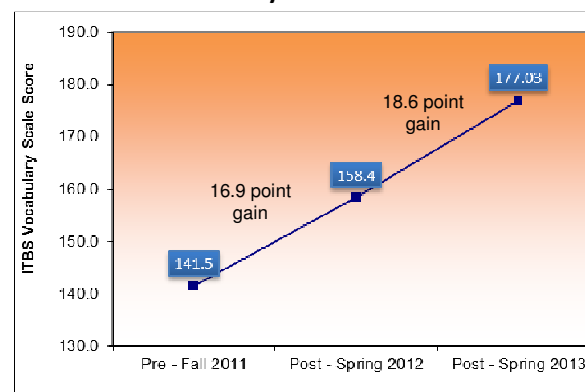


Figure 3. Pre- and Post ITBS Spelling Subtest

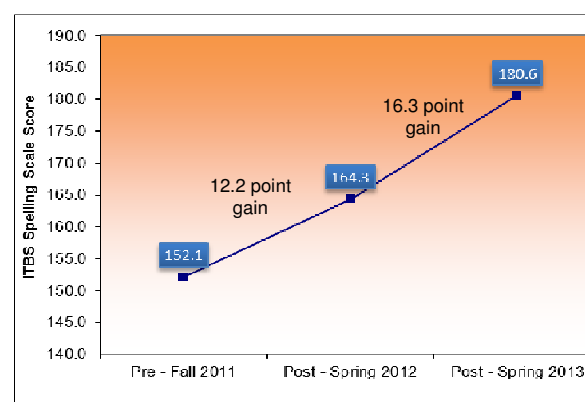


Figure 4. Pre- and Post ITBS Language Subtest Performance of Journey Students

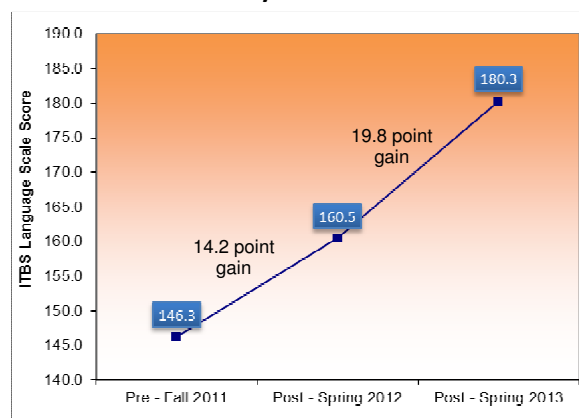
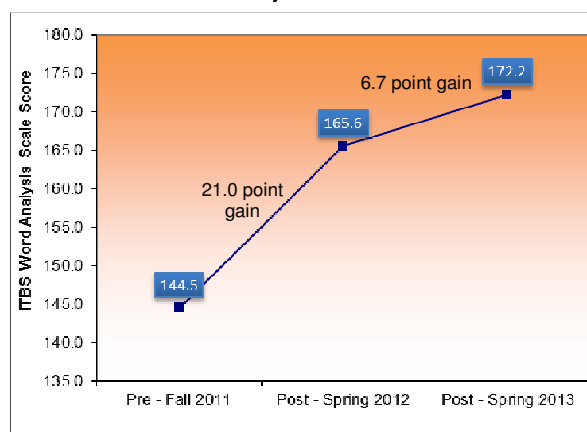


Figure 5. Pre- and Post ITBS Word Analysis Subtest Performance of Journey Students



Journeys students showed significant growth in all measured outcomes. Specifically, gains were observed in reading comprehension, vocabulary, word analysis, spelling and language performance. Furthermore, higher gains were observed in Year 2 for spelling and language skills as compared to Year 1. Conversely, higher gains were observed in Year 1 for word analysis than Year 2.

Do changes in reading/language arts performance among Journeys students vary by different types of students and levels of implementation?

In order to examine whether the Journeys program was associated with improvements among students of various subgroups, exploratory, descriptive analyses were conducted. Only the performance of *treatment* students in specific student populations (i.e. students receiving free/reduced lunch and students not receiving aid, males and females, minority and non-minority students, Limited English Proficient (LEP) students and non-LEPs, special education students and students not in special education, and students of various grade and reading levels) were examined in these analyses. It should be noted that the sample sizes in some of the subgroups are small and there are unequal sample sizes between those in the special populations and those not for a number of variables¹⁷. Therefore, with the caveat that these analyses are limited, this provides readers with preliminary, descriptive information on whether the program is associated with improvements among various subgroups. Figures 6-35 display the results for the various subgroups.

Similar to Year 1 results, findings showed that all students in special populations using Journeys showed significant learning gains on all outcome assessments, with one exception. Special education Journeys students did not show growth in the area of word analysis; however on all other subtests special education students experienced growth. Thus, females and males, minorities and non-minorities, students receiving free/reduced lunch, with Limited English Proficiency, in special education, and at various grade and reading levels showed significant gains in reading and language arts skills, $p < .05$.

¹⁷ The reader is referred to Technical Appendix A for statistics.

Free or Reduced Price Lunch

Figure 6. Journey Students Gains by Free /Reduced Price Lunch: ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

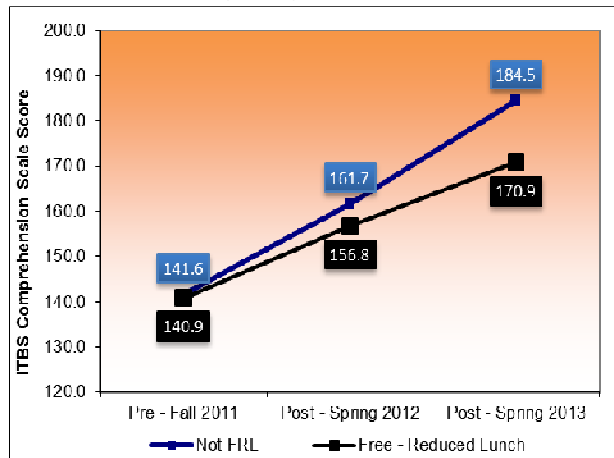


Figure 7. Journey Students Gains by Free/ Reduced Price Lunch: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

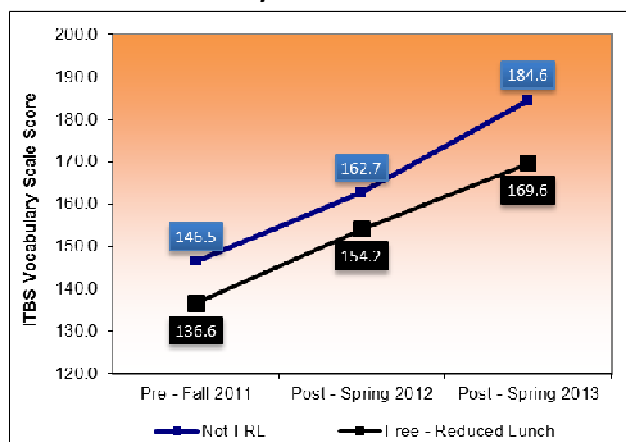


Figure 8. Journey Students Gains by Free/Reduced Price Lunch: ITBS Spelling Subtest

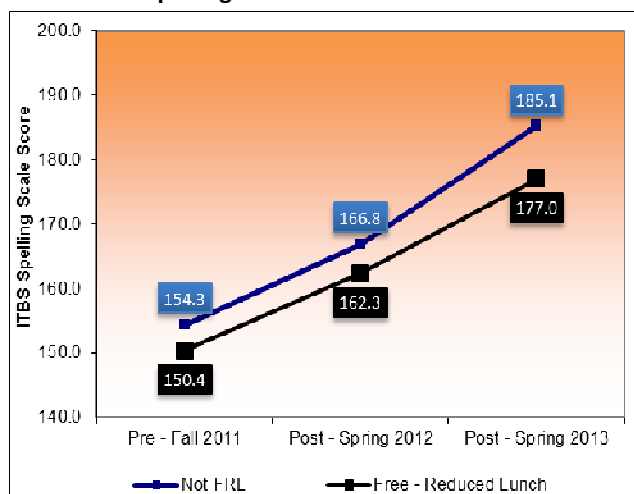


Figure 9. Journey Students Gains by Free/ Reduced Price Lunch: ITBS Language Subtest

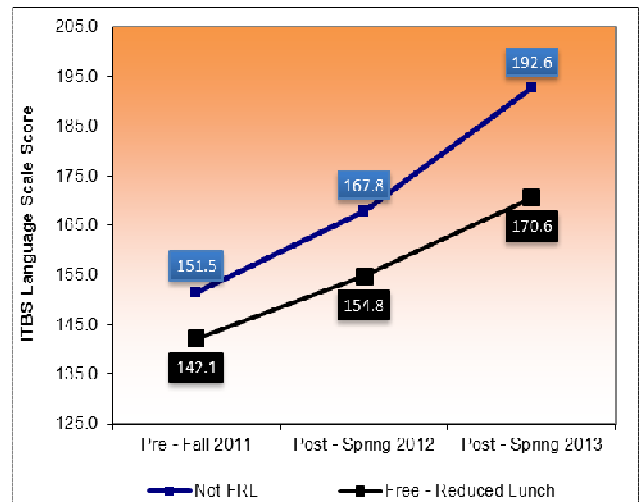
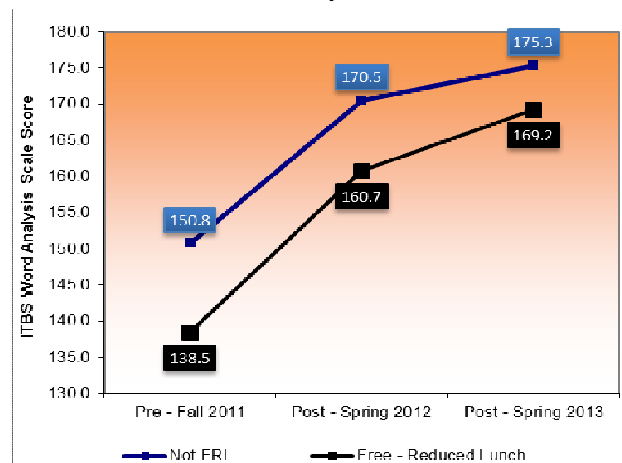


Figure 10. Journey Students Gains by Free /Reduced Price Lunch: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Journeys students receiving free/reduced lunch and those not receiving this aid showed significant gains across all outcome measures.

Gender

Figure 11. Journey Students Performance Gains by Gender: ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

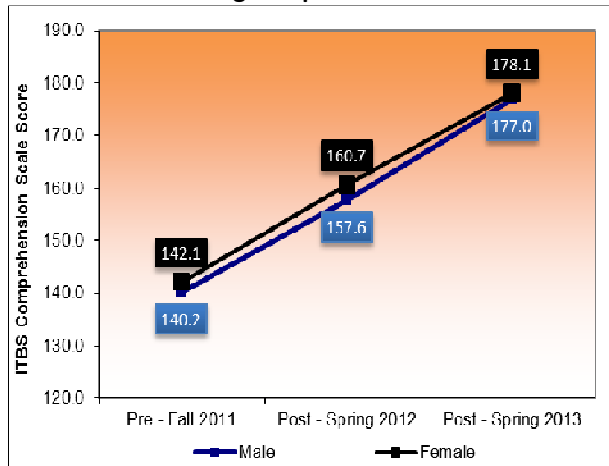


Figure 12. Journey Students Performance Gains by Gender: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

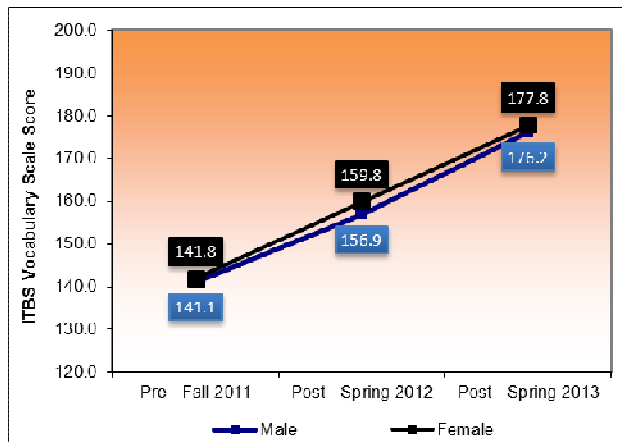


Figure 13. Journey Students Performance Gains by Gender: ITBS Spelling Subtest

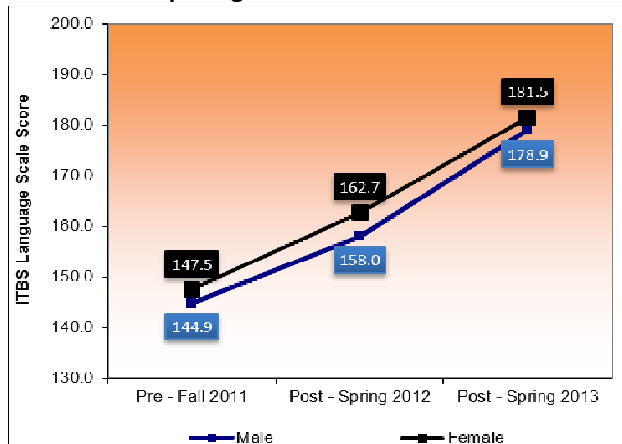


Figure 14. Journey Students Performance Gains by Gender: ITBS Language Subtest

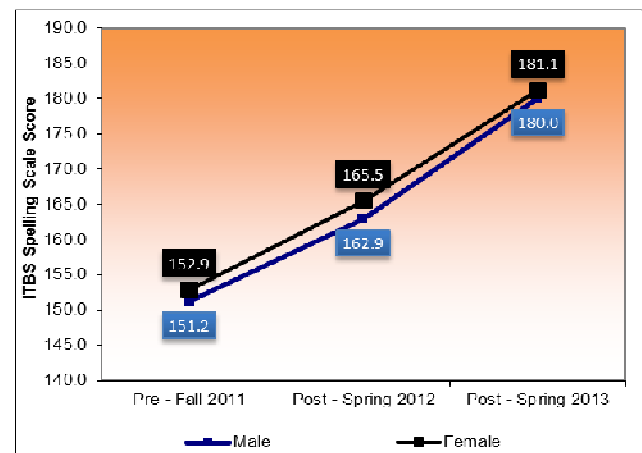
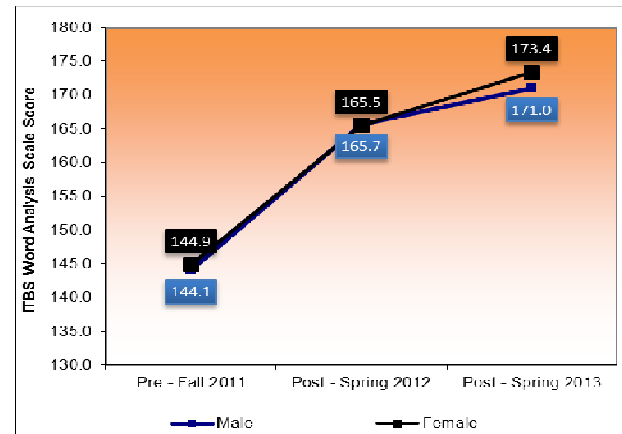


Figure 15. Journey Students Performance Gains by Gender: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Males and females who used the Journeys program also showed significant gains in all literacy measures over the course of both school years.

Race/ Ethnicity

Figure 16. Journey Students Gains by Race/ Ethnicity: ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

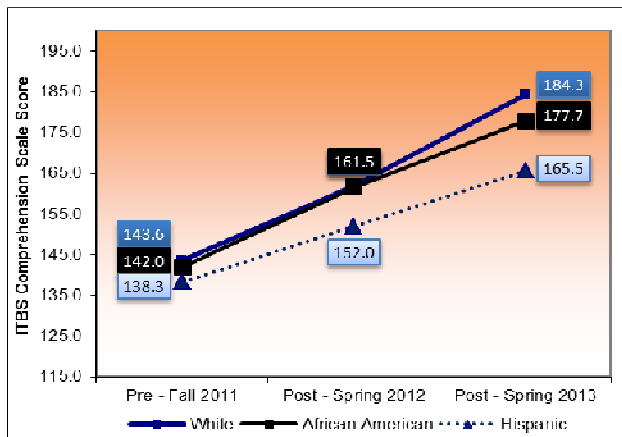


Figure 17. Journey Students Performance Gains by Race/Ethnicity: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

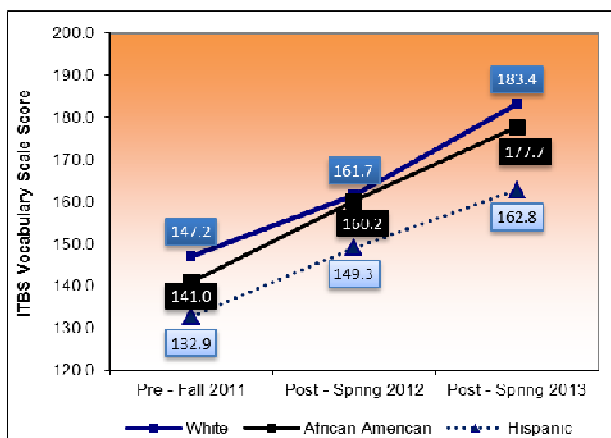


Figure 18. Journey Students Performance Gains by Race/Ethnicity: ITBS Spelling Subtest

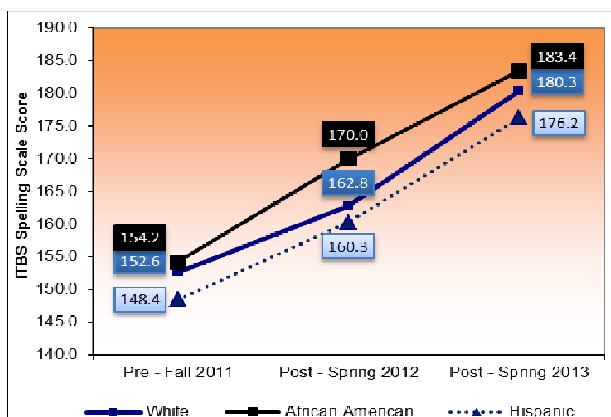


Figure 19. Journey Students Performance Gains by Race/Ethnicity: ITBS Language Subtest

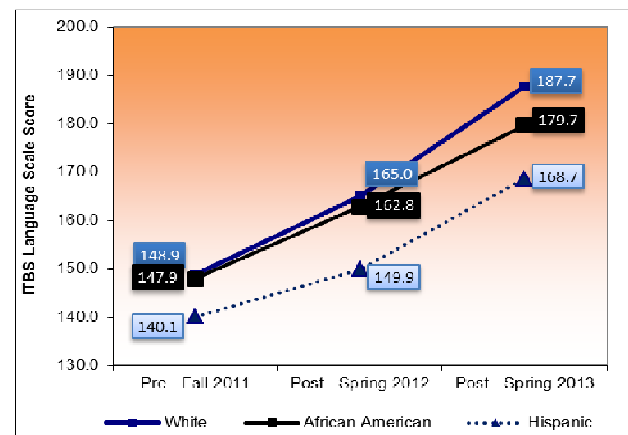
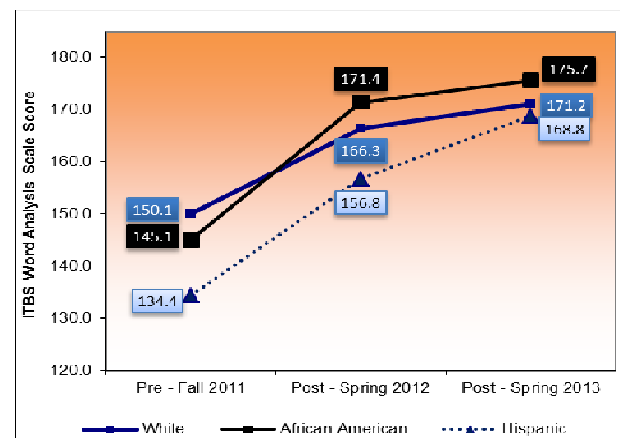


Figure 20. Journey Students Performance Gains by Race/Ethnicity: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Journeys students of all racial/ethnic categories including Whites, African Americans, and Hispanics showed significant literacy gains over the course of the two year study.

Limited English Proficient

Figure 21. Journey Students Performance Gains by Limited English Proficient: ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

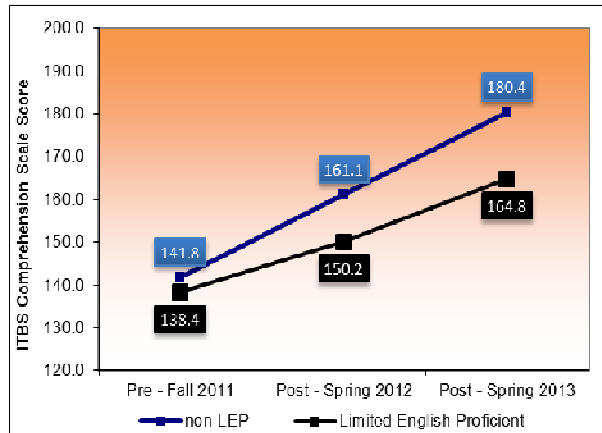


Figure 22. Journey Students Performance Gains by Limited English Proficient: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

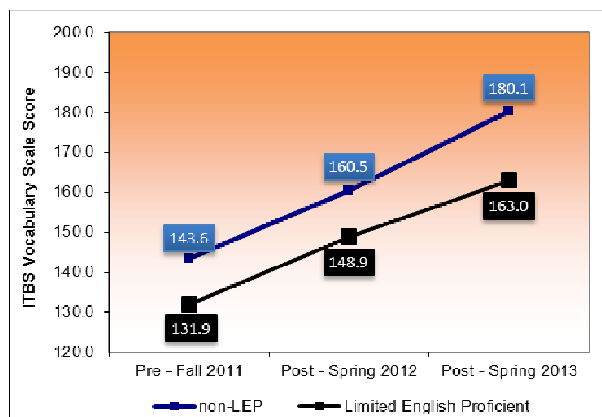


Figure 23. Journey Students Performance Gains by Limited English Proficient: ITBS Spelling Subtest

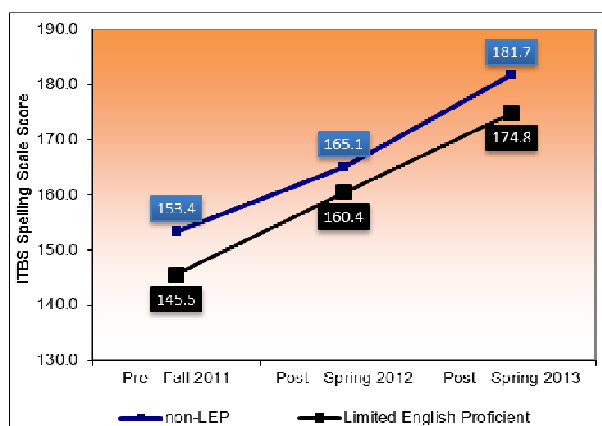


Figure 24. Journey Students Performance Gains by Limited English Proficient: ITBS Language Subtest

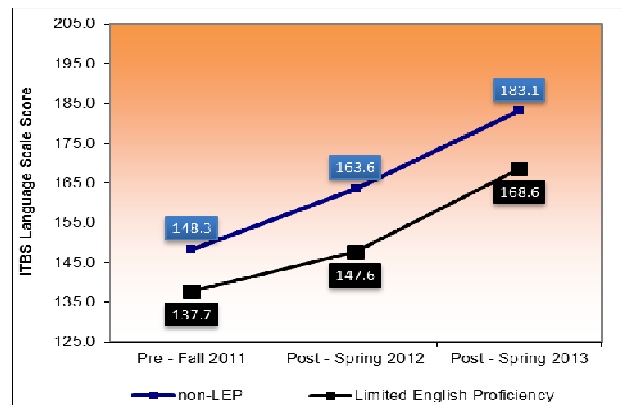
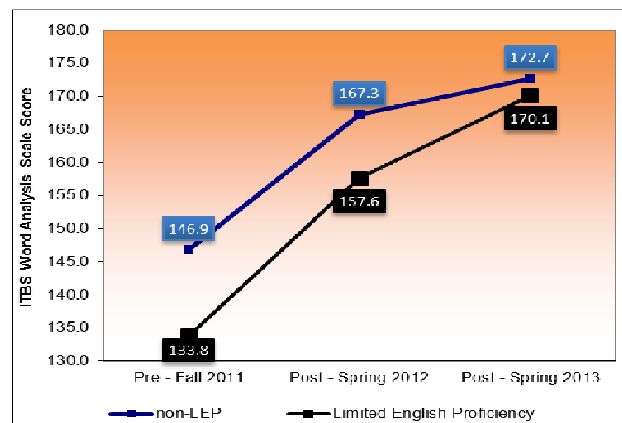


Figure 25. Journey Students Performance Gains by Limited English Proficient: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Journeys students who were of Limited English Proficiency demonstrated significant growth on all measures. Non-LEP students also showed significant gains.

Special Education Status

Figure 26. Journey Students Gains by Individualized Education Plan : ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

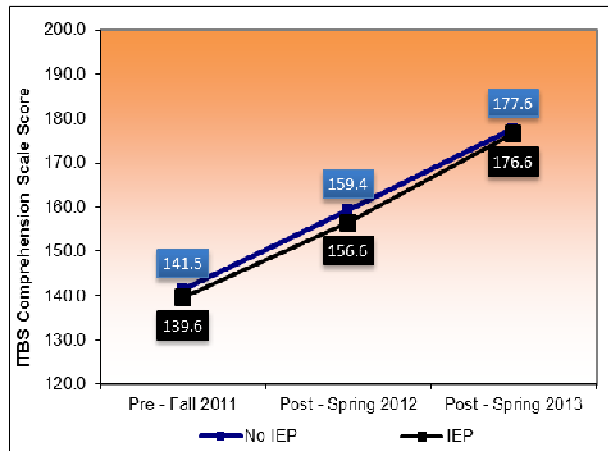


Figure 27. Journey Students Gains by Individualized Education Plan: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

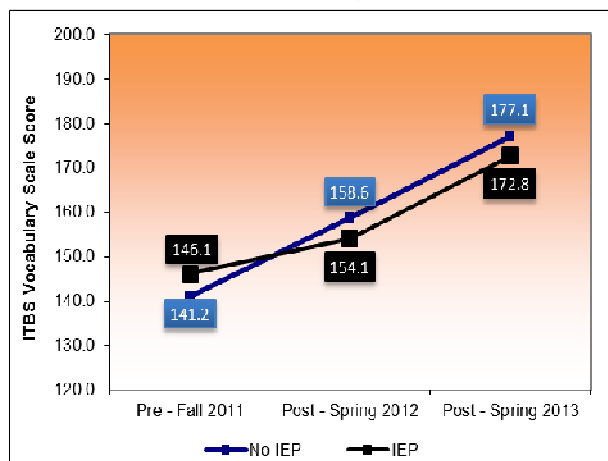


Figure 28. Journey Students Gains by Individualized Education Plan: ITBS Spelling Subtest

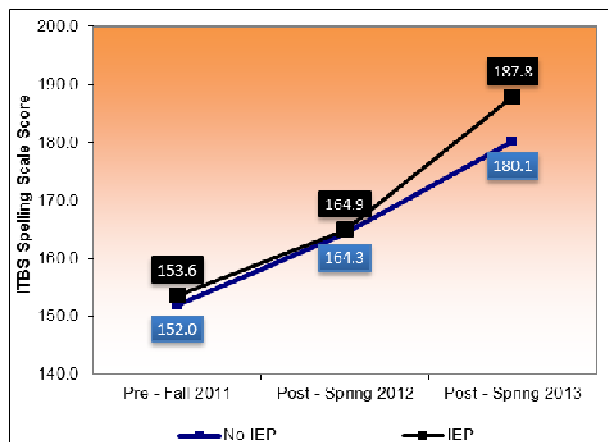


Figure 29. Journey Students Gains by Individualized Education Plan: ITBS Language Subtest

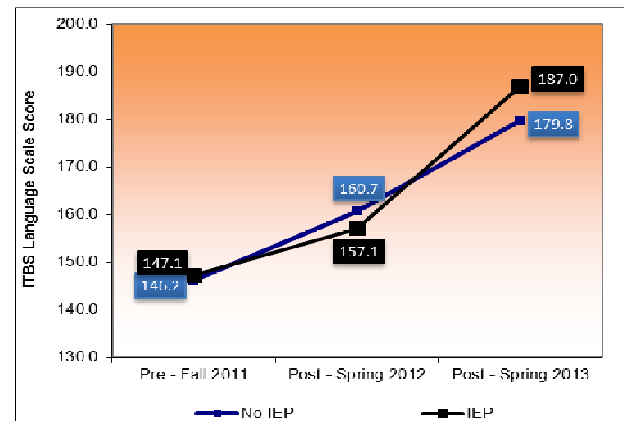
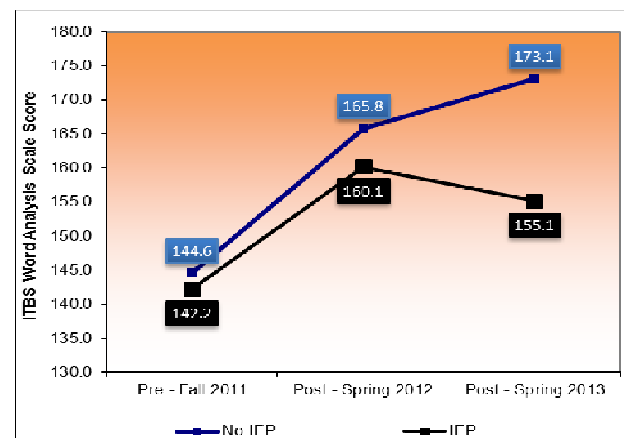


Figure 30. Journey Students Gains by Individualized Education Plan: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Among Journeys special education students, gains were observed for all measures with one exception. Special education students did not show significant gains on the Word Analysis subtest.

Grade Level

Figure 31. Journey Students Performance Gains by Grade Level: ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest

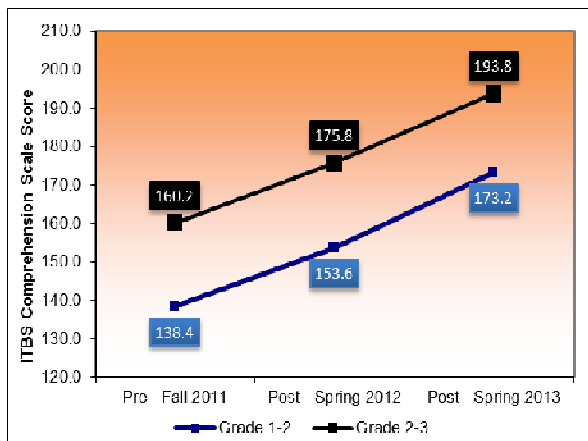


Figure 32. Journey Students Performance Gains by Grade Level: ITBS Vocabulary Subtest

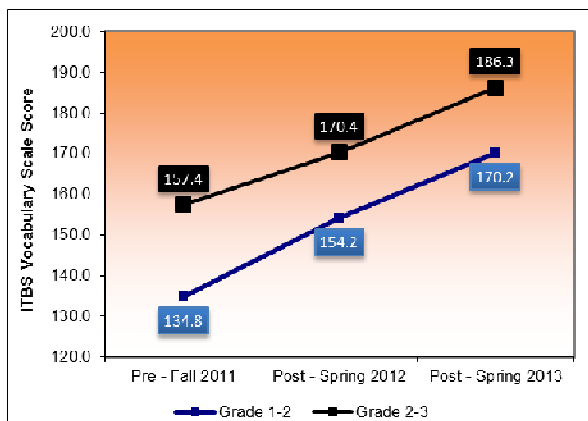


Figure 33. Journey Students Performance Gains by Grade Level: ITBS Spelling Subtest

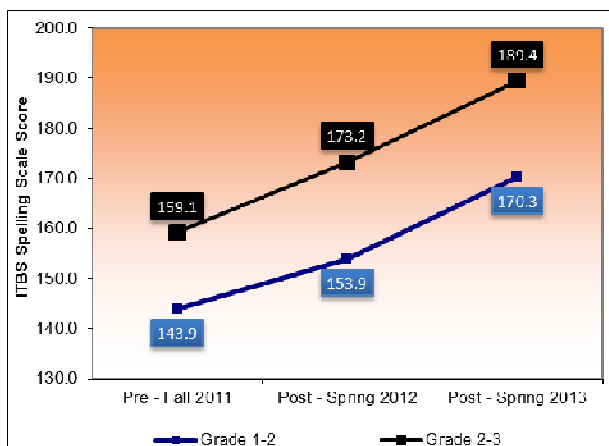


Figure 34. Journey Students Performance Gains by Grade Level: ITBS Language Subtest

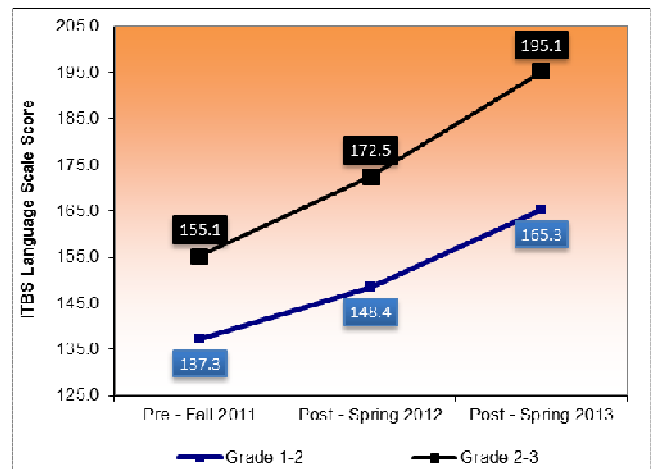
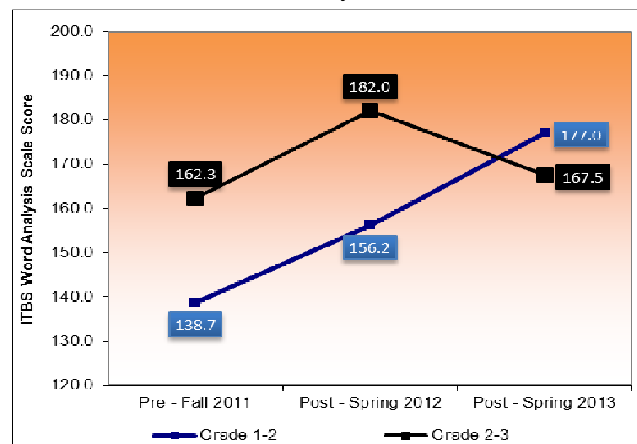


Figure 35. Journey Students Performance Gains by Grade Level: ITBS Word Analysis Subtest



Journeys students at all grade levels (1-3) showed significant learning gains from pre- to post-testing.

READING/LANGUAGE ARTS LEVELS

Performance results from the ITBS subtests administered in Fall 2011 were used to categorize students on initial reading level. The average score was calculated and the 33rd and 66th percentile rank were determined. Students who were at or below the 33rd percentile were classified at a low reading level, students who were at or above the 66th percentile were classified as high, and the remaining students were classified as average. Comparisons were made between the three identified reading levels. Similar to Year 1, results showed that students at all reading levels showed significant growth over both school years.

Figure 36. Pre- and Post ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Reading Level

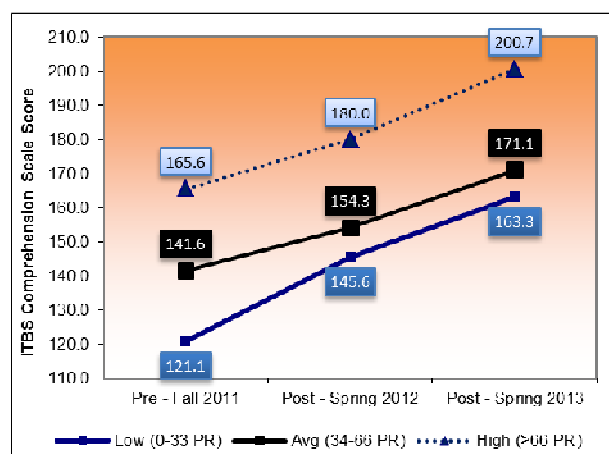


Figure 37. Pre and Post ITBS Vocabulary Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Reading Level

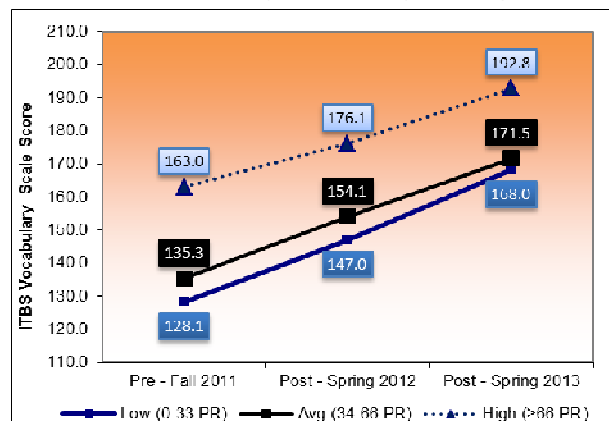


Figure 38. Pre- and Post ITBS Spelling Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Reading Level

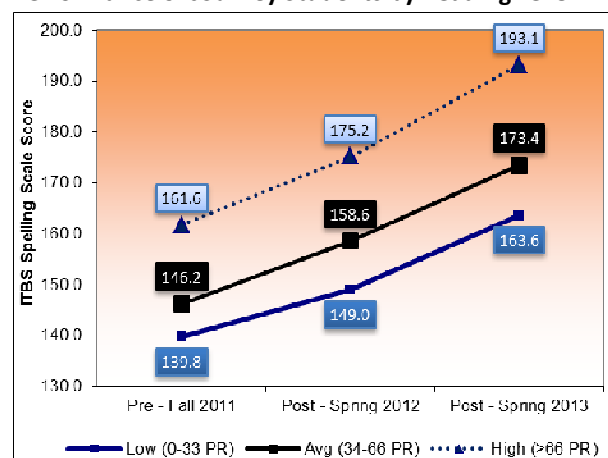


Figure 39. Pre- and Post ITBS Language Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Reading Level

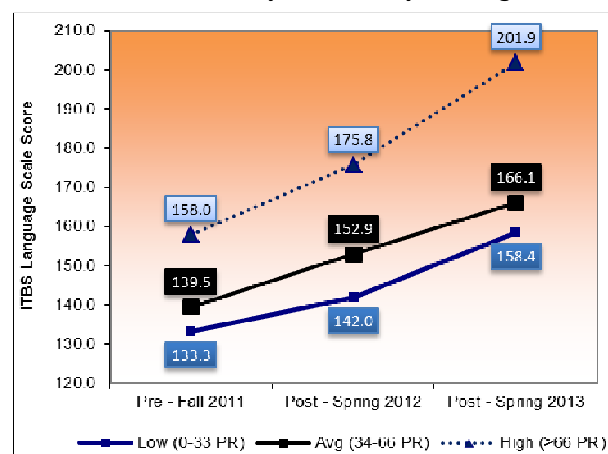
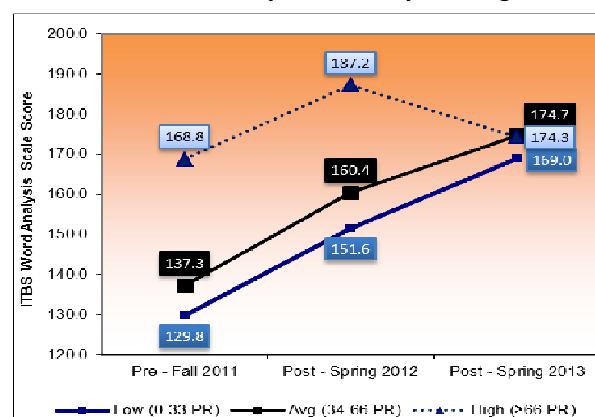


Figure 40. Pre- and Post ITBS Word Analysis Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Reading Level



Journeys students at all reading levels showed significant learning gains on the ITBS subtests.

IMPLEMENTATION LEVELS

In addition to these analyses among subgroups of Journeys students, exploratory analyses on the relationship between overall levels of Journeys implementation of key program components and student performance were conducted. These analyses provide preliminary information on whether low to high implementation fidelity of Journeys¹⁸ components was associated with student performance. Note that sample sizes are uneven, with the majority of treatment teachers being high implementers.

Results showed significant relationships between overall Journeys implementation levels and improved performance on the ITBS subtests, $p < .05$. Specifically, students whose teachers used the Journeys program with high and/or moderate fidelity showed the highest levels of gains as compared to teachers who used the program with low levels of fidelity as measured by the reading comprehension, vocabulary, word analysis, and language subtests, see Figures 41-45. No significant relationship was observed in spelling, though the trend is also similar. These findings are similar to those observed in Year 1 and suggest that when teachers used the program as described within the implementation guidelines (Appendix C), students will show optimal levels of learning gains.

Preliminary analysis showed that teachers implementing the Journeys program with high and moderate fidelity showed greater gains in reading performance as compared to teachers implementing the program with low fidelity.

¹⁸ See section on Fidelity of Implementation for how this categorization was determined.

Figure 41. Pre- and Post ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Implementation Level

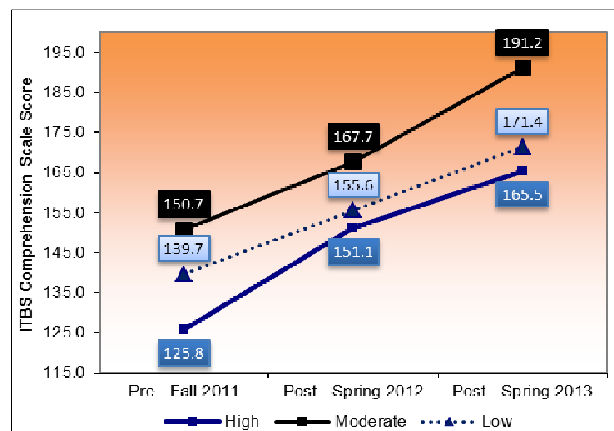


Figure 42. Pre and Post ITBS Vocabulary Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Implementation Level

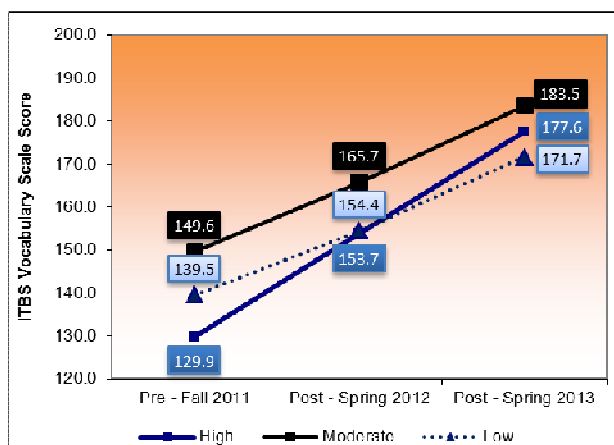


Figure 43. Pre- and Post ITBS Spelling Performance of Journey Students by Implementation Level

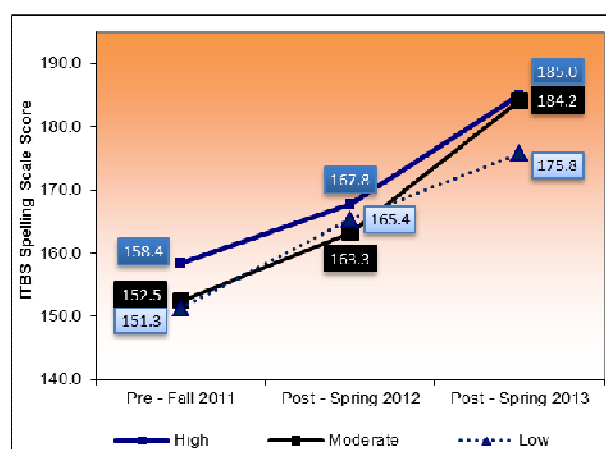


Figure 44. Pre- and Post ITBS Language Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Implementation Level

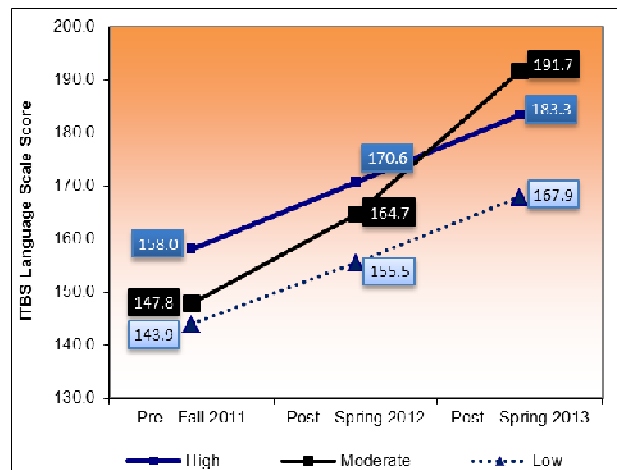
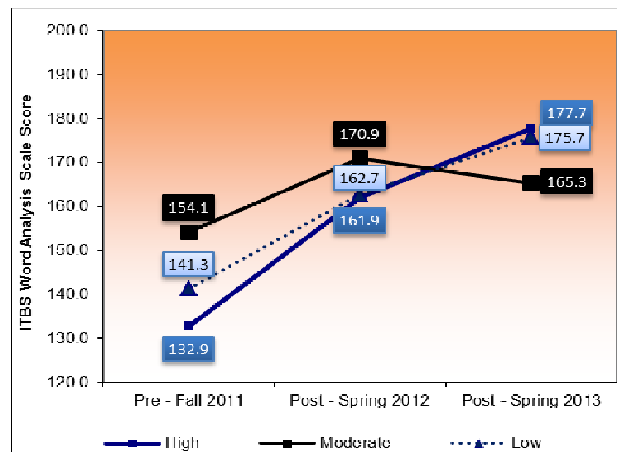


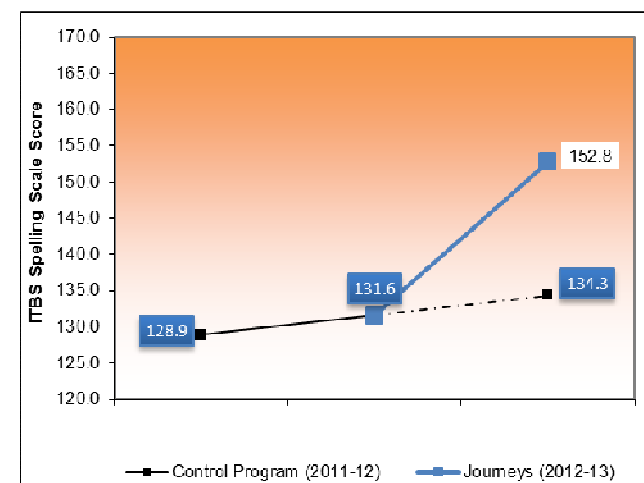
Figure 45. Pre- and Post ITBS Word Analysis Subtest Performance of Journey Students by Implementation Level



Do changes in reading performance among Journeys students differ depending on years of usage? That is, did students who used other reading/ language arts programs during 2011-12 demonstrate different growth trends than when they used Journeys in 2012-13?

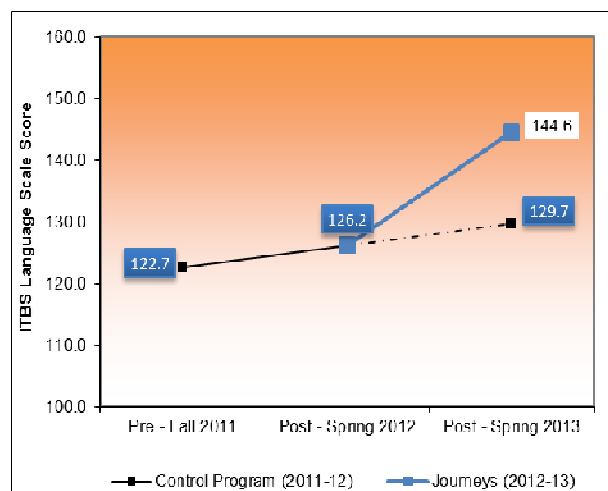
As previously noted, there was small subset of students (n=78) who changed conditions from control during 2011-2012 to Journeys in 2012-13. This allowed researchers to examine if there was a change in growth patterns following usage of the Journeys program. Results showed a significant relationship for two of the five subtests (see Figures 46-47). Specifically, spelling and language arts performance growth was significantly greater following usage of Journeys (in the 2012-13 school year) as compared to their predicted performance had they continued to be exposed to the control programs used during Year 1 of the study.

Figure 46. Students' ITBS Spelling Performance Before and After Students Used Journeys



NOTE: The black dotted line denotes what the students predicted performance would have been had they continued to use control reading programs.

Figure 47. Students' ITBS Language Arts Performance Before and After Students Used Journeys



NOTE: The black dotted line denotes what the students predicted performance would have been had they continued to use control reading programs.

Analysis of changes in reading and language arts skills showed that students who used the Journeys program during the 2012-13 school year (blue portion of lines in graphs) demonstrated accelerated growth in spelling and language arts performance as compared to their performance during the prior school year (2011-12) when they used other control reading programs.

The aforementioned analyses focused on the extent to which Journeys is positively associated with student reading/language arts performance. Results clearly show significant improvements among students overall, and among subgroups of students. However, these analyses do not examine how Journeys students compared to students using other elementary reading/language arts programs. The following section presents analyses of how the reading performance of students taught via Journeys compares to the performance of students using other programs.

Does using Journeys result in increased student achievement as compared to other types of reading/language arts programs?

Prior to discussing the results found, it is important to understand the differences and similarities of the Journeys program and control curricula and classes. This will assist the reader in interpreting the results and effect sizes¹⁹, a measure of the importance of an intervention.

Control and treatment classes generally were exposed to the same content within schools. This is due to teachers following curriculum pacing guides that dictate what content to cover at each grade level. That said, differences existed with respect to the pedagogy employed. Specifically, Journeys delivers lessons driven by a Big Idea and Essential Question and the specific skills and activities within the lesson support this larger concept. While control programs 1, 4, 5 and 7 followed a similar organizational structure around a unit theme, these programs did not incorporate an overarching concept. Similarly, lessons within control programs 2, 3 and 6 contain themes within their lessons, but these themes do not prompt students to think about the big picture. Other notable differences between Journeys and the control curricula include: a) the emphasis of daily small group activities in Journeys, b) the greater cohesiveness between the different elements of the Journeys program (e.g., the writing, reading, vocabulary, and phonics components), and c) the embedded alignment of the Journeys program to the Common Core State Standards.

¹⁹ Effect size (ES) is commonly used as a measure of the magnitude of an effect of an intervention relative to a comparison group. It provides a measure of the relative position of one group to another. For example, with a moderate effect size of $d=.5$, we expect that about 69% of cases in Group 2 are above the mean of Group 1, whereas for a small effect of $d=.2$ this figure would be 58% and for a large effect of $d=.8$ this would be 79%.

In terms of specific instructional activities, there were some few differences between the groups in terms of how the lessons were structured or delivered. While the teachers reported a similar flow in their lesson schedule, treatment teachers reported a significantly stronger emphasis on phonics, phonemic awareness, vocabulary, grammar and spelling activities. Other differences existed in teaching practices which were likely driven by the curriculum used (e.g., more use of small groups in treatment classes).

Given this information and the fact that the duration of the study and exposure to the program occurred during two school years, small to medium effect sizes, if any, were expected. Expanding the study over the course of two school years allowed for year 2 teachers to become better accustomed to the Journeys program and therefore, to be more familiar with the program, thereby reducing the learning curve experienced by teachers using a new curriculum during the first year. Thus, it was hoped that treatment and control teachers would be much more comparable in terms of experience and comfort in using their assigned curriculum.

RESULTS

Multilevel modeling was conducted to examine whether there were significant differences in growth of reading and language arts related skills between Journeys and control students. That is, the three level models examine *changes* in outcomes between the pre and post-testing.

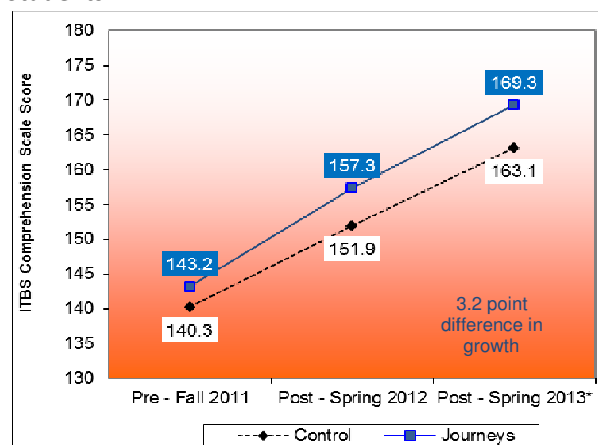
Results from students who participated in both years of the study²⁰ showed four significant differences between students who used the Journeys program and students using other reading/language arts programs. Specifically, statistically significant differences were

²⁰ Students who changed conditions were excluded.

observed in the areas of reading comprehension and vocabulary, $p < .05$, and marginally significant differences were observed in spelling and word analysis, $p < .10$. In all cases, Journeys students outperformed control students—thus a positive impact was observed, see Figures 48-51. No significant differences were observed on the language arts subtest.

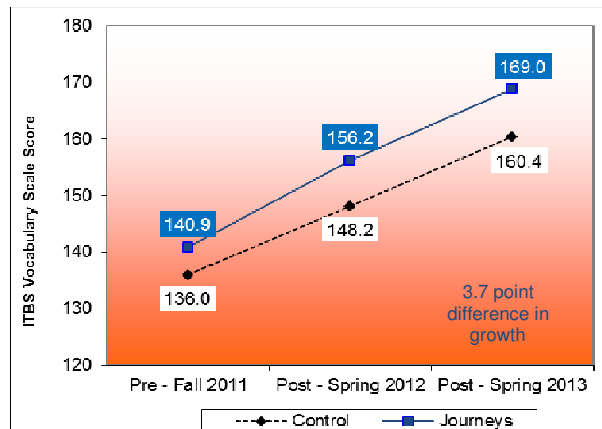
In Year 1, Kindergarten students were administered the Reading Words subtest (this grade level did not participate in Year 2). Results from these Kindergartners showed a significant effect with Journeys students outperforming control students, see Figure 52. Note that in the prior year's report which included a larger sample, Journeys students also showed significant effects on the reading comprehension, vocabulary, and spelling subtests but not word analysis. In sum, Journeys students showed accelerated learning gains on the ITBS assessments as compared to control students.

Figure 48. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students



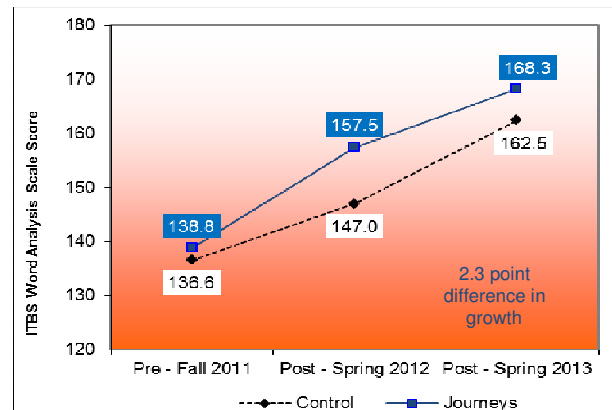
- ◆ Students who used the Journeys program showed significantly greater reading comprehension gains over the course of the two school years as compared to control students. Journeys students grew by 26 points whereas control students grew by 22.8 points (3.2 point significant difference).

Figure 49. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Vocabulary Subtest of Journeys and Control Students



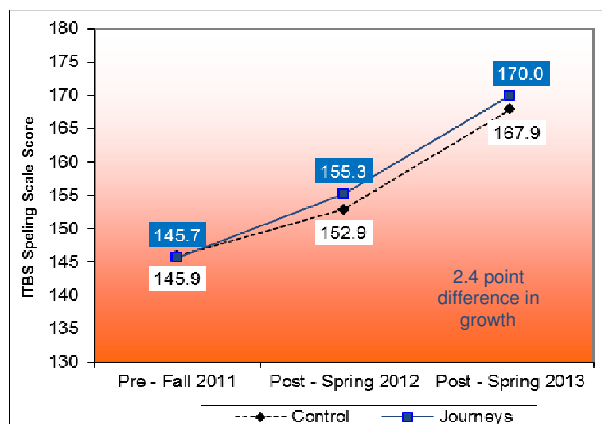
- ◆ Similarly, Journeys students showed accelerated vocabulary gains as compared to control students. Journeys students grew by 28.1 points whereas control students grew by 24.4 points over the prior two years (3.7 point significant difference).

Figure 51. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Word Analysis Subtest of Journeys and Control Students



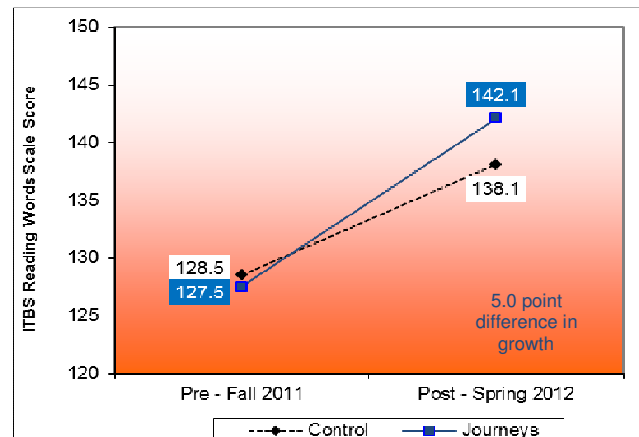
- ◆ Students who used the Journeys program demonstrated greater gains in word analysis skills as compared to control students. Journeys students grew by 29.5 points overall and control students grew by 25.9 points (2.3 point marginally significant difference).

Figure 50. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling Subtest of Journeys and Control Students



- ◆ Journeys students also outperformed control students over the course of two school years in spelling. Journeys students grew by 24.3 points overall and control students grew by 22 points (2.3 point marginally significant difference).

Figure 52. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Words Subtest of Journeys and Control Students (Kindergarten-Year 1 Only)



- ◆ Among Kindergarteners who participated in Year 1 (2011-12) of the study, results showed a significant difference such that students who used the Journeys program demonstrated greater gains in word recognition skills as compared to control students. Journeys students grew by 14.6 points and control students grew by 9.6 points in Year 1 (5 point significant difference).

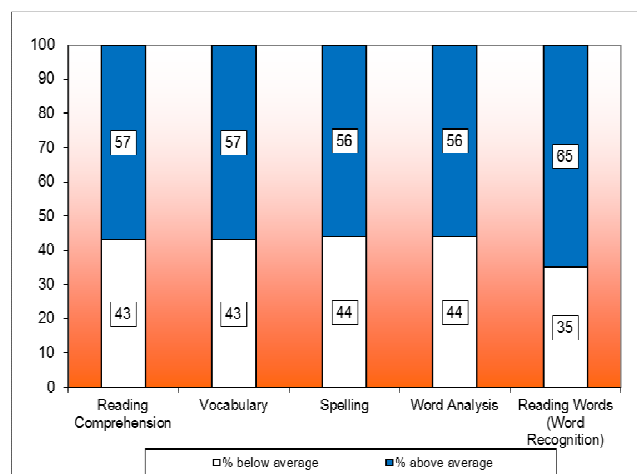
Results showed that Journeys students outperformed students using other reading/language arts programs on five out of six outcome measures. Specifically, Journeys students showed accelerated learning gains in the areas of reading comprehension, vocabulary, spelling, word analysis, and word recognition (Year 1-Kindergarten only). These findings are consistent with those obtained in the prior year, with the exception of word analysis which was a positive effect observed in Year 2.

EFFECT SIZES

Effect size is a commonly used measure of the importance of the effect of an intervention (in this case, Journeys). All effect sizes were positive indicating a favorable effect of the Journeys program on student reading performance. In addition, the effect sizes obtained can be classified as small to moderate ($d=.15$ to $.39$). Small effects are not surprising given the similarities in the content covered across treatment and control classrooms and are typical of those seen in other educational curricular research. Indeed, effect sizes obtained during Year 1 were similar in size ($.15-.39$) and in general, were stable. In sum, the consistency in findings across multiple study years lends support to the conclusion that the Journeys program has a positive impact on student performance.

In order to better understand the effects observed as a result of exposure to Journeys, effect sizes can be translated to the percent of treatment students that can be expected to be *above* the average of the control group (see blue part of bar in Figure 53). As shown, students using Journeys are more likely to have scored above the average of control students.

Figure 53. Percent of Journeys Students Above and Below Average Relative to Control Students by ITBS Subtest



Results show that 56% to 65% of Journeys students scored above the average control student as measured by the reading comprehension, vocabulary, spelling, word analysis, and word recognition (K only) subtests respectively. In other words, Journeys students were 7 percentile points higher than the average of control students on vocabulary and comprehension skills, and 6 percentile points higher on spelling and word analysis skills than control students. In addition, during Year 1 in which the Reading Words subtest was administered to Kindergarten students, Journeys students scored 15 percentile points higher than the average of control students.

Do effects of the Journeys program on student performance vary as a function of different student characteristics?

To examine if there were differences in performance between different subgroups of Journeys and control students, subgroup effects were analyzed via multilevel modeling. Specifically, differences between Journeys and control students in the following subgroups were examined: grade, gender, ethnicity, free/reduced lunch status, special education status, Limited English Proficiency status, and reading ability level. Note, it is important to view these analyses as exploratory given the smaller sample sizes involved and the fact that random assignment did not occur at the subgroup level²¹. Significant subgroup differences are discussed in the following sections.

RESULTS BY STUDENT SUBPOPULATIONS

When the growth coefficients for the two year period were examined (Pre – Post 2013)²², results showed a significant difference between Journeys students and control students in the following subgroups: Whites, African Americans and Hispanics, students in 1st through 3rd grades, Limited English Proficiency students, and students receiving free/reduced lunch. These results are shown in Figures 54-66. In **all** cases, students showed greater gains on the ITBS subtests as compared to control students within these subgroups. Thus, Journeys students consistently outperformed control students within specific subgroups. The following graphs show the significant findings

²¹ Detailed information on why this is exploratory and non-casual and statistics regarding these results are presented in Technical Appendix A.

²² Year 1 (Pre-Post 2012) growth coefficients were also calculated for the final analytical sample and are presented in Appendix A. Year 1 growth coefficients from the 2011-12 sample are also available in the First Year Final Report from PRES Associates.

observed over the two year time period (slope 2 in MLM analyses).

These consistent findings across multiple subgroups suggest that Journeys may be more effective with certain subgroups as compared to other elementary reading/ language arts programs. However, due to the small sample sizes involved for many subgroups, these results are preliminary and warrant further research.

Results by Grade Level

Figure 54. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Grade 1

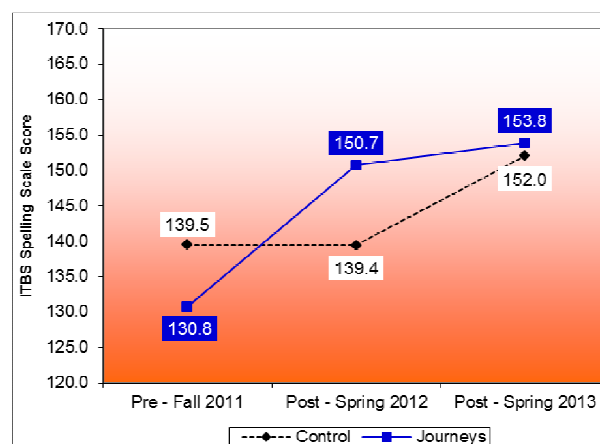


Figure 55. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Vocabulary Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Grade 2

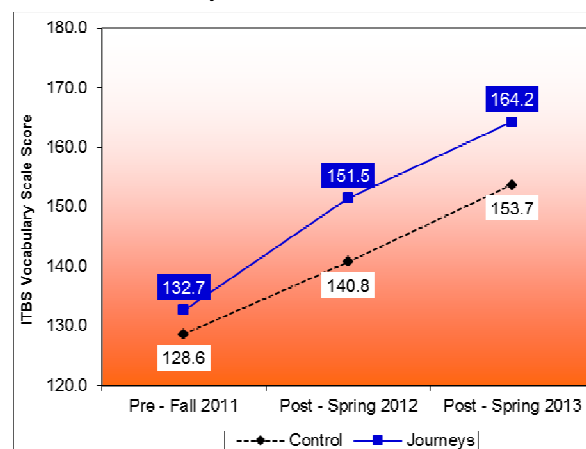
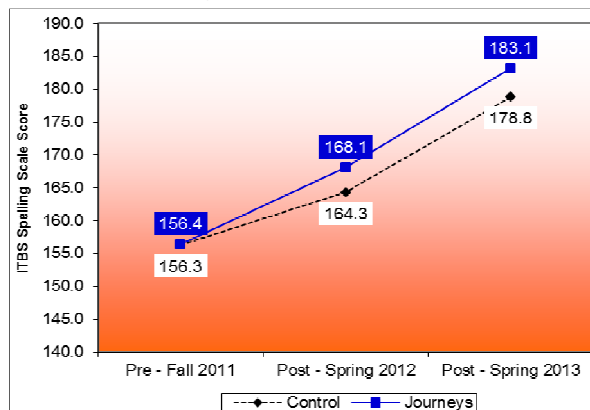
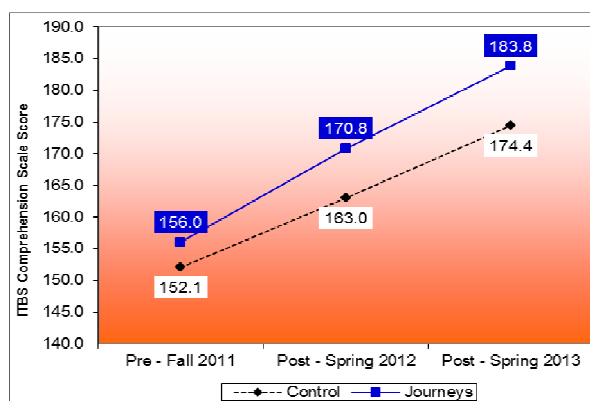


Figure 56. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Grade 3



Results showed that 1st grade students who used Journeys showed greater gains in spelling skills than students using other reading/language arts programs. Similarly, 2nd grade Journeys students had significantly more growth in vocabulary than control students. Third grade students using Journeys also demonstrated greater gains in spelling, reading comprehension and word analysis skills as compared to control students.

Figure 57. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Grade 3



Results by Ethnicity

Figure 59. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Hispanics

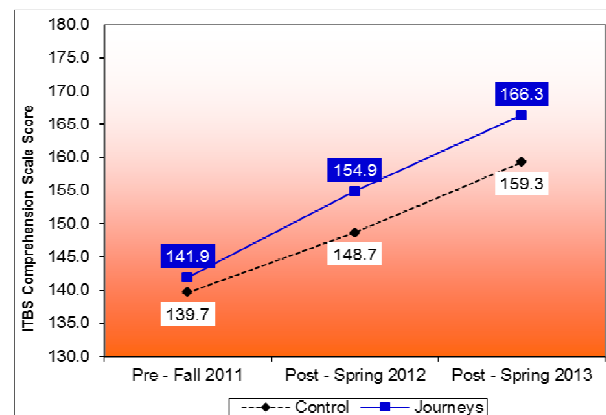


Figure 58. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Word Analysis Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Grade 3

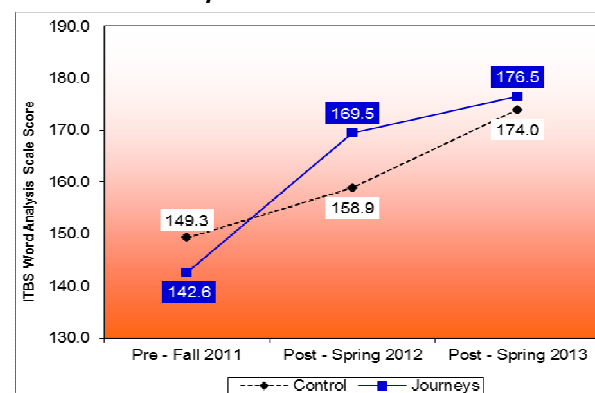


Figure 60. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: African Americans

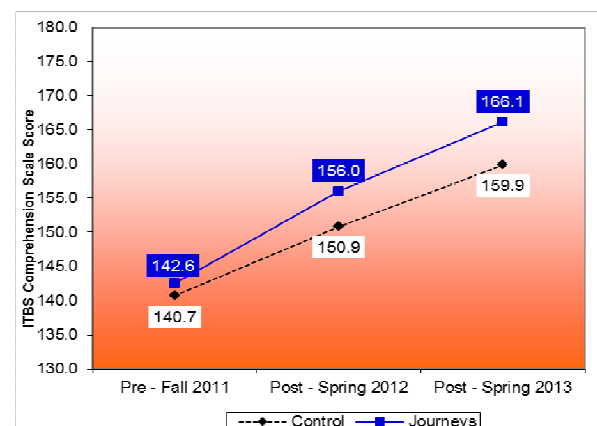


Figure 61. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Vocabulary Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Whites

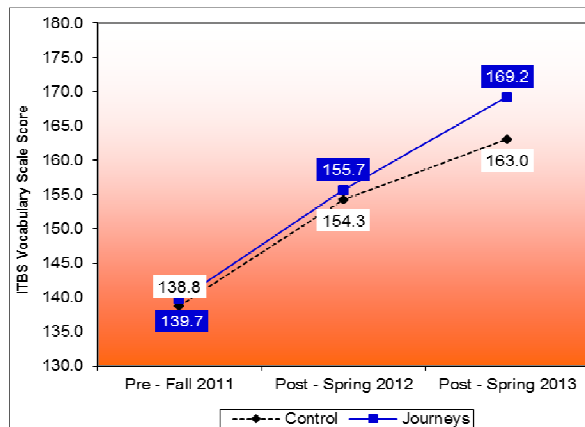
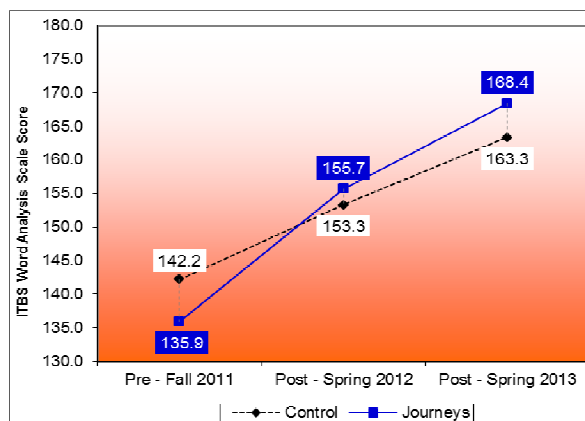


Figure 62. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Word Analysis Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Whites



Results showed that Hispanics and African Americans who used the Journeys program showed accelerated learning gains in reading comprehension as compared to Hispanics and African Americans who used other elementary reading/language arts programs. In addition, White students who used Journeys showed higher learning gains in vocabulary and word analysis as compared White control students.

Results by Free/Reduced Lunch

Figure 63. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Students Receiving Free/Reduced Lunch

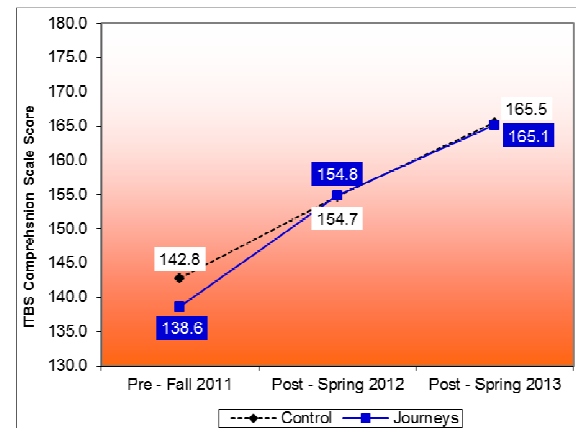
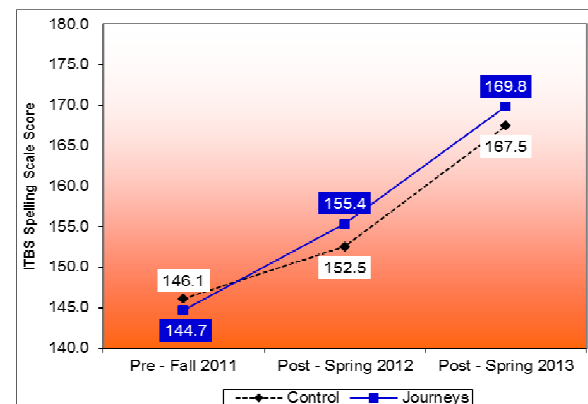


Figure 64. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Students Receiving Free/Reduced Lunch



Journeys students receiving free/reduced lunch consistently showed greater learning gains than control students receiving this aid as measured by the reading comprehension and spelling subtests.

Results by Limited Education Proficiency

Figure 65. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension of Journeys and Control Students: Limited English Proficiency

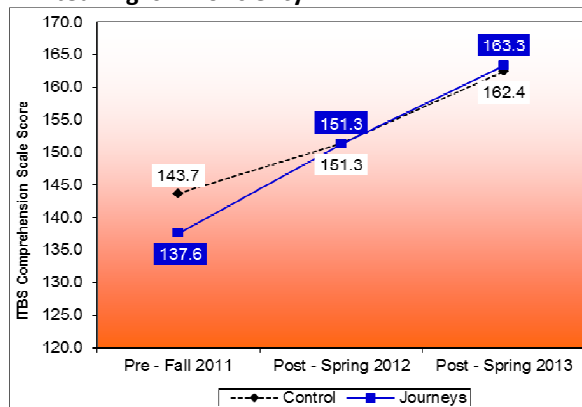
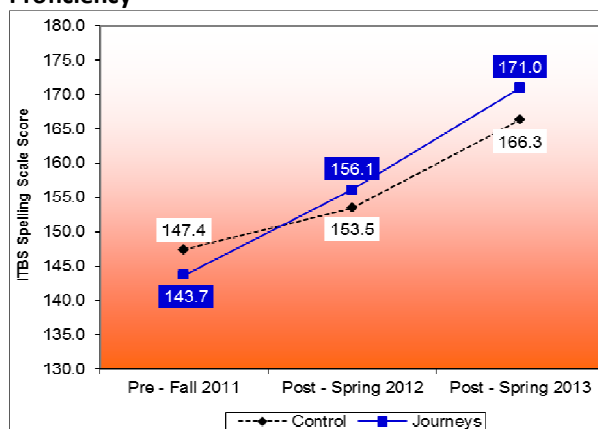


Figure 66. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling of Journeys and Control Students: Limited English Proficiency



LEP students using Journeys showed greater growth in reading comprehension and spelling than LEP control students.

RESULTS BY READING ABILITY

It is important to closely examine the extent to which reading programs contribute to the continued progress of students at differing ability levels. With that in mind, students were categorized into reading levels depending on their percentile rankings on the ITBS subtests at baseline (Fall, 2011). Students who scored at or above the 66th percentile were classified as high level students, students below the 33rd percentile were low ability students -- those between were classified as average performing. Significant differences were observed among high, average, and low level students. In all cases, Journeys students showed significantly greater growth than control students. Specifically, among low level students, Journeys students outperformed control students in vocabulary over the two year study period. Among average level students, Journeys students demonstrated greater learning gains on both the vocabulary and reading comprehension subtests. As well, high level students who used Journeys outperformed students using other reading programs in the areas of spelling and word analysis, see Figures 67-71.

Figure 67. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Vocabulary Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Low Level

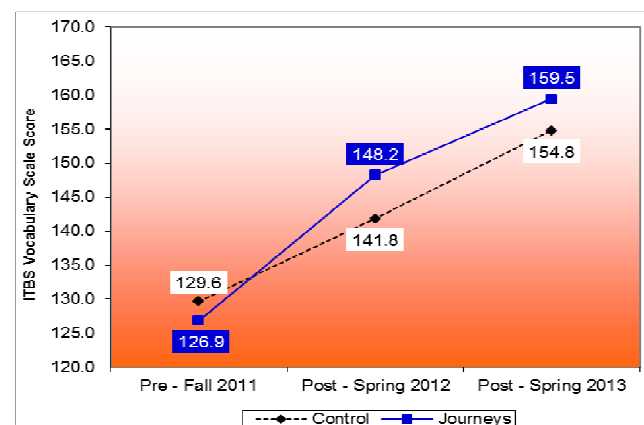


Figure 68. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Average Level Students

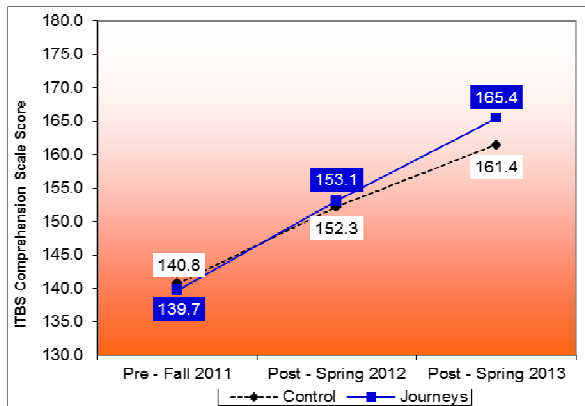


Figure 71. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Word Analysis Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: High Level Students

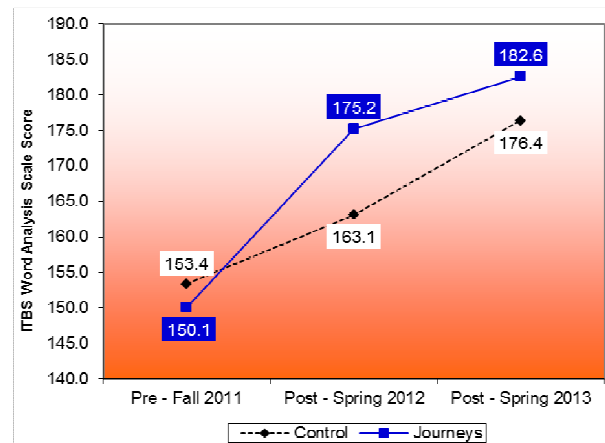
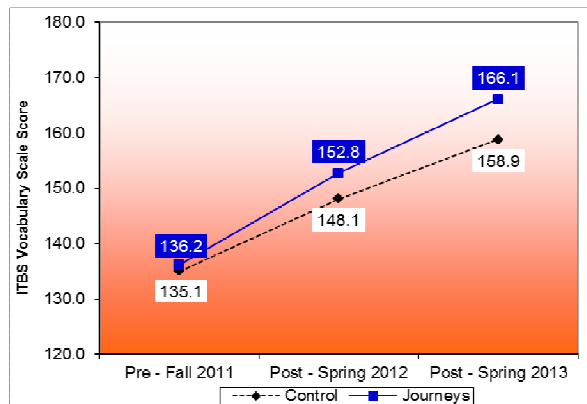
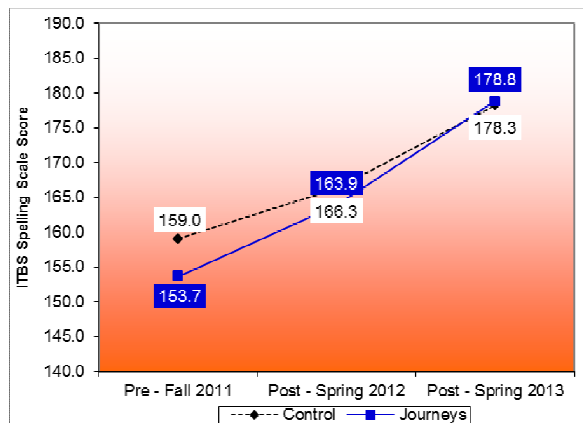


Figure 69. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Vocabulary Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: Average Level Students



Results showed that low level Journeys students demonstrated accelerated learning gains in vocabulary as compared to control students. Among average level students, Journeys students outperformed control students in the areas of reading comprehension and vocabulary. As well, high level Journeys students showed greater learning gains in spelling and word analysis as compared to control students.

Figure 70. Pre-Post Performance on ITBS Spelling Subtest of Journeys and Control Students: High Level Students



In sum, students who used Journeys showed significantly greater gains in multiple areas as compared to students using other elementary reading/language arts programs. The majority of these gains observed within subgroups of students were observed in the areas of comprehension, spelling, and vocabulary. Moreover, in all cases in which significant differences were observed, results were in favor of Journeys students. Findings were also consistent with those observed in Year 1 – that is, there were a number of significant effects and all were positive. Such consistency in findings across multiple outcome measures, subpopulations, and years indicate that the Journeys program is effective in helping students attain critical reading skills.

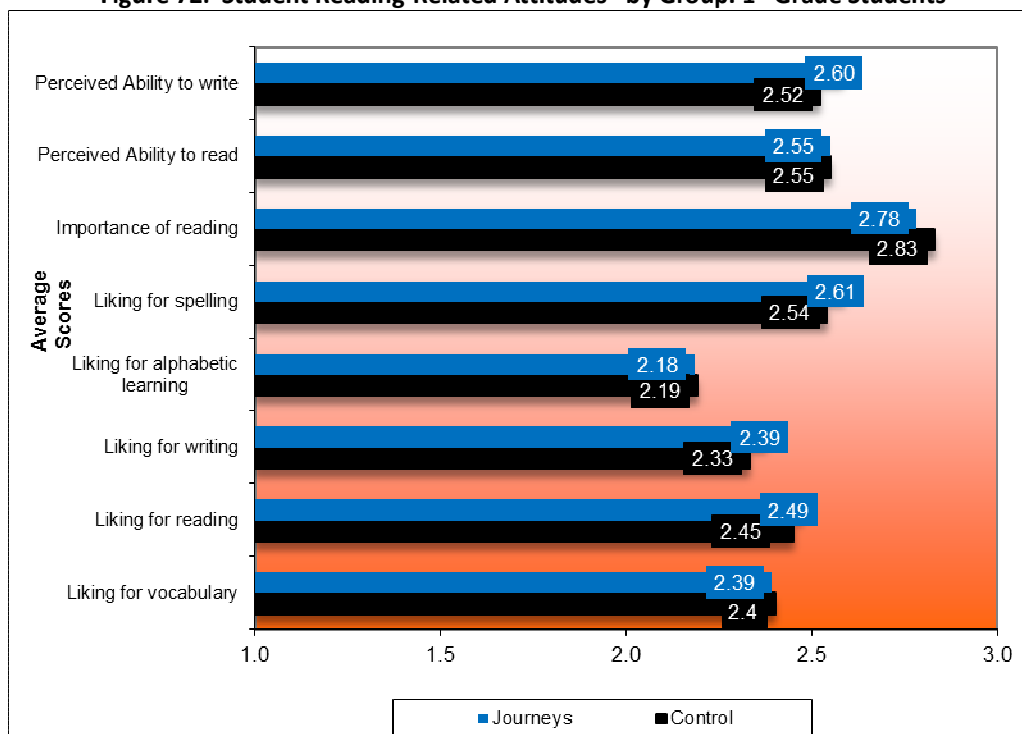
Does participation in the Journeys program result in other positive student outcomes (e.g., positive attitudes towards reading, student engagement/interest, etc.)?

While the primary focus of the Journeys program is to improve students' reading and language arts understanding and skills, the program incorporates a number of program components that may have an effect on other important aspects of education, including affective attitudes. Measures were included in the RCT to explore whether use of the Journeys program was associated with changes in student attitudes towards reading as well as changes in teacher practices and attitudes.

STUDENT ATTITUDES TOWARD READING & WRITING

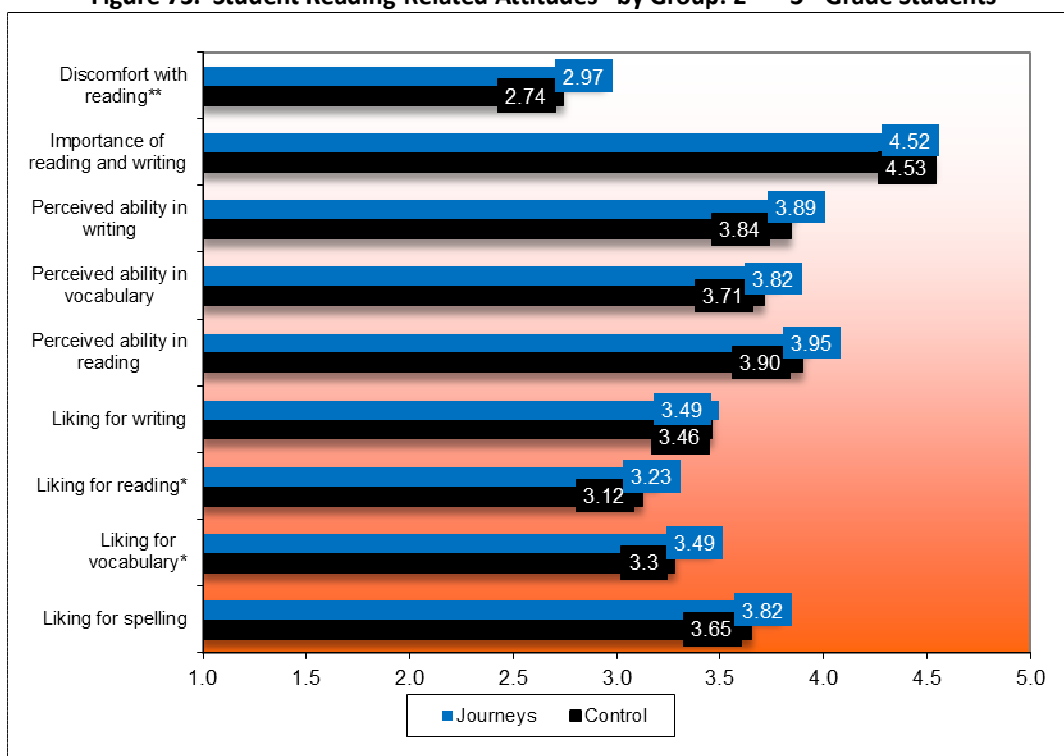
Comparison of data collected on reading-related student attitudes showed no significant differences between students who used the Journeys program and control students, $p > .05$, in Year 1. However in Year 2 of the study significant differences were observed among 2nd and 3rd grade students, see Figures 72-73. Second and third grade Journeys students reported that they liked reading and vocabulary significantly more than control students, $p < .05$. Journeys students also reported a greater comfort with reading activities than control students, $p < .10$. In general, both treatment and control students felt that reading was important; liked spelling and writing; and reported a high ability in reading and writing.

Figure 72. Student Reading-Related Attitudes* by Group: 1st Grade Students



Higher scores indicate more positive attitudes. Based on scale of 1-3.

Figure 73. Student Reading-Related Attitudes* by Group: 2nd – 3rd Grade Students



*Significantly different at the $p < .05$ level. **Marginally significantly different at the $p < .10$ level.

Higher scores indicate more positive attitudes (Discomfort with reading scale reverse coded). Based on scale of 1-5.

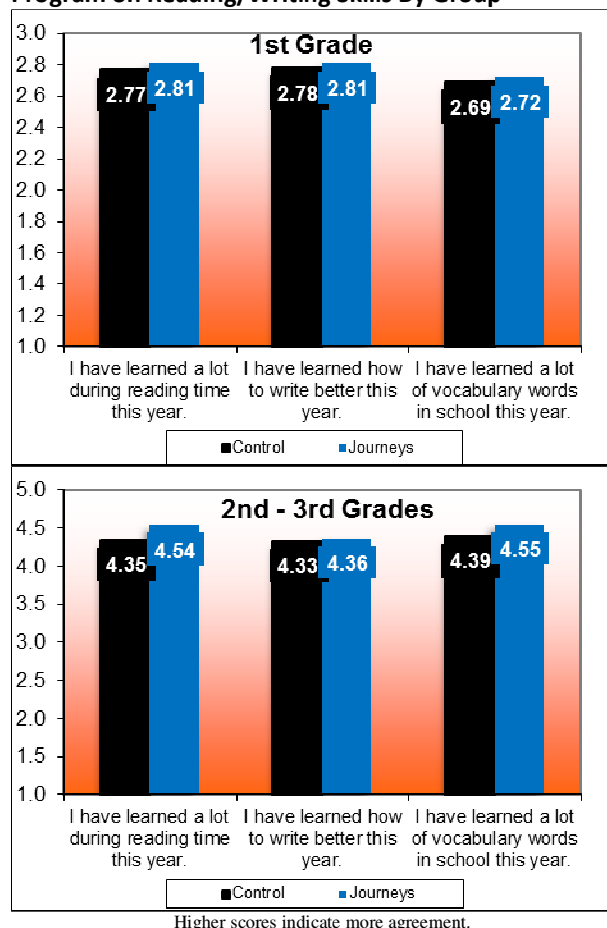
Results showed that 2nd and 3rd grade Journeys students enjoyed various reading and vocabulary related activities more than control students.

In the following sections, more detailed information is presented on how students and teachers were impacted in terms of: 1) academic skills, 2) engagement and motivation, 3) preparation for future tests, 4) teacher preparation, and 5) instructional practices.

IMPACT ON ACADEMIC SKILLS

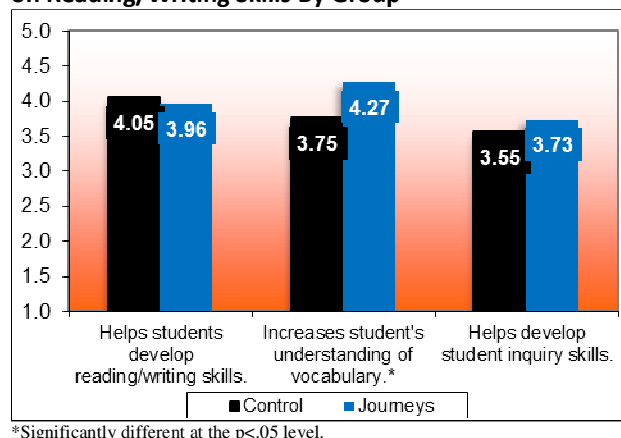
As shown in Figure 74, no significant differences were observed in Year 2 of the study between treatment and control students regarding the impact on academic skills. Journeys and control students both felt that they learned vocabulary words and to be better readers and writers over the course of the school year. Of note, in Year 1 of the study, Journeys students in grades K-1 reported learning vocabulary words to a greater extent than control students. Anecdotally, Journeys teachers commented that the various vocabulary activities, including Words to Know, Vocabulary Context Cards, and embedded vocabulary strategies helped their students decipher word meanings from the context.

Figure 74. K-1 Students' Perceptions of Impact of Program on Reading/Writing Skills By Group



Results from the teacher survey showed that Journeys teachers concurred with their students' perceptions. Similar to Year 1, in Year 2 of the study a significant difference was observed among Journeys teachers perceiving a greater impact of their reading program on students' vocabulary skills as compared to control teachers, see Figure 75. Although not statistically significant, Journeys teachers also tended to report more agreement that their program helped with students' inquiry skills than control teachers. However, in Year 2 control teachers tended to report more agreement that their respective control programs helped students develop reading/writing skills more than the Journeys program.

Figure 75. Teachers' Perceptions of Impact of Program on Reading/Writing Skills By Group

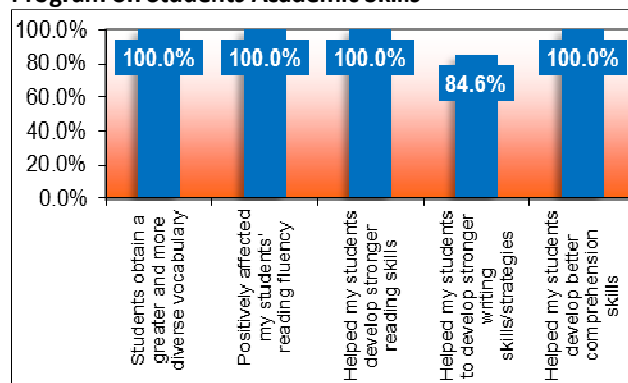


"My students last year were better prepared to go on to 2nd grade. Kids jumped proficiency levels, I was flabbergasted!" Teacher School C

"This program prepares students for the next grade level and get them to think on their own." Teacher School D

Journeys teachers were also asked whether the Journeys program helped improve upon students' academic skills. As shown in Figure 76, all teachers reported that Journeys helped with students' vocabulary skills, reading fluency, reading skills and comprehension skills. The lowest rated item was writing with 85% of teachers reporting that the program helped with students' writing skills. These findings are similar to Year 1 in which teachers lowest rating of perceived impact was on students' writing skills. As discussed later in this report, teachers reported that the writing component was not as strong and would supplement to increase the rigor of the writing opportunities.

Figure 76. Journeys Teachers' Perceptions of Impact of Program on Students Academic Skills



"The program (Journeys) does a great job with sight words, the children have made tremendous gains with sight words." Teacher School F

"My students have improved the most in reading and phonics." Teacher School D

"The students spelling and phonics skills have really improved, because of all the built in practice and repetition across the materials." Teacher School D

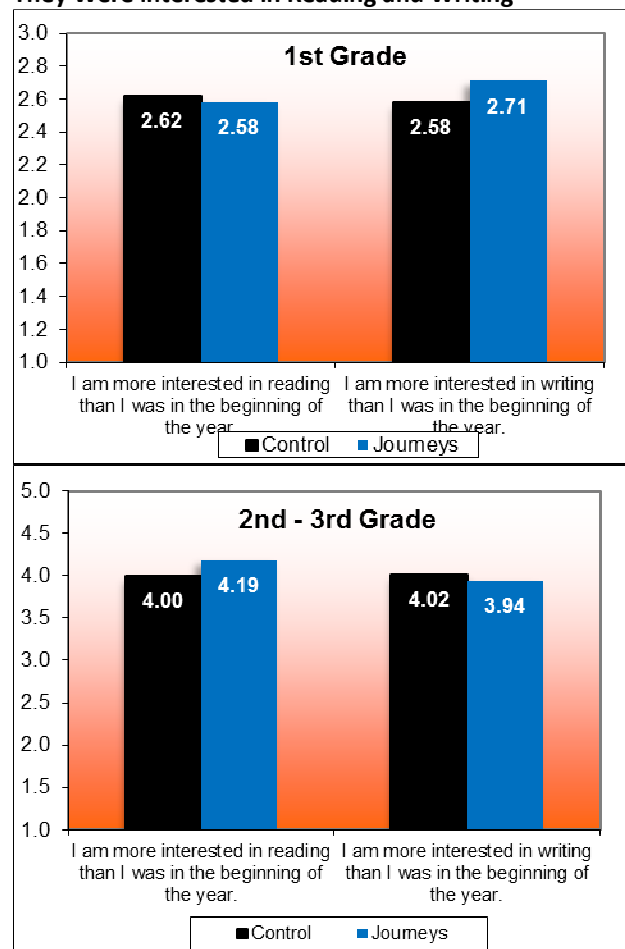
Journeys students and teachers reported that the Journeys program had a significant impact on student vocabulary skills as compared to the control group.

While not statistically significant, Journeys teachers also reported that the program helped with students' inquiry skills.

STUDENT ENGAGEMENT AND MOTIVATION

In general, during both study years, Journeys and control students reported that they were more interested in reading and writing since the beginning of the school year, and no significant differences were observed, see Figure 77. Thus, regardless of their reading/language arts program, student engagement improved over the course of the school year.

Figure 77. Student Perceptions of the Degree to Which They Were Interested in Reading and Writing



Higher scores indicate more agreement.

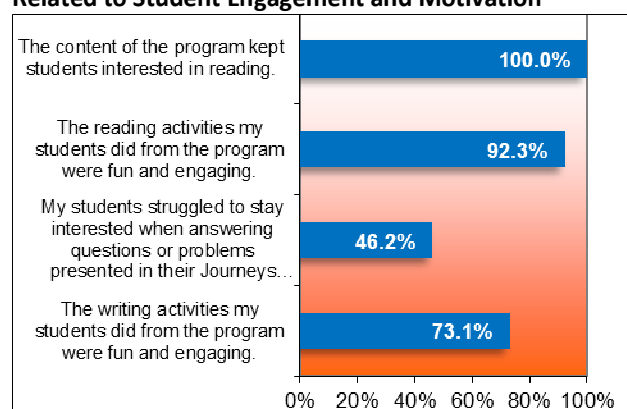
"Even my children with ADD are engaged in reading. The pace, the structure and the content I think lends itself to the age group really well." Teacher School E

"I think my students like it (the program); they definitely like the stories and always laugh and the content is appropriate and the authors are good." Teacher School D

When Journeys teachers were asked about their students' interest and enjoyment of reading and writing, 100% reported that the content of the Journeys program kept students interested in reading and another 92% noted that reading activities were fun and engaging. According to teachers, in general reading activities and

content within the Journeys program was engaging, see Figure 78. In addition, 73% of teachers perceived the writing activities as fun and engaging. These findings are consistent with Year 1 of the study in which teachers noted that the program kept students interested, but some commented that the writing component needed improvement. When asked what specific components impacted students' level of interest, teachers reported that the literature was entertaining and captured students' interest.

Figure 78. Journeys Teachers' Agreement to Statements Related to Student Engagement and Motivation



"Since I've been using Journeys I notice that my students love when they get a chance to choose their own books; compared to other programs there's so much for them." Teacher School D

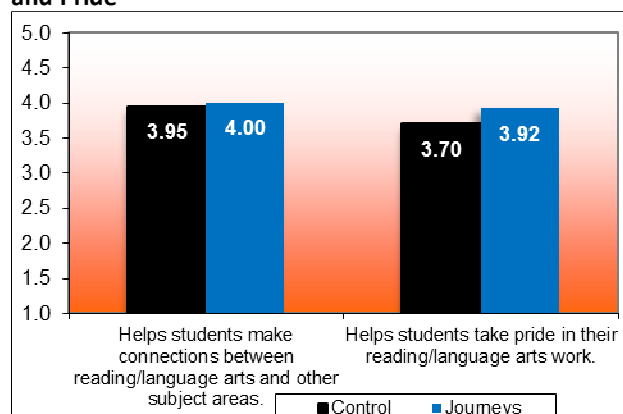
"They like the stories and they will ask to read from the Journeys book for independent reading." Teacher School A

While treatment and control students reported similar levels of engagement, Journeys teachers reported that the reading component was very engaging, particularly the literature.

CONNECTIONS/PRIDE

In general both treatment and control teachers felt that their respective programs helped students to make connections between reading/language arts and other subject areas. While not statistically significant, Journeys teachers rated their program as having helped students to take pride in their reading/language arts work more than control teachers.

Figure 79. Teacher Perceptions of Student Connections and Pride



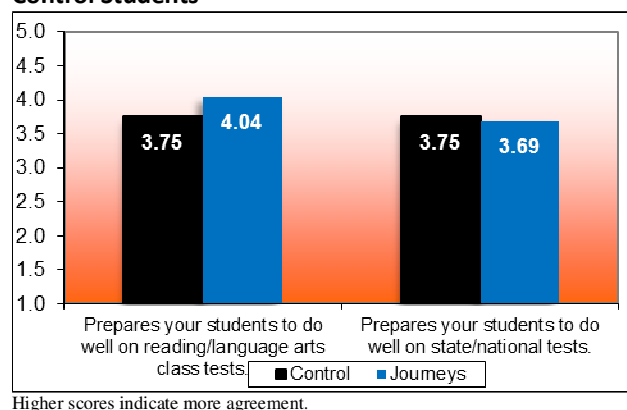
"They (the students) enjoy reading more because of Journeys; they've been exposed to different genres from Journeys and it helps them select what they like when they read independently." Teacher School D

"I love it (Journeys) because I think it has really encouraged kids that did not choose to pick a non-fiction book before to love non-fiction. I find that they are reading more, more confidence I think is the big thing." Teacher School E

PREPARATION FOR FUTURE TESTS

Analysis of teacher surveys revealed that although differences were not statistically significant, Journeys teachers felt that their program prepared their students for future tests, more so than control teachers, see Figure 80. However, unlike in Year 1 of the study, Journeys teachers in Year 2 felt that the program prepared students for state assessments slightly less than control teachers. Anecdotal information obtained from Journeys teachers indicates that the multiple-choice tests available through the Journeys program helped prepare their students for high stakes exams.

Figure 80. Perceptions of the Degree to Which Reading/Language Arts Program Helped Students Prepare for Future Tests and Courses: Journeys and Control Students



"It's (Journeys) is more rigorous and prepares the students for successful testing," Teacher School D

TEACHER LEVEL OF PREPAREDNESS

Teachers were asked about how prepared they felt to: 1) engage in different types of best practice teaching strategies; and 2) teach the five elements of reading and language arts in the Spring. As shown in Figure 81, significant differences emerged for instructional strategies. Specifically, Journeys teachers reported being more prepared to use small, leveled groups than control teachers, $p < .05$. Marginally significant

differences were also observed in Year 2 with Journeys teachers reporting higher levels of preparedness using differentiated instruction and decoding strategies, $p < .10$. While last year's Kinder - 2nd grade teachers reported no significant differences to teach specific content areas, 1st - 3rd grade Journeys teachers indicated they were significantly more prepared to teach grammar, $p < .05$, see Figure 82. As well, a marginally significant difference was observed in preparedness of Journeys teachers to teach phonics and phonemic awareness over control teachers, $p < .10$. No other significant differences were found in response patterns between treatment and control teachers in terms of preparedness.

Figure 81. Teacher Preparedness to Teach Via Best Practice Strategies

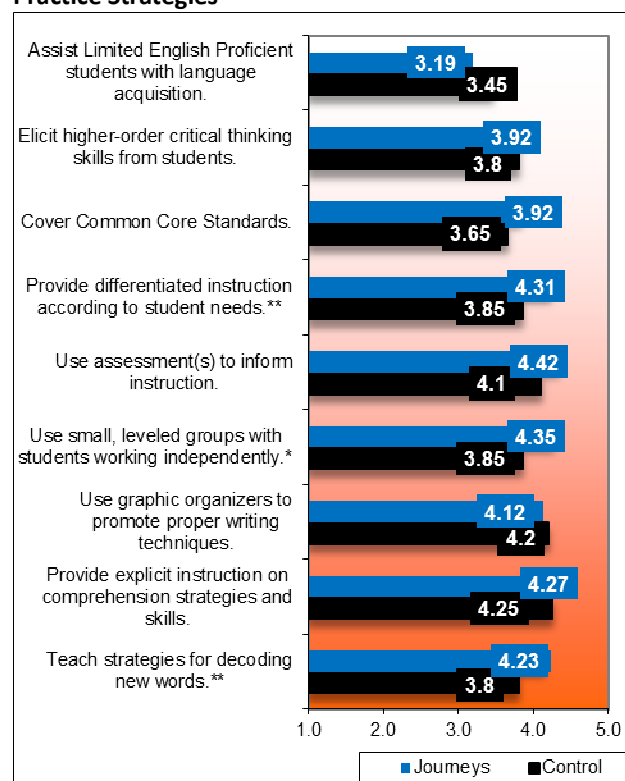
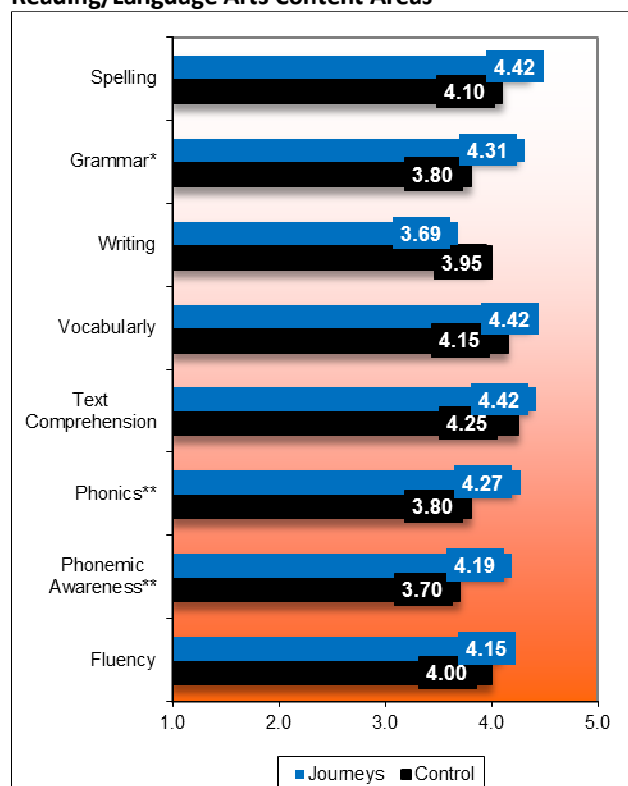


Figure 82. Teacher Preparedness to Teach Specific Reading/Language Arts Content Areas



* $p < .05$ level. ** $p < .10$ level.

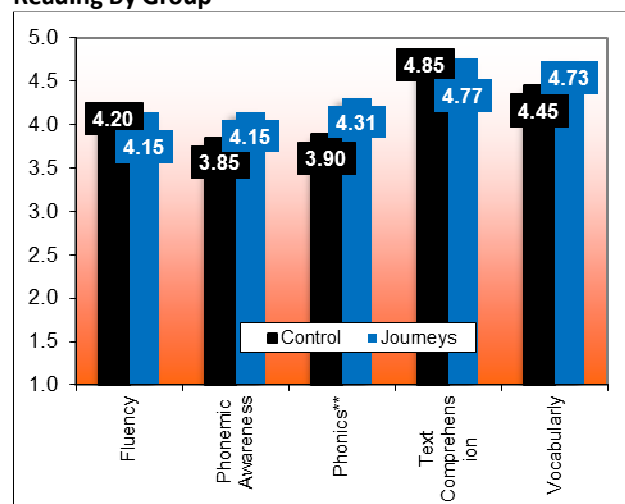
Journeys teachers reported being more prepared to use small, leveled groups than control teachers. Journeys teachers also reported being better prepared to teach grammar than control teachers. No other significant differences were found in response patterns between treatment and control teachers in terms of preparedness.

INSTRUCTIONAL PRACTICES

Teachers were also asked about the emphasis they placed in their instruction on the five elements of reading. Analyses of the Spring survey showed that Journeys teachers tended to emphasize phonemic awareness, phonics and vocabulary to a greater extent than control teachers, and that control teachers tended to emphasize fluency and comprehension to a

greater extent than Journeys teachers, though these differences were not significant. However, a marginally significant difference was observed in Year 2 with Journeys teachers placing a greater emphasis on phonics than control teachers, see Figure 83, $p < .10$.

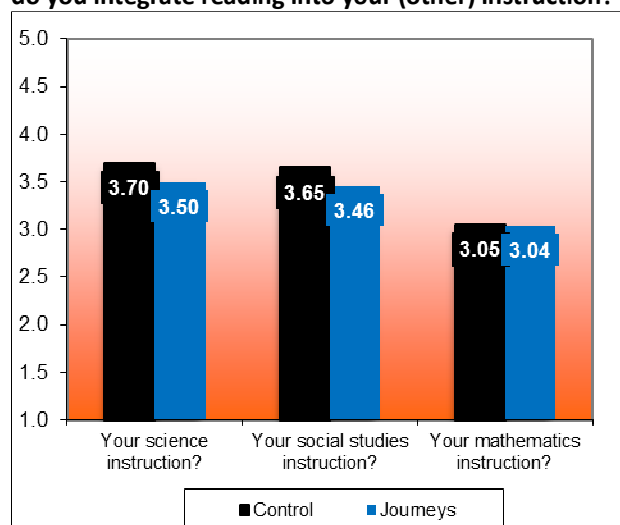
Figure 83. Teacher Emphasis on Five Elements of Reading By Group



* $p < .05$ level. ** $p < .10$ level.

Teachers were also asked the extent to which they integrated reading with other subject areas including science, social studies and mathematics. While no significant differences were observed control teachers tended to integrate more of their reading instruction with other subject areas as compared to treatment teachers, see Figure 84. This is in contrast to Year 1 in which the treatment teachers reported greater integration of reading with other subject areas than control teachers. Indeed, Journeys teachers participating in Year 1 of the study perceived this as a strength of the program. They reported that integration was more seamless with the Journeys program as it was embedded within the lessons and resources. As well, such connections are an important component of the Common Core State Standards.

Figure 84. Teacher Responses to Item “To what extent do you integrate reading into your (other) instruction?”



Higher scores indicate more integration.

“This program (Journeys) integrates social studies and science and I really like that.” – 1st Grade Teacher, AZ

Both Journeys and control teachers felt that their respective programs integrated well with other subject areas, allowing them to make important connections to enhance student understanding.

Anecdotal information obtained from Journeys teachers revealed that teachers experienced changes in their instructional practices. For example, teachers indicated that their instruction was more structured and streamlined as compared to prior years. As a result of this organization they were therefore able to cover everything that needed to be covered during the school year. Journeys teachers also reported that working with small leveled groups allowed them to provide individualized instruction to students.

“The main change is the way I am running the classroom; we are working with small groups its better because kids that whip through it can just move on and know what they are doing, while kids that need a little more time can have it.”
Teacher School E

“I like the small group aspect a lot, I get to work with them more one on one. In the past with [control program] I really felt like I was letting some of the kids down.” Teacher School E

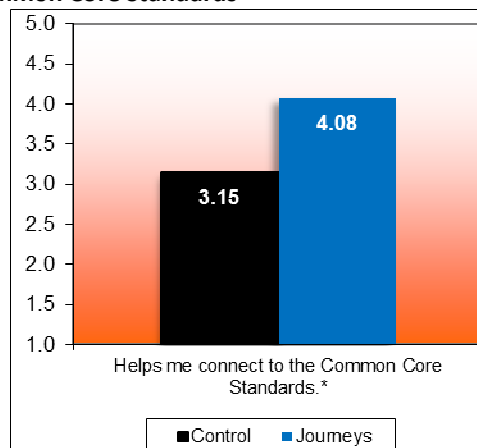
“I love teaching it because it is more structured. It makes me more thorough because of the structure, and the spiral reviews.” Teacher School E

“The biggest improvements I see are in small groups where I can concentrate on exactly what they are lacking.” Teacher School E

Common Core State Standards

As previously noted, the Journeys program is aligned to the Common Core State Standards (CCSS). In order to assess whether teachers using the Journeys program were better able to meet these standards as compared control teachers, survey data was analyzed. Teachers reported that the Journeys program helped connect to the Common Core standards significantly more than the control programs, $p < .05$.

Figure 85. Teacher Perceptions of the Degree to Which Reading Program Helped Teachers Connect to the Common Core Standards



*Significantly different at the $p < .05$ level.

When teachers were asked about the extent to which their program helped to meet specific Common Core Reading and Writing standards results showed three significant differences, $p < .05$, and two marginally significant differences, $p < .10$. Specifically, Journeys teachers reported being able to meet the standards in the following table to a greater extent than control teachers.

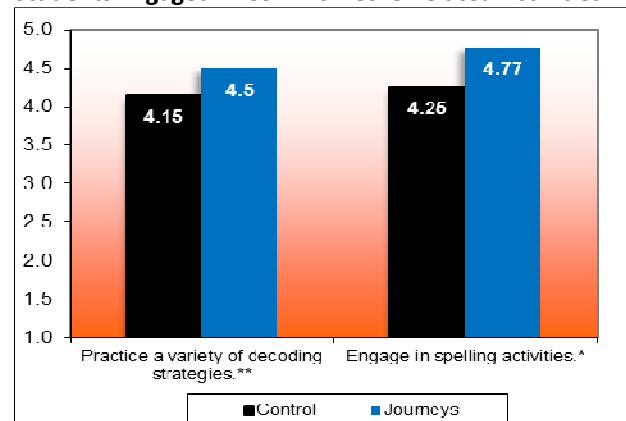
Table 8. Common Core Standards Average Teacher Ratings

CCSS RLA Standards	Control	Journeys
K-1: Literature: Retell familiar stories, including details.*	3.67	4.45
K-1: Informational Text: Describe the connection between two individuals, events, ideas, or pieces of information in a text.**	3.33	4.09
K-1: Informational Text: Identify basic similarities in and differences between two texts on the same topic (e.g., in illustrations, descriptions, or procedures).**	3.5	4.09
2-3: Language: Demonstrate command of the conventions of Standard English spelling when writing as appropriate for grade level.*	3.54	4.07
2-3: Foundational Skills: Know and apply grade-level phonics and word analysis skills in decoding words.*	3.31	4.13

*Significantly different at the $p < .05$ level. **Marginally significantly different at the $p < .10$ level.

Teachers were additionally asked the extent to which they had students complete various Common Core related classroom activities. Journeys teachers reported engaging students in spelling activities, $p < .05$, and decoding strategies to a greater extent than control teachers, $p < .10$, see Figure 86.

Figure 86. Teacher Perceptions of the Degree to Which Students Engaged in Common Core Related Activities

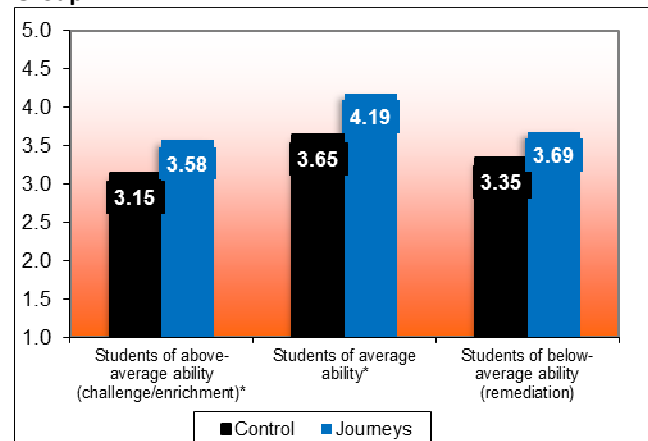


* $p < .05$ level. ** $p < .10$ level.

Differentiated Instruction

In general, teachers also reported that their reading/language arts program provided them with assistance to provide differentiated instruction to students at all levels (low, average and advanced) – however, when treatment and control comparisons were made there were two significant differences, $p < .05$. Journeys teachers generally felt that their program provided more assistance with differentiated instruction to above average and average students as compared to teachers using other elementary programs, see Figure 87. These findings are also consistent with those obtained last year.

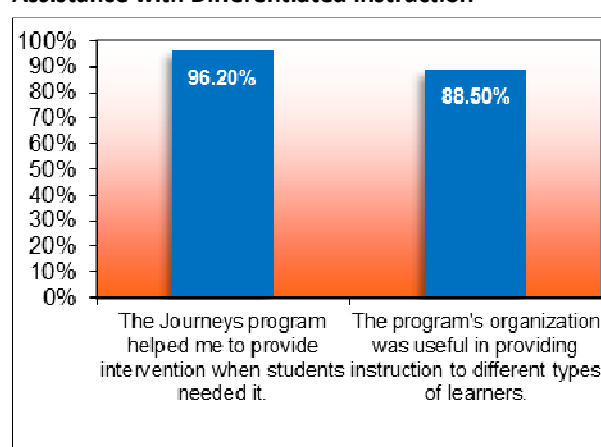
Figure 87. Teacher Perceptions of the Degree to which Program Helped with Differentiated Instruction By Group



*Significantly different at the $p < .05$ level.

When Journeys teachers were asked explicitly the extent to which the program helped them to provide intervention and instruction to different types of learners, over 96% and 86% respectively reported that the Journeys program was useful in these respects, see Figure 88. As will be discussed later in this report, while most teachers felt Journeys was helpful, especially with the leveled readers, they also felt that more enrichment and intervention resources were needed.

Figure 88. Teacher Perceptions of Journeys Program Assistance with Differentiated Instruction



"My favorite part is the opening routine; I think it is a strong program for the lowest readers and the middle readers, but I am having a hard time finding reading material for my higher readers with Journeys." Teacher School E

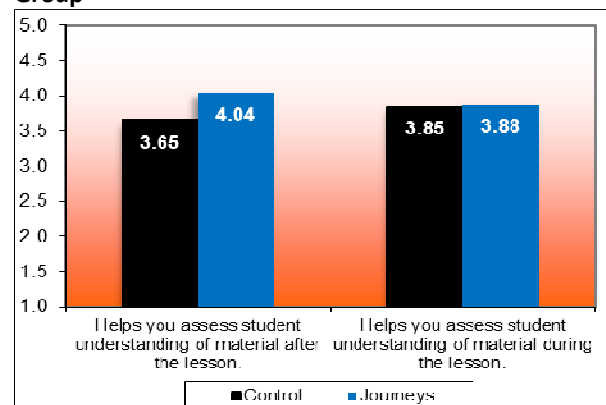
"I think Journeys is not high enough for my high kids, but then last year I didn't have enough low for my low kids." Teacher School D

Over 96% of Journeys teachers felt that the program provided them with assistance to provide intervention when students needed. Moreover, Journeys teachers generally felt that their program provided more assistance with differentiated instruction to above average and average students as compared to teachers using other elementary programs.

Progress Monitoring

When analyzing perceptions about the assistance of reading/language arts programs provided in assessing student progress and learning, results from teacher surveys indicated that generally Journeys teachers perceived greater assistance from their programs, although differences were not significant, $p > .05$. Of note, Journeys teachers felt that the embedded questions and assessments were useful in monitoring student understanding. Furthermore, teachers who used the Running Records felt these were very useful in monitoring student fluency over the school year.

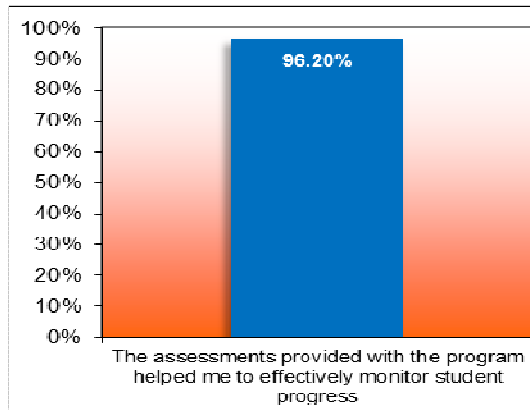
Figure 89. Teacher Perceptions About Extent to Which Program Helped Them Monitor Student Progress By Group



In addition, over 96% teachers using the Journeys program agreed that the organization of the Journeys program helped teachers to effectively monitor student progress, see Figure 90.

In general, Journeys teachers felt the program helped them assess and monitor student understanding.

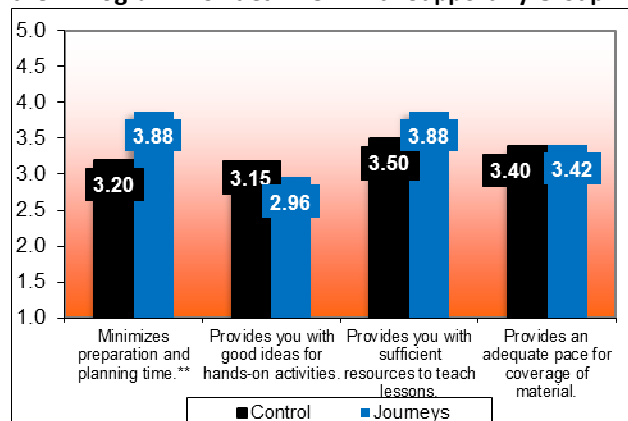
Figure 90. Percent of Treatment Teachers that Agree the Journeys Program Helps in Monitoring Progress



Teacher Support

Teachers were also asked about the extent to which their reading/language arts programs provided them with support (e.g., in lesson planning, in selecting activities, etc.). As shown in Figure 91, there was one marginally significant difference between treatment and control teachers – Journeys teachers reported greater assistance in helping to minimize preparation and planning time than control teachers. In general, Journeys teachers also reported greater assistance from their program in providing them with sufficient resources to teach lessons. Similar to K-2nd grade teachers in Year 1, Year 2 control teachers tended to report that their programs provided more good ideas for hands-on activities than Journeys teachers.

Figure 91. Teacher Perceptions of the Degree to Which their Program Provided Them with Support By Group



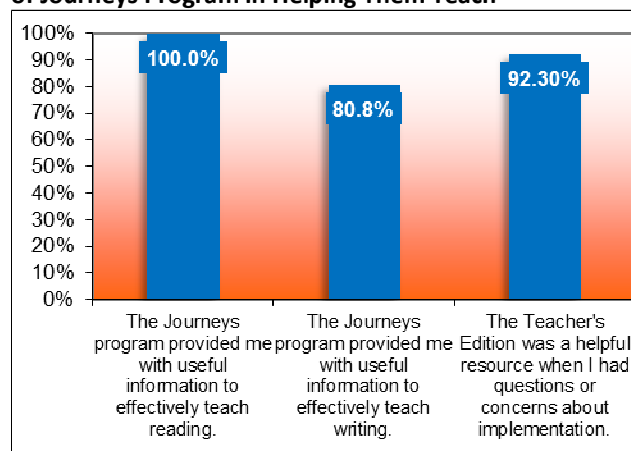
"Journeys helps me be more organized and I don't have to take the time to find a lot of stuff."
Teacher School D

"It keeps me organized so I can cover all the things that need to be covered". Teacher School F

"Journeys is much better than the other programs I've used; I don't have to spend as much of my own time to get ready." Teacher School D

Journeys teachers were further asked if the program had provided them with useful information to effectively teach reading and writing. As shown in Figure 92, while 100% of teachers reported that the program helped them provide effective reading instruction, only 80% felt the same way about writing. As noted, the writing component of Journeys was perceived as the weakest.

Figure 92. Journeys Teachers Perceptions of Usefulness of Journeys Program in Helping Them Teach



"I really like Journeys compared to the other program I've used; it's a wonderful program, but there is a lot there to try and use." Teacher School D

"The Teachers Guide is so explicit, really helpful for a 1st year teacher." Teacher School A

"I really like the Big Idea. It is very helpful in planning because then I know specifically what

they (the students) need to be doing and what I should be focusing on.”

“it encompasses everything and you don’t have to search for stuff, that’s nice.” Teacher School A

Journeys teachers reported a marginally significant difference in minimizing preparation time as compared to teachers using other reading/language arts programs.

What do users of Journeys think about the program? What aspects of the program do they find most useful? Least useful? What, if any, suggestions for program improvement do they have?

“I think the Journeys program will help my students to meet our high expectations for them, because the kids enjoy the program and I enjoy it; it lights me up to see them light up!” Teacher School D

STUDENT PERCEPTIONS

Analysis of student surveys in 2nd – 3rd grade showed that students who used the Journeys program significantly liked their program more as compared to students using other elementary reading/language arts programs, see Figure 93. Furthermore, Journeys students reported enjoying the stories, and vocabulary flash cards, significantly more than control students. Although not significant, Journeys students generally reported enjoying the writing activities more than control students. Similarly, while not statistically significant, 2nd grade students in Year 1 of the study reported enjoying the reading program, stories, vocabulary flash cards and writing activities more than control students. As well, Journeys teachers unanimously reported that their

students spoke highly of the program and enjoyed Journeys, see Figure 94.

Figure 93. Students Who Agreed They Liked Reading Program

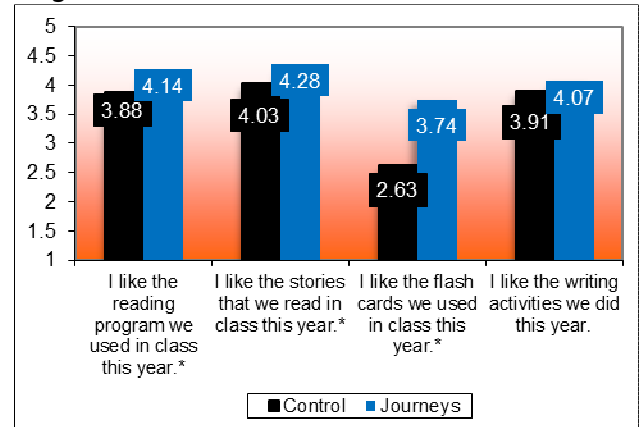
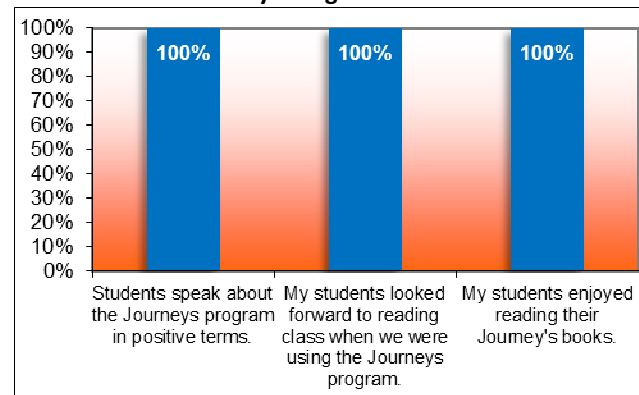


Figure 94. Percentage of Teachers Who Reported That Students Liked Journeys Program



“If you ask them (the students) how they like Journeys they will tell you they like it, they like the books, the work books and they like the tests I don’t think I even liked tests as a kid but they seem to like them.” Teacher School E

“I think my students enjoy this program, they feel like they can follow it and that makes them feel successful.” Teacher School D

“I think students like it; each week is different enough that they don’t get bored, but they can see the connection within the structure.” Teacher School D

“They like listening to the main selections and the audio tech cd’s. They loved the stories and they

especially love the non-fiction story's they eat them up. They also love the literacy stations they love to move and work with each other. They (literacy stations) make them feel independent because they can choose what they do." Teacher School E

"The students are very comfortable with Journeys because it is a continuous routine and they like that. The way it revisits each component over and over it makes it so the kids are very familiar with the components." Teacher School E

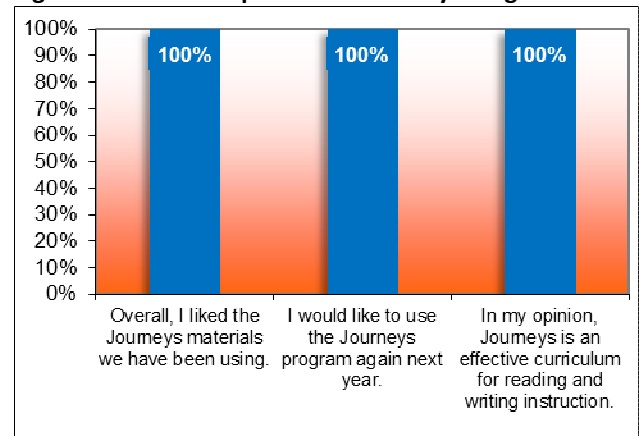
"One of the things they absolutely love is the non-fiction reading workshop, its filled with all kinds of books they are really interested in, they can pick whatever book meets their interests and they are very excited to do that part." Teacher School E

Journeys students rated their program more favorably than control students. In general, students liked the Journeys program and found it engaging.

TEACHER PERCEPTIONS

The majority of teachers reported that they liked the Journeys program and would like to use it again in the upcoming school year. Teachers indicated that the program was user-friendly and included everything they needed to teach reading. They also liked the structure of the program and how all the components tended to "fit together," for example, the connections made between the main reading selection used in whole group and the leveled readers used in small groups. As shown in Figure 95, 100% of teachers liked the Journeys program, would like to use it during the upcoming school year, and felt the program was an effective curriculum for reading and writing instruction.

Figure 95. Teacher Opinions on Journeys Program



"I really like it (Journeys), I like the consistency as well as the multiple avenues of practice that students get. I love how it all spirals together."

"This program pushes them to learn the terms and vocabulary they'll need later." Teacher School D

"I think Journeys is a really good program; for some of my students it's a little stronger than other programs, but it's good for them." Teacher School D

"I love the focus wall, it gets me centered and gets the kids centered we cover everything; my kids want to know what is coming, when is the test and what is for homework tonight. It's good to get that all out in the open first thing in the morning." Teacher School E

Teachers also reported that they liked the way the program is comprehensive in targeting numerous skills, including phonics, phonemic awareness, comprehension, fluency, spelling, writing, and grammar. The program provides explicit instruction in these areas and, as previously noted, teachers noted this as beneficial as they did not always emphasize instruction in grammar or writing. Furthermore, Journeys teachers reported that the alignment of the program to the Common Core State Standards was a definite strength of the program by allowing them to meet these standards

without taking much planning or preparation time.

“The phonics have been so useful, particularly at this grade level (2nd) it’s so important in helping them read and I like how this explains patterns.”
Teacher School D

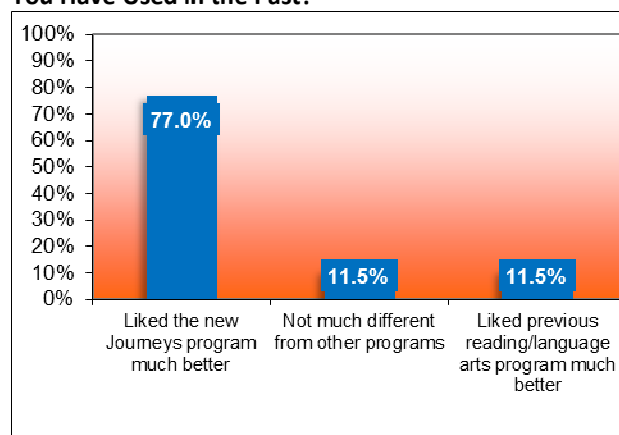
“I like how this program is aligned to Common Core and that all the components are there.” Teacher School D

“My students’ writing and grammar have improved immensely since using Journeys; I’ve never had a class this bright, maybe it’s Journeys...” Teacher School D

“Its [Journeys] really good for planning. It’s been easy to transition to the Common Core because it already follows it.” Teacher School B

When asked to compare the Journeys program to other reading/language arts programs they have used in the past, 77% of treatment teachers reported that the Journeys program was much better. Another 11.5% thought the Journeys program was similar to prior programs, and only 11.5% preferred their prior reading/language arts program, see Figure 96. These findings are consistent with those obtained from Kinder – 2nd grade teachers last year. Thus, the Journeys program was viewed more favorably than other programs teachers used in the past. As illustrated by the quotes below, a number of teachers reported that Journeys was much more rigorous as well as engaging as compared to other programs. Several Journeys teachers also noted that they felt they had flexibility in teaching with this program and liked the abundance of materials and resources available with the Journeys program.

Figure 96. Comparison of Journeys and Prior Reading/Language Arts Program: “How did Journeys Compare to Other Reading/Language Arts Programs You Have Used in the Past?”



“My students struggled the first year with the rigor, but this year was so different, they were ready to go and just took off!” Teacher School D

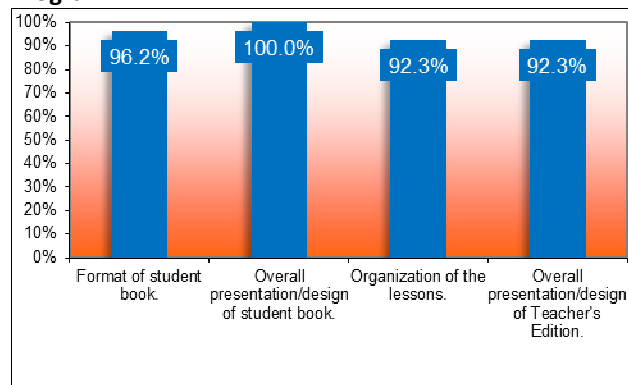
“Journeys is helping us achieve getting all students on level so that’s ok that this program is so rigorous.” Teacher School D

“I feel like when we were using [control program] that it wasn’t as organized and it did not spiral like Journeys. It did not have a clear scope and sequence I think Journeys is a lot better structured.” Teacher School E

“I think it’s a bit hard to use this program, because of the amount of materials that are there; I like that they are there, don’t get me wrong, but it is a lot.” Teacher School D

Consistent with Year 1, Year 2 teachers also liked the overall format, design and presentation of the books, see Figure 97. Journeys teachers commented that the overall layout of the program, design and illustrations were visually appealing to their students. Teachers also liked the layout of the Teacher’s Editions and felt that the sequence of the lessons provided a nice flow from one lesson to the next. Teachers reported that the layout of the Teacher’s Edition was also easy to follow and appreciated the predictability of the structure of the program.

Figure 97. Teacher Feedback on Format and Design of Program



"Journeys is nice, because it's spiraled and concepts keep coming back." Teacher School D

"The program is helpful in terms of the layout and plan; it's allowed me to form a plan that the students know." Teacher School D

"I like that its set up day by day and week by week and all concepts are covered. It really helps with planning" Teacher School F

The majority of teachers enjoyed using the Journeys program, would like to use the program during the following school year, and felt that it was a better program compared to what they used previously. Teachers liked the overall layout and design of the program, and reported that the Student Editions captured their students' interest.

FEEDBACK SPECIFIC TO JOURNEYS COMPONENTS

Usefulness of Resources

When asked to rate the usefulness of the specific components of the Journeys program, in general teachers thought that many of the program components were useful. Consistent with teacher ratings in Year 1, the top rated components teacher rated in Year 2 included: 1) main selection story of the lesson, 2) inclusion of Common Core State Standards, 3) program overall, 4) comprehension strategies in the TE, and 5) targeted vocabulary strategies, see Table 9. Among the resources, the top rated resources were the Student Book, Leveled Readers, and Teacher's Edition. The least favorably rated resources were the Literacy Tool Kit and Ready Made Workstations. These components and resources are discussed in more detail in the following section.

"I think the reading components and the leveled readers have been the most useful; the kids feel so successful and get excited because they actually read at their level and they love the stories, because the content is so relevant." Teacher School D

"The leveled readers have been the most useful and I don't have to go online and search like I used to." Teacher School D

"I really like this part of the program [main story selection]. It generally is connected to the skill we are working on for the week, it comes with supplementary materials. The kids seem to enjoy it because they can read it over and over again and build on the skill."

Table 9. Teacher Ratings of Usefulness of Journeys Components

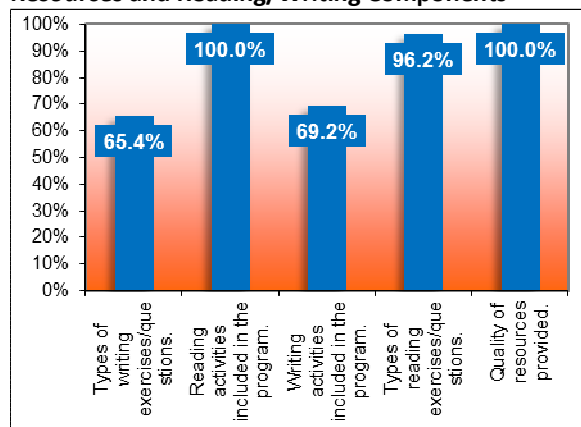
Journeys Lesson Features	Not at all useful	A little useful	Somewhat useful	Useful	Very useful	Useful to Very Useful
Main Selection story of the lesson.	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	32.0%	68.0%	100.0%
Inclusion of Common Core Standards	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	52.0%	48.0%	100.0%
The Journeys program as a whole.	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	60.0%	40.0%	100.0%
Comprehension strategies included in the Teacher's Edition.	0.0%	0.0%	8.0%	28.0%	64.0%	92.0%
Targeted Vocabulary Strategies in every lesson	0.0%	0.0%	8.0%	32.0%	60.0%	92.0%
The target skill and target strategy feature in every lesson.	0.0%	0.0%	8.0%	44.0%	48.0%	92.0%
Companion selection story following the Main Selection.	0.0%	0.0%	8.0%	48.0%	44.0%	92.0%
Stop and Think activities in the Main Selection story.	0.0%	0.0%	16.0%	52.0%	32.0%	84.0%
Essential Question at the beginning of every lesson.	0.0%	4.2%	12.5%	37.5%	45.8%	83.3%
Your Turn activities following the Main Selection	0.0%	8.0%	32.0%	44.0%	16.0%	60.0%
Introduction of the Big Idea at the beginning of every lesson.	4.2%	8.3%	29.2%	25.0%	33.3%	58.3%
Journeys Resources	Not at all useful	A little useful	Somewhat useful	Useful	Very useful	Useful to Very Useful
Student book.	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	16.0%	84.0%	100.0%
Leveled Readers.	0.0%	0.0%	4.0%	16.0%	80.0%	96.0%
Teachers Edition.	0.0%	0.0%	4.0%	24.0%	72.0%	96.0%
Practice Book.	0.0%	0.0%	8.0%	16.0%	76.0%	92.0%
Read Aloud Book	0.0%	0.0%	11.1%	33.3%	55.6%	88.9%
Vocabulary Readers.	0.0%	4.0%	8.0%	16.0%	72.0%	88.0%
Vocabulary in Context cards.	0.0%	4.3%	8.7%	21.7%	65.2%	87.0%
Weekly Assessments included in the Grab and Go Kit	0.0%	4.2%	12.5%	41.7%	41.7%	83.3%
Grab and Go!	0.0%	4.2%	16.7%	37.5%	41.7%	79.2%
Journeys Unit Benchmark Assessments	4.2%	4.2%	12.5%	37.5%	41.7%	79.2%
Decodable Readers.	0.0%	0.0%	21.7%	21.7%	56.5%	78.3%
Focus Wall.	0.0%	12.5%	12.5%	37.5%	37.5%	75.0%
Running Records included in the Grab and Go Kit.	0.0%	5.3%	21.1%	36.8%	36.8%	73.7%
Graphic Organizers.	0.0%	8.3%	25.0%	25.0%	41.7%	66.7%
Reading Adventures magazine	0.0%	7.1%	28.6%	35.7%	28.6%	64.3%
Interactive Instructional Flip Chart	40.0%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	60.0%	60.0%
Journeys Digital.	25.0%	8.3%	8.3%	16.7%	41.7%	58.3%
Journeys digital online companion.	14.3%	14.3%	14.3%	21.4%	35.7%	57.1%
Write-in Reader.	23.5%	11.8%	11.8%	23.5%	29.4%	52.9%
Literacy Tool Kit	5.3%	21.1%	31.6%	26.3%	15.8%	42.1%
Ready Made Workstation group activities.	37.5%	12.5%	25.0%	12.5%	12.5%	25.0%

The top rated lesson components in terms of usefulness were: 1) Main Selection Story of the lesson, 2) inclusion of Common Core State Standards, 3) program overall, 4) comprehension strategies, and 5) targeted vocabulary strategies. Among the resources, the top rated resources were the Student Book, Leveled Readers, and Teacher's Edition. The least favorably rated resources were the Literacy Tool Kit and Ready Made Workstations.

Reading, Writing, and Grammar Activities

Teachers were asked about the extent to which they liked various components of the Journeys program. As shown in Figure 98, teachers gave higher ratings to the reading and grammar activities and exercises/questions as compared to the writing component. These findings are consistent with those observed in the prior year. In general, Journeys teachers felt that the writing component of the program was lacking -- while teachers liked that the writing component is tied to the reading, they felt that the writing portion was not well put together. According to these teachers, it lacked rigor, consistency, and clear alignment to national writing standards. In Year 1 of the study, Kindergarten teachers also reported that the program needs a stronger focus on handwriting. That said, a few of those teachers also commented that their Kindergarten students benefited from early exposure to grammar and writing rules. These teachers did not teach writing and grammar explicitly in the past, and were quite pleased with the progress students made in these areas.

Figure 98. Teacher Feedback on Quality of Resources and Reading/Writing Components



"I really like how the grammar, spelling and writing are all consistent and they have

specific targeted skills that are correlated to each other and help build off one another."
Teacher School E

"I'm really enjoying the writing component of Journeys and like how it's integrated and I don't have to add it in." Teacher School D

"The writing is really fast paced and too challenging for my students as they don't have the background necessary" Teacher School F

"The writing is seriously lacking, the program offers good grammar but the writing is lacking." Teacher School B

"The writing has not been useful, I think it's too hard." Teacher school A

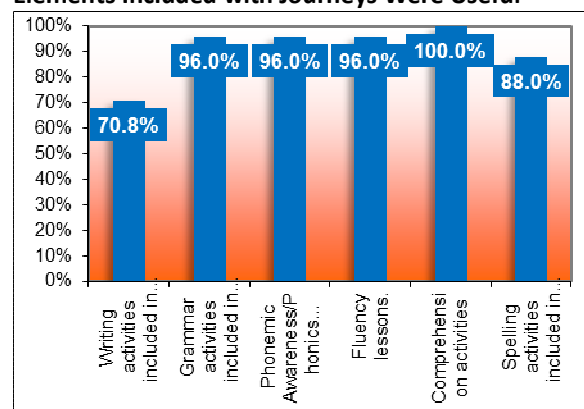
While the majority of Journeys teachers liked the quality of the resources, especially the reading and grammar activities and exercises/questions, only about 2/3 liked the writing components.

Literature, Comprehension, Spelling, Phonics, Fluency and Vocabulary

Teachers felt that the literature was engaging and appreciated the inclusion of non-fiction stories as this is something that is more difficult to find in elementary literature. The connections made with other readings (e.g., paired selections) and subject areas (drama, art, social studies, science, etc.) was viewed as a bonus and helped keep students' interest. Teachers reported that the tying of lessons across different components (e.g., sight words, spelling, comprehension strategies, etc. were all tied to main selection) also helped students understanding and acquisition of reading skills. In particular, the explicit instruction

in phonics (including site words), fluency, and phonemic awareness was reported as being essential in students' growth in reading. The vocabulary and spelling lessons were also frequently mentioned by teachers as being an extremely useful part of the Journeys program. That said, a few teachers commented that they would have liked more spelling words and at times had to supplement. With respect to vocabulary, teachers reported that they liked that the program wasn't "dumbed down." Students were presented and expected to learn vocabulary terms that they would need to know at higher grade levels. As previously noted, the attention given by the program to grammar, vocabulary, and writing has helped enrich teacher's practices by giving them higher expectations for what their students can do and learn.

Figure 99. Percent of Teachers Who Felt Reading Elements Included with Journeys Were Useful



"I like that sight words and vocab words are all laid out sequentially. I like knowing when to teach everything so I can cover in logical system." Teacher School F

"I feel the words to know and the vocabulary help them understand the story better and gives them a meaningful connection to their own lives. I like the questions that they ask them to build prior knowledge."

"The students get really into the vocabulary cards; they like the pictures and questions." Teacher School D

"I like the teacher read aloud because it helps the students visualize what is happening in the story. I think it helps them focus on being able to listen for specifics in a story, like listen for fluency, or specific vocabulary words."

Differentiated Instructional Resources

When teachers were asked what they liked best about the Journeys program, one of the most cited responses were the resources available for differentiated instruction, particularly the leveled readers. In both Year 1 and Year 2 of the study teachers rated the leveled readers as one of the most useful components of the Journeys program. Teachers felt these books were engaging, connected well with the main selection and strategies being taught via the whole group lessons, and in general, aligned well with average level students. That said, some teachers also reported that there were insufficient number of leveled readers provided (6 per level). Some teachers noted that the low level readers were not low enough (students were 1 or more grade level behind) and/or the high level readers were not high enough. Thus, they had to supplement with other readers or borrow books from teachers at other grade levels. Other teachers reported that they would have preferred more enrichment and intervention resources. Nevertheless, they liked that they could provide differentiated instruction during small group centers through use of the leveled readers. Furthermore, teachers who taught English Language Learners felt the program provided sufficient resources to meet their needs and saw noteworthy improvements over the school year. However, in Year 2 of the study it was noted that the ELL

resources were not appropriately leveled as it assumed that the ELL students were on-level. Additionally, in Year 2 of the study teachers rated the Literacy Toolkit as one of the least useful components of the Journeys program.

There's a lot to this program, but I like the differentiated Grab and Go and it makes it easy to use for centers without additional prep to differentiate." Teacher School D

"I wish there was more ELL resources; the program assumes ELL learners are on-level and most of them aren't." Teacher School D

"There's a big jump from on-level to high level and I'm not sure Journeys gets that quite right; it's too big of a jump like that." Teacher School D

Assessments

In general, Journeys felt that the assessments available through the Journeys program were useful. Teachers reported that there were a lot of assessment activities to draw from. That said, teachers also reported that sometimes they did not teach all concepts taught within a lesson or the tests were too long and therefore, customization had to occur which was challenging (e.g., they had to cut and paste specific test items in order to make them more accessible). Some teachers also reported that they would have liked to see more variation in the types of items, as opposed to being only multiple-choice. That said, a few teachers also commented that testing via multiple-choice items provided needed test preparation for their students. As well, in Year 2 it was suggested by a few teachers that the assessment be leveled to match the leveled practice activities. Additionally some teachers noted that built in weekly quizzes would be useful in addition to the unit tests.

In Year 1, some teachers noted the Running Records as one of the best aspects of the Journeys program.

"Whatever assessments Journeys provides I try to use because I think they give really good information." Teacher School E

"I do the leveled practice, but the assessments aren't leveled so it's difficult." Teacher School D

"I was wondering if some time in the future we could change the assessments so that it is a mix of bubble and written response. Then we can have some of both." Teacher School E

Feedback on Journeys Online Resources

Unlike Year 1, in year 2 of the study many teachers reported a willingness to try the online activities as they were more comfortable with the programs print resources. Among the teachers that did use the online activities, 58% of teachers reported that the online resources were useful. Teachers who did not find it useful reported it was not user friendly or as interactive as expected.

"I was really excited about the technology, but it's not user friendly or as interactive as I thought it would be." Teacher School D

"I love Think Central, if someone said I could not use Think Central I would be very sad, I love putting the technology on the board, I like how I can zoom in, highlight and underline use it on the smart board. I also like how I can access it at home as well." Teacher School E

Ready Made Workstations

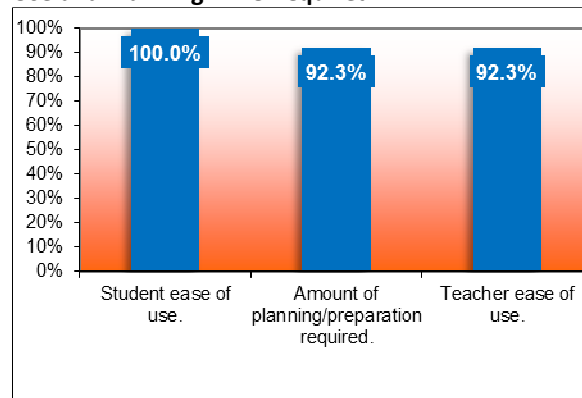
Similar to the findings observed last year, 35% of teachers reported that they did not use the Ready Made Workstations because they required students to independently work on their own, which was challenging at K-2. In addition to being difficult to do independently, teachers reported that the centers themselves were not well-planned because they were either too short (5 minutes) or too long (30 plus minutes) – thus, they lacked consistency. Furthermore, teachers reported that some activities were simply not engaging or were too easy. Thus, teachers tended to supplement with other center activities.

“Ready-made work stations were not useful, they’re not things students can actively do independently.” Teacher School C

Ease of Use & Pacing

In general, teachers found the Journeys program as user-friendly and teachers were able to quickly integrate Journeys into their literacy block. As shown in Figure 100, teachers also thought the program was easy to use by students. During the second year of the study, 92.3% of teachers reported that the amount of planning and preparation time was reasonable. This was a sizable increase from the first year of the study in which only 56.5% of teachers reported that the amount of planning and preparation time was reasonable. This was an expected increase as during the first year of implementation it is typical that teachers would experience a “learning curve” in adjusting to a new program.

Figure 100. Percent of Teachers Who Liked Ease of Use and Planning Time Required



With respect to pacing, the majority of teachers felt the pacing was reasonable and they were able to complete what was needed from the program. A few teachers felt the program went too fast or too slow; however, this was primarily due to the level of students in their classes (e.g., one teacher had a lot of lower level students and therefore, she had to go slower than directed).

“Its much better this year. I wish the program had varied pacing, where there allotted two weeks for harder concepts”. Teacher School B

“I like the way the program runs, with letting the kids work at their own pace on their weekly to do list and they like that too.” Teacher School E

“I like it; its very easy to follow. You don’t have to plan so much, we have so much on our plates. It makes it really easy.” Teacher School A

RECOMMENDATIONS

While overall teachers liked the Journeys program, they also had some very useful feedback about the program and potential areas for improvement. The primary area(s) that teachers noted as needing improvement were the Ready Made Stations, leveled readers, and writing component. In particular, teachers commented that writing activities and prompts need to be improved and more graphic organizers provided. As well, more focus on handwriting, especially at the Kindergarten level, is needed. With respect to readers, a number of teachers would have liked more varied levels (high and low for students 1+ grade above/below) and a larger library. One teacher also suggested perhaps tailoring selections according to school/teacher needs rather than providing a “basic kit.” As previously noted, the Ready Made Workstations also need to be more consistent with respect to time requirements and they also should be revamped so that more engaging activities that are clearly aligned to the daily lesson are available.

A few teachers also reported that they would like to see more resources available online. These teachers felt the program was too “paper heavy” and would like to have access to resources digitally. Additional student online activities that are aligned to lessons were also recommended.

Teachers participating in Year 2 of the study further commented on the lack of resources available for special education students and the level of difficulty of the ELL resources provided.

“I don’t like that there isn’t anything in Journeys for special education students; I often have to pull resources from the first grade teacher.”
Teacher School D

“I don’t like that the high level just consists of more text, but really isn’t higher level in any other way.” Teacher School D

“There aren’t enough hands on activities and I have to supplement for that if I want them.”
Teacher School D

“I think four levels for leveled readers would be better.” Teacher School D

Conclusion

The results obtained from the two year randomized control trial indicate that Journeys is significantly related to positive student outcomes. Elementary students using the program showed significant growth in reading and language arts skills from pre (Fall 2011) to post-testing (Spring 2013). Journeys students also showed accelerated learning gains following usage of Journeys in Year 2 as compared to when they used other reading programs in Year 1. Moreover, significant differences were observed between Journeys and control students’ performance. Consistent with Year 1, students using Journeys showed significantly more improvement than control students in the areas of reading comprehension, vocabulary, spelling, and word analysis. In Year 1, results among Kindergarteners showed a significant positive effect of the Journeys program for word recognition (Reading Words subtest) as well.

Results also showed a number of significant differences between treatment and control students who were African

American and Hispanic, in 1st through 3rd grades, of Limited English Proficiency, receiving free/reduced lunch, and of various ability levels. In these cases, students in these subgroups that used Journeys showed greater growth in performance from pre (Fall 2011) to post-testing (Spring 2013) as compared to students that did not use Journeys.

Among affective outcomes, results also showed that Journeys students and teachers felt their program had a positive impact on student vocabulary skills to a greater extent than the control group. Additionally students using the Journeys program reported a greater liking for reading and vocabulary activities than students in the control group. Journeys teachers also reported being more prepared to use small, leveled groups, teach strategies for decoding new words and provide differentiated instruction than control teachers. Furthermore, Journeys teachers reported being more prepared to teach grammar, phonics, and phonemic awareness than control teachers.

Journeys teachers also tended to emphasize phonics, phonemic awareness and vocabulary to a greater extent than the control teachers. Students in treatment classrooms were significantly more likely to engage in Common Core related activities such as spelling and decoding strategies. Indeed, Journeys teachers reported significantly greater assistance with their program in connecting to the Common Core State Standards as compared to control teachers.

All (100%) teachers reported that they liked the Journeys program and would like to use it again in the upcoming school year. Teachers indicated that the program was user-friendly and included everything they

needed to teach reading effectively. A trend was also observed where Journeys students enjoyed their reading/language arts program to a greater extent than students using other programs. Indeed, Journeys students indicated that they liked the reading program, stories read and flash cards used significantly more than control students. As well, 100% of Journeys teachers reported that their students spoke highly of the program and enjoyed it.

In sum, results from this two-year RCT show that students who use the Journeys program perform significantly better than students using other reading programs in multiple areas of literacy skills. Such positive treatment effects were observed across different outcome measures, subpopulations of students, and study years. This consistency of positive effects in favor of the Journeys program supports the conclusion that the Journeys program has a positive impact on student performance relative to other elementary reading/language arts programs.

Appendix A

Technical Appendix

Overview of the Technical Appendix

The purpose of this appendix is to provide fellow researchers with additional technical information to fully evaluate the scientific rigor of this study. Specifically, this appendix is written for technical audiences so that they may examine the statistical procedures employed as well as make more informed judgments of the internal and statistical conclusion validity of this study. It is *not* written for lay people. This *Technical Appendix* contains the following information:

- Analytical goals of these analyses
- Analytical framework
- Results of data analyses by analytical framework

Analytical Goals

The evaluation of the Journeys program focuses on the following broadly-framed goals:

1. *Assessment of effectiveness of the Journeys Program:* The Journeys program is examined in comparison to other elementary reading/language arts programs. The analytical framework used to identify the effectiveness of the Journeys program is causal in a numbers of ways:

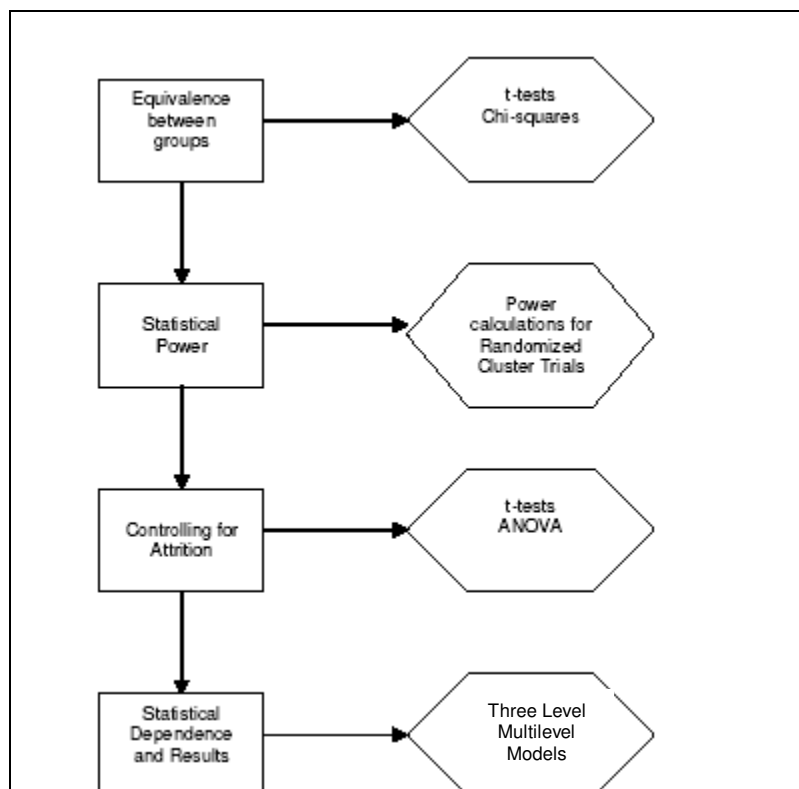
- (i) As described in the body of this final report, a well-planned randomized control trial was implemented;
- (ii) The analytical procedures pay close attention to multiple threats to internal validity including selection effects and attrition (Shadish, Cook, and Campbell, 2002);
- (iii) Given that students are “nested” within classrooms, the data are unlikely to be independent across students; dependence in outcomes is modeled by implementing hierarchical linear models (Raudenbush and Bryk, 2002);

2. *Knowledge development:* The implemented design also provides an opportunity to examine student and classroom/program measures that may be associated with program effectiveness for the Journeys program. This relationship between student and classroom characteristics and program effectiveness is viewed as primarily associative and not causal for two reasons: (a) The implemented design is focused on estimating causal *main effects* for the program; the statistical power to identify program effects within subgroups is much lower; (b) There have been very few studies that have examined subgroup effects of the Journeys program as well as reading/language arts interventions as a whole. In the absence of a strong program theory, the subgroup effects are viewed as empirical patterns that need theoretical frameworks and other rigorous experimental designs in the future to be estimated “causally.”

Analytical Framework

Figure A1 below and accompanying narrative show the four-step analytical procedures that were implemented to evaluate the effectiveness of the Journeys program.

Figure A1. Description of Analytical Framework



- (i) *Establishing group equivalence:* The differences in the treatment and control group were examined by conducting t-tests and chi-square analyses at the student, class and teacher levels on a range of baseline outcomes and other student and teacher characteristics. Care was taken to ensure that measures on which the groups differed significantly were used as covariates in subsequent analyses.
- (ii) *Statistical power:* Dependency in the data decreases the statistical power to detect significant differences. Specifically, increased values of intra-class correlations (higher dependency in the data) results in reductions in statistical power. The power to detect significant differences in clustered random trials was calculated for a range of intra-class correlations and effect sizes, and also with and without a cluster covariate.²³

²³The use of a cluster-level covariate that is correlated with the outcomes of interest increases the power of the test (Raudenbush et al., 2005).

- (iii) *Controlling for attrition:* In this step, consideration is given to attrition as a potential threat to both internal and external validity of the study (Cook and Campbell, 1979). Both issues of measurement attrition (i.e., missing data due to student absences or lack of test administration) and dropout attrition (i.e., missing data due to students leaving the study) were examined.

Dropout Attrition

The potential problems of overall attrition and differential attrition due to students leaving the study was first “diagnosed” using a simple statistical procedure; specifically, chi-square analysis was conducted to determine if the proportion of dropout attrition was equivalent among both groups. Second, in order to determine whether there was differential attrition on pretest measures, ANOVAs were run to determine if there was (1) a significant interaction between group and attrition status, and (2) a significant main effect for attrition status (Cook and Campbell, 1979). A significant interaction would indicate a threat to internal validity because the type of student dropping out of the treatment group would be different than the type of student dropping out of the control group. A significant main effect would indicate a threat to external validity because the students remaining in the study would be different than the students who dropped out of the study.

- (iv) *Statistical Dependency and Results:* Three-level multilevel models were implemented to estimate program effects. In the three-level model, student outcomes and characteristics were modeled at level 1, student level characteristics were modeled at level 2, and teacher characteristics were modeled at level 3. Appendix B describes the mathematical equations representing the three-level multilevel models.

Results

This section is organized according to the aforementioned analytical framework.

1. Establishing Group Equivalence

- a) The relationship between various student demographic variables and group status was examined. Results showed that one variable was significantly associated with group, $p < .05$. There were a higher proportion of control students who were Hispanic than Journeys students. Conversely, there were a lower proportion of control students who were African American and White than Journeys students. For more information, see Table 4 within the main report.
- a) Pre-test differences on the assessment measures were examined, see Table A1. Student level t-test analysis revealed no significant differences using the final analytical sample²⁴, $p < .05$. Thus, there were no significant baseline performance differences.

Table A1. Sample Size, Means, Standard Deviations, and t-test (Student Level) Results for Assessments at Pre-testing

Pretest*	Group	N	Mean	Std. Dev.	t	Sig. Level
ITBS Word Analysis	Control	313	139.69	21.16	-0.18	.91
	Treatment	385	139.87	21.04		
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Control	313	142.94	16.31	-0.01	.99
	Treatment	387	142.95	21.23		
ITBS Spelling	Control	238	151.49	16.53	-0.47	.64
	Treatment	296	152.15	15.60		
ITBS Language	Control	231	144.27	13.56	-1.03	.31
	Treatment	284	145.59	15.17		
ITBS Vocabulary	Control	310	140.19	17.79	-1.41	.16
	Treatment	384	142.28	20.55		

- b) Differences on other student characteristics were also examined. Results showed no significant differences in self-reported baseline reading and writing abilities, and school engagement, $p < .05$.
- c) With respect to teacher characteristics, there were no significant differences between control and treatment teachers in terms of teacher preparation to teach using best practices, Common Core State Standards, or important literacy topics (e.g., phonics, vocabulary, comprehension, grammar, etc.), perceived barriers to teaching, teaching experience, participation in professional development in the prior three years, gender, minority status and highest degree earned. However, differences were observed in

²⁴ This consists of students who participated in both years of the study within the same group assignment.

autonomy in setting instructional goals, $t(42)=2.09, p=.04$. Control teachers reported being more autonomy than treatment teachers.

- d) Implementation of various typical activities that occur in elementary reading/language arts classrooms were also analyzed based on information collected from the initial logs (August-Sept.) and pre teacher surveys (from all participating year 2 teachers). Results showed no significant differences between treatment and control classrooms in terms of diversity of student activities, amount of homework assigned, and percentage of students who turn in homework. There were also no differences in the amount of time spent on: a) reading activities, b) writing activities, c) whole group reading, d) small group reading, and e) language arts. No differences were also observed in the percentage of time spent on specific components of reading and writing (e.g., comprehension, phonics, vocabulary, grammar, spelling, etc.) nor emphasis placed in these various content areas, and in the frequency in which assessment occurred. The only significant difference observed among all the comparisons conducted was in the provision of enrichment activities. Treatment teachers reported providing more enrichment activities than control teachers, $t(42)=2.32, p=.03$.

In sum, based on these preliminary analyses the two groups were very comparable in terms of baseline characteristics and outcomes.

2. Statistical Power

The following assumptions were used to calculate the power to detect effects:

- Significance level (α) = 0.05;
- 44 clusters (classes) with an average class size of 26.
- Calculations were done both without and with a cluster covariate. Our prior research has shown that this value can range from 0.32 to 0.80. The power analysis with a moderate cluster-level covariate was set at 0.50.
- The calculations were done on a range of intra-class correlations. Research conducted by PRES Associates has shown that this value can range from 0.07 to 0.55. In addition, the What Works Clearinghouse has set a default value of 0.20 when adjusting statistics for clustering.

The *Optimal Design* software was used in the calculations in this section (Raudenbush et al., 2005). This program is designed to determine the power of longitudinal and multilevel research. Figure A2 describes the power for a cluster randomized trial for a range of intra-class correlations *without* any cluster covariate for low, medium and high power (effect sizes corresponding to 0.2, 0.5, and 0.8 respectively). Figure A3 describes the power for a cluster randomized trial with a correlated cluster variable ($r = 0.50$). The key point from the graphics below is that there is enough power to reasonably detect a moderate to large effect size; however, there is not sufficient power to detect a small effect size of .20.

Figure A2. Power vs. Intra-Class Correlations for a Range of Effect Sizes (No Cluster-Level Covariate Included)

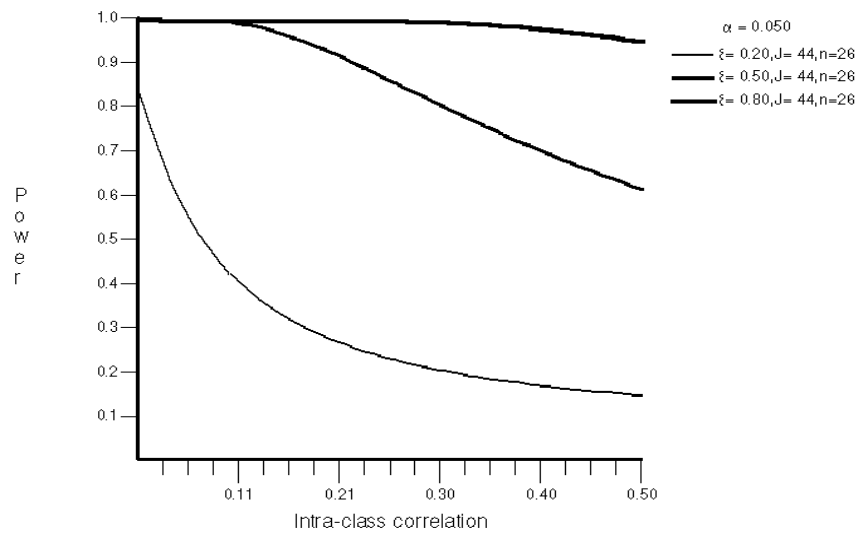
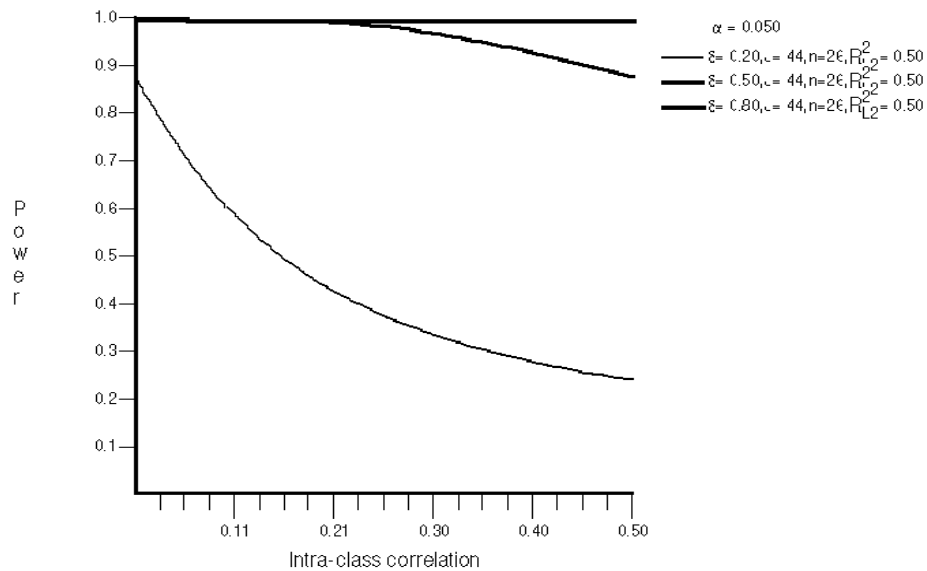


Figure A3. Power vs. Intra-Class Correlations for a Range of Effect Sizes (Cluster-Level Covariate Included)



Note: In figures A2 and A3, J refers to number of clusters, n refers to the average cluster size, δ refers to the effect size, α is the significance level, and r^2 is the correlation coefficient between the cluster-level covariate and the individual-level outcomes.

3. Attrition Analysis

As previously noted, both measurement attrition (i.e., missing data due to students not completing assessments) and dropout attrition (i.e., missing data due to students leaving the study) were examined. The approach taken in this project was to seek a consistent pattern of results of program effects across a range of methods. In this section, the observed pattern of differential attrition is examined to determine if it can explain the pattern of the observed results.

MEASUREMENT ATTRITION

While a small portion of the students did not take their tests due to absences on scheduled test administration days, teachers did very well in administering the assessments when these students returned. Furthermore, among the students who did complete a make-up test, the vast majority left the study (transferred out of the school or class). As a result, measurement attrition was minimal (5-10 students) and was not be calculated as all students in the final analytical sample provided pre-data.

DROPOUT ATTRITION

Among students who were available to participate in both study years, there was an overall dropout attrition of 22.3% due to students leaving school either during the summer of 2012 or during the 2012-13 school year. Of note, the RI school district underwent a reorganization during the summer of 2012 and approximately half of the students who participated in year 1 moved to another building that was not participating in this study. This resulted in a loss of participants and raised the attrition rate higher than what would have occurred otherwise. The Technical Report analyzing dropout attrition during the 2011-12 school year found an overall attrition rate of 6.9% (6.0% among control and 7.7% among treatment) and no significant relationship between attrition and group. Similar to the first year of the study, during the second year of implementation, drop-out behavior was primarily attributed to students moving and transferring to other schools. Analyses were performed to examine if there was *differential attrition* as a result of students leaving. The following table highlights the attrition levels by group and provides summary data and a test statistic to assess whether a significant relationship exists between attrition category and group. There were no significant findings for the treatment or control conditions for any of the attrition categories described.

Table A2. Number of Students by Enrollment Status

	Students			Chi-square
	Control	Treatment	Total	
Enrolled at end of Spring 2012	448 (100%)	598 (100%)	1046 (100%)	
Left during summer and did not return to school in Fall 2012	67 (13.6%)	87 (15.7%)	154 (14.7%)	$\chi^2 (1)=.953, p=.329$
Left during 2012-13 school year	34 (6.9%)	45 (8.1%)	79 (7.6%)	$\chi^2 (1)=575, p=.448$
Total Enrolled at end of Spring 2013	347 (79.5%)	466 (76.2%)	813 (77.7%)	

Not all students who left the study dropped out in a manner described above. Some simply changed conditions (i.e., students who were in the Journeys program in year 1 were placed in a class that was in the control condition, or vice versa). Table A3 shows the number (and percent) of students who changed conditions and those who remained in the same condition during both years by group. Results showed a significant relationship in the proportion of students who changed conditions. Namely, a higher proportion of students who were in the treatment condition in year 1 were transferred to a control class in year 2 (17%) as compared to control students moving to the treatment condition (9.8%). These students were excluded from the main outcome analyses.

Table A3. Number of Students Changing Conditions*

	Students		
	Control	Treatment	Total
Students who stayed in the same condition during both years of the study	313 (90.2%)	387 (83.0%)	700 (86.1%)
Students who changed conditions	34 (9.8%)	79 (17.0%)	113 (13.9%)

* $\chi^2(1)=8.507, p=.004$

Additional analyses were performed to examine whether baseline performance differences existed between students who remained in the study and those who left or changed conditions, and group assignment (see Tables A4-A6 for more information). Of interest in these ANOVAs were the interactions of group assignment and attrition status and the main effect for attrition status. A significant interaction would indicate a threat to internal validity. Similarly, a main effect for attrition status would suggest a threat to external validity.

Examination of the *interactions* showed no significant group by attrition status interactions on all measures for enrollment status and dropout attrition. However, analysis of the *main effects* for attrition status showed significant effects for all measures for those who left during the 2012-13 school year as well as those that left during the summer of 2012. In general, and across treatment and control conditions, dropouts in the 2012-13 school year performed at a higher level than students who did not leave. In contrast, students who did not return for the 2012-13 school year (left summer 2012) performed at a lower level than students who did not leave.

Table A4. ANOVA Results for Pre-Tests by Group and Attrition Status for 2012-13 School Year

Measure	Attrition Status	Group	N	Mean	Sd.	ANOVA for interaction	ANOVA for main effect
ITBS Word Analysis	Attrition	Control	34	160.50	34.37	F(1, 1022)=0.768, p=0.381	F(1,1022)=73.87, p=.000
		Treatment	45	160.42	25.25		
	No change	Control	452	134.85	20.85		
		Treatment	49	139.52	23.53		
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Attrition	Control	34	158.88	21.51	F(1, 1023)=.141, p=0.708	F(1,1023)=86.50, p=0.000
		Treatment	45	161.60	21.51		
	No change	Control	451	138.74	16.44		
		Treatment	493	139.77	20.86		

Table A4 Continued. ANOVA Results for Pre-Tests by Group and Attrition Status for 2012-13 School Year

Measure	Attrition Status	Group	N	Mean	Sd.	ANOVA for interaction	ANOVA for main effect
ITBS Spelling	Attrition	Control	34	163.15	23.45	$F(1,709)=0.387$, $p=0.534$	$F(1,709)=53.59$, $p=0.00$
		Treatment	45	166.98	22.16		
	No change	Control	295	149.64	15.97		
		Treatment	335	150.96	15.75		
ITBS Language	Attrition	Control	29	151.10	19.32	$F(1,669)=1.43$, $p=0.232$	$F(1,669)=9.58$, $p=0.002$
		Treatment	28	148.32	17.51		
	No change	Control	288	142.43	13.18		
		Treatment	324	144.48	15.02		
ITBS Vocabulary	Attrition	Control	34	153.06	18.76	$F(1,1016)=.858$, $p=0.355$	$F(1,1016)=67.44$, $p=0.00$
		Treatment	45	159.31	22.92		
	No change	Control	449	136.50	17.51		
		Treatment	488	138.54	20.36		

Table A5. ANOVA Results for Pre-Tests by Group and Attrition Status for 2012 Summer

Measure	Attrition Status	Group	N	Mean	Sd.	ANOVA for interaction	ANOVA for main effect
ITBS Word Analysis	Attrition	Control	60	120.60	14.09	$F(1, 1022)=1.93$, $p=0.164$	$F(1,1022)=101.50$, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	73	120.40	13.97		
	No change	Control	426	138.90	23.09		
		Treatment	463	144.56	24.02		
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Attrition	Control	59	122.88	10.44	$F(1, 1023)=.039$, $p=0.843$	$F(1,1023)=119.11$, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	72	125.17	9.90		
	No change	Control	426	142.55	17.03		
		Treatment	466	144.13	21.98		
ITBS Spelling	Attrition	Control	22	138.04	8.71	$F(1,709)=.039$, $p=0.844$	$F(1,709)=32.47$, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	27	139.00	11.33		
	No change	Control	307	151.97	17.45		
		Treatment	353	153.92	17.33		
ITBS Language	Attrition	Control	22	129.82	6.33	$F(1,669)=0.358$, $p=0.550$	$F(1,669)=38.56$, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	28	133.86	7.33		
	No change	Control	295	144.23	13.95		
		Treatment	324	145.73	15.38		
ITBS Vocabulary	Attrition	Control	60	126.17	13.92	$F(1,1016)=3.14$, $p=0.076$	$F(1,1016)=82.88$, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	71	123.41	9.56		
	No change	Control	423	139.29	18.03		
		Treatment	462	142.89	21.49		

In addition, there were no significant interactions observed with respect to students who changed conditions and group. That said, three main effects were observed for the Word Analysis, Reading Comprehension, and Vocabulary subtests. In these cases, students who did not change conditions had higher performance levels than students that did change conditions, see Table A6.

Table A6. ANOVA Results for Pre-Tests by Group and Second Year Group Status Changes

Measure	Attrition Status	Group	N	Mean	Sd.	ANOVA for interaction	ANOVA for main effect
ITBS Word Analysis	Changed Status	Control	79	126.51	15.86	F(1, 810)=.839, $p=0.360$	F(1, 810)=41.52, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	33	126.70	21.27		
	No change	Control	313	139.69	21.16		
		Treatment	385	144.24	22.94		
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Changed Status	Control	79	133.97	11.41	F(1, 813)=.016, $p=0.900$	F(1, 813)=18.29, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	34	134.50	19.87		
	No change	Control	313	142.94	16.31		
		Treatment	387	142.95	21.23		
ITBS Spelling	Changed Status	Control	35	144.37	10.74	F(1,581)=0.423, $p=0.516$	F(1,581)=3.83, $p=0.051$
		Treatment	12	148.58	17.77		
	No change	Control	238	151.49	16.53		
		Treatment	296	152.15	15.59		
ITBS Language	Changed Status	Control	35	138.23	7.42	F(1,562)=.546, $p=0.460$	F(1,562)=2.98, $p=0.085$
		Treatment	12	143.17	15.93		
	No change	Control	231	144.27	13.56		
		Treatment	287	145.59	15.17		
ITBS Vocabulary	Changed Status	Control	79	129.85	13.41	F(1,806)=1.126, $p=0.289$	F(1,806)=36.72, $p=0.000$
		Treatment	33	127.55	15.85		
	No change	Control	310	140.19	17.79		
		Treatment	385	142.28	20.55		

In summary, while there was no evidence for differential dropout attrition, there was some evidence for baseline performance differences among those who dropped out of the study; however the relationship depended on when dropout occurred. Students who left the study in the 2012-13 school year ($n=79$) tended to have higher literacy than students who participated in both years. In contrast, students who left in the summer of 2012 ($n=154$) had lower literacy than students who participated in both years. Furthermore, these differences were consistent between groups and as noted there were no significant interaction across 10 comparisons. As such, the threat to internal validity is minimized. Additionally, there is no evidence of differential baselines for those who changed status between treatment and control conditions and those that remained in the same condition during both years. While the overall attrition rate was not low (22%), this rate is due in large part to the reorganization that occurred at one participating school district – approximately half of the year 1 study participants could not participate in year 2 as they were transferred to another school.

4. Statistical Analysis of Outcomes Measures

Analysis of Growth among Treatment Students

Paired t-tests for Change from Pretest to Posttest

Table A7 presents the means obtained for treatment students using Journeys at pre- and posttests as measured by the ITBS subtests. Paired sample t-tests were conducted to examine whether there was significant change from pretest to posttest. Results showed significant growth (i.e., improvement in performance) on all outcome measures. Moreover, the quadratic relationship was significant for Word Analysis, Spelling and Language. Examination of the change in slope reveals that with Spelling and Language, the growth during year 2 was greater than the growth observed in year 1. These findings suggest a cumulative effect of the Journeys program on spelling and language skills, with higher levels of growth observed following two years of exposure to the program as compared to one year of exposure. In contrast, for Word Analysis, growth was larger in year 1 as compared to year 2. Thus, the cumulative gains were not constant across all outcomes.

Table A7. Pre-Posttest Scores for Treatment Students (Repeated Measures Results Within Subjects)

	N	Pre Mean (sd)	Post – Year 1 Mean (sd)	Post – Year 2 Mean (sd)	F	Sig. Level
ITBS Word Analysis	268	144.51 (23.40)	165.55 (25.84)	172.24 (32.84)	Linear= 129.20 Quadratic= 26.89	<.001* <.001*
ITBS Reading Comprehension	268	141.21 (21.44)	159.18 (20.52)	177.57 (29.76)	Linear= 752.18 Quadratic= 0.08	<.001* .78
ITBS Spelling	310	152.12 (14.12)	164.33 (16.07)	180.61 (22.34)	Linear= 398.65 Quadratic= 5.13	<.001* .03*
ITBS Language	191	146.25 (15.20)	160.47 (22.38)	180.29 (34.91)	Linear= 299.88 Quadratic= 4.73	<.001* .03*
ITBS Vocabulary	267	141.47 (20.68)	158.40 (20.82)	177.03 (23.62)	Linear= 791.27 Quadratic= 0.88	<.001* .35

* $p < .05$

Multilevel Models for Growth in Treatment Students

Analyses were also performed to examine if students showed accelerated growth following usage of Journeys as compared to when they used another reading program. A subsample of Journeys students ($n=78$) who used another reading program during the 2011-12 study year and Journeys during the 2012-13 study year was used in this analysis. Results showed a significant relationship for two of the five measures (see Table A8). Specifically, modeled growth for the Spelling and Language subtests following usage of Journeys (in the 2012-13 school year) was significantly greater than their predicted performance had they remained in the control condition. That is, there was a significant bump up in student test scores after they had used Journeys as compared to when they used another reading program in the prior year.

Table A8. Analysis of Change in Growth from Students Using Journeys only in Year 2: Two-Level Models^a

Predictor		Coefficient	Standard Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
ITBS Word Analysis	Time Slope- β_{10}	15.88	3.01	5.27	<.001*
	Change Slope- β_{20}	-2.16	5.36	-0.40	0.67
ITBS Reading Comprehension	Time Slope- β_{10}	7.94	2.21	3.60	<.001*
	Change Slope- β_{20}	5.33	3.93	1.36	0.18
ITBS Spelling	Time Slope- β_{10}	2.67	2.91	0.92	0.36
	Change Slope- β_{20}	18.55	5.15	3.60	<.001*
ITBS Vocabulary	Time Slope- β_{10}	10.93	2.40	4.55	<.001*
	Change Slope- β_{20}	3.90	4.27	0.91	0.36
ITBS Language	Time Slope- β_{10}	3.46	2.67	1.30	0.20
	Change Slope- β_{20}	14.86	4.72	3.15	.003*

^a Each row corresponds to the coefficients estimated from running a *separate* model for each of the tests. * $p < .05$

Growth Analysis of Subgroups of Treatment Students

Exploratory analysis was also performed to examine the relationship between Journeys and subgroup performance. That is, the results summarized in this section deal with the performance among treatment students only. It is important to note that due to the small sample sizes, no causal, conclusive statements should be made. Nevertheless, these results are presented for preliminary, exploratory purposes. Analyses were performed for the following subgroup categories: gender, ethnicity, free/reduced lunch status, special education status, Limited English Proficiency status, grade level, and students at various reading levels.

The accompanying tables (A9-A17) include the paired t-tests' results. For these analyses, only treatment students within these subgroups are included. This provides preliminary information on whether students in these subgroups show growth in reading performance.

Gender

Table A9. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Gender

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Male							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	141.12	20.54	130	Linear= 364.82	1,129	.00
	Post 1	156.91	21.61	130			
	Post 2	176.22	25.23	130	Quad= 2.03	1,129	.02
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	144.10	22.96	130	Linear= 61.45	1,129	.00
	Post 1	165.65	26.03	130			
	Post 2	171.02	32.70	130	Quad= 16.18	1,129	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	140.24	21.27	131	Linear= 385.27	.00	.00
	Post 1	157.63	20.35	131			
	Post 2	177.01	28.10	131	Quad= .85	.358	.36

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	151.24	14.79	82	Linear= 183.02	1,81	.00
	Post 1	162.94	17.05	82			
	Post 2	180.01	22.62	82	Quad= 4.03	1,81	.05
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	144.89	14.50	91	Linear= 143.86	1,90	.00
	Post 1	157.98	23.20	91			
	Post 2	178.91	35.19	91	Quad= 4.41	1,90	.04
Female							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	141.80	20.89	137	Linear= 424.96	1,136	.00
	Post 1	159.82	20.01	137			
	Post 2	177.79	22.06	137	Quad= .00	1,136	.98
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	144.89	23.89	138	Linear= 67.33	1,137	.00
	Post 1	165.46	25.76	138			
	Post 2	173.38	32.23	138	Quad= 10.94	1,137	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	142.14	21.65	137	Linear= 365.43	1,136	.00
	Post 1	160.66	20.64	137			
	Post 2	178.11	25.52	137	Quad= .260	1,136	.00
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	152.88	13.56	96	Linear= 213.47	1,95	.00
	Post 1	165.52	15.16	96			
	Post 2	181.13	22.21	96	Quad= 1.48	1,95	.23
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	147.48	15.77	100	Linear= 154.48	1,99	.00
	Post 1	162.74	21.48	100			
	Post 2	181.54	34.77	100	Quad= .10	1,99	.32

Grade Level

Table A10. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Grade Level

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
K-2							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	134.81	16.82	98	Linear= 287.85	1,97	.00
	Post 1	154.15	20.92	98			
	Post 2	170.21	23.34	98	Quad= 1.39	1,97	.24
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	138.74	15.86	99	Linear= 235.25	1,98	.00
	Post 1	156.18	22.34	99			
	Post 2	176.98	28.93	99	Quad= .84	1,98	.36
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	138.35	13.31	98	Linear= 280.59	1,97	.00
	Post 1	153.59	13.93	98			
	Post 2	173.16	23.32	98	Quad= 3.54	1,97	.06
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	143.93	10.57	82	Linear= 135.46	1,81	.00
	Post 1	153.90	11.76	82			
	Post 2	170.30	20.93	82	Quad= 5.99	1,81	.02
ITBS Language Test	Pre	137.27	11.17	95	Linear= 195.74	1,94	.00
	Post 1	148.37	18.22	95			
	Post 2	165.28	22.34	95	Quad= 2.76	1,94	.10
1-3							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	157.44	19.56	96	Linear= 216.19	1,95	.00
	Post 1	170.35	19.12	96			
	Post 2	186.26	23.90	96	Quad= .991	1,95	.32
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	162.26	23.04	96	Linear= .953	1,95	.33
	Post 1	182.03	23.04	96			
	Post 2	167.52	40.75	96	Quad= 40.23	1,95	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	160.15	14.89	97	Linear= 196.40	1,96	.00
	Post 1	175.76	19.09	97			
	Post 2	193.76	28.79	97	Quad= .904	1,96	.34
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	159.13	12.99	96	Linear= 285.15	1,95	.00
	Post 1	173.24	13.75	96			
	Post 2	189.42	19.66	96	Quad= .703	1,95	.40
ITBS Language Test	Pre	155.13	13.36	96	Linear= 149.64	1,95	.00
	Post 1	172.45	19.55	96			
	Post 2	195.14	38.67	96	Quad= 2.02	1,95	.16

Free-Reduced Lunch Status

Table A11. Paired t-tests Results for Students by Free/Reduced Lunch Status

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Not eligible for free or reduced price lunch							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	146.45	21.93	132	Linear= 84.04	1,36	.00
	Post 1	162.74	22.59	132			
	Post 2	184.58	22.05	132	Quad= 2.78	1,36	.03
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	150.75	24.62	132	Linear= 40.65	1,131	.00
	Post 1	170.52	25.29	132			
	Post 2	175.34	33.91	132	Quad= 15.58	1,131	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	141.57	25.80	131	Linear= 471.90	1,130	.00
	Post 1	161.67	21.60	131			
	Post 2	184.54	27.93	131	Quad= 1.45	1,130	.23
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	154.30	15.16	80	Linear= 259.14	1,79	.00
	Post 1	166.81	14.96	80			
	Post 2	185.08	19.28	80	Quad= 7.50	1,79	.01
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	151.48	16.80	84	Linear= 213.84	1,83	.00
	Post 1	167.76	22.00	84			
	Post 2	192.58	35.58	84	Quad= 5.10	1,83	.03
Eligible for free or reduced price lunch							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	136.60	18.19	135	Linear= 371.34	1,134	.00
	Post 1	154.16	18.03	135			
	Post 2	169.64	22.83	135	Quad= .73	1,134	.40
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	138.45	20.49	136	Linear= 104.74	1,135	.00
	Post 1	160.73	25.54	136			
	Post 2	169.22	30.74	136	Quad= 11.62	1,135	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	140.87	19.21	137	Linear= 350.77	1,136	.00
	Post 1	156.80	19.21	137			
	Post 2	170.91	23.85	137	Quad= .88	1,136	.35
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	150.35	13.03	98	Linear= 167.24	1,97	.00
	Post 1	162.31	16.72	98			
	Post 2	176.97	24.05	98	Quad= .95	1,97	.33
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	142.14	12.42	107	Linear= 118.59	1,106	.00
	Post 1	154.75	21.06	107			
	Post 2	170.64	31.29	107	Quad= .88	1,106	.35

Limited English Proficient

Table A12. Paired t-tests Results for Students by Limited English Proficient Status

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Not limited English Proficient							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	143.57	21.32	219	Linear= 684.94	1,218	.00
	Post 1	160.48	21.13	219			
	Post 2	180.11	23.28	219	Quad= 1.83	1,218	.18
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	146.85	23.80	220	Linear= 84.00	1,219	.00
	Post 1	167.29	26.13	220			
	Post 2	172.70	33.10	220	Quad= 23.68	1,219	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	141.83	22.85	220	Linear= 672.41	1,219	.00
	Post 1	161.14	21.21	220			
	Post 2	180.36	27.52	220	Quad= .00	1,219	.96
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	153.35	13.98	150	Linear= 320.31	1,149	.00
	Post 1	165.06	16.38	150			
	Post 2	181.70	22.83	150	Quad= 5.78	1,149	.02
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	148.29	15.29	154	Linear= 229.02	1,153	.00
	Post 1	163.56	21.13	154			
	Post 2	183.11	36.81	154	Quad= 2.39	1,153	.12
Limited English Proficient							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	131.90	14.10	48	Linear= 113.25	1,47	.00
	Post 1	148.92	16.42	48			
	Post 2	162.96	19.94	48	Quad= .57	1,47	.45
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	133.75	18.07	48	Linear= 77.85	1,47	.00
	Post 1	157.58	23.06	48			
	Post 2	170.10	29.33	48	Quad= 3.25	1,47	.08
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	138.38	13.03	48	Linear= 115.59	1,47	.00
	Post 1	150.21	13.99	48			
	Post 2	164.79	18.33	48	Quad= 1.03	1,47	.32
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	145.54	13.25	28	Linear= 80.30	1,27	.00
	Post 1	160.43	13.85	28			
	Post 2	174.79	18.81	28	Quad= .03	1,27	.86
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	137.73	11.53	37	Linear= 84.04	1,36	.00
	Post 1	147.59	23.15	37			
	Post 2	168.55	22.31	37	Quad= 758.44	1,36	.10

Special Education Status

Table A13. Paired t-tests Results for Students by Special Education Status

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
No Individualized Education Plan							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	141.16	20.58	248	Linear= 754.15	1,247	.00
	Post 1	158.63	20.79	248			
	Post 2	177.14	23.29	248	Quad= .321	1,247	.57
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	144.59	23.71	249	Linear= 131.82	1,248	.00
	Post 1	165.80	26.00	249			
	Post 2	173.11	31.86	249	Quad= 24.82	1,248	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	141.46	21.43	248	Linear= 708.51	1,247	.00
	Post 1	159.37	20.61	248			
	Post 2	177.64	26.80	248	Quad= .054	1,247	.82
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	152.02	14.19	166	Linear= 349.36	1,165	.00
	Post 1	164.29	15.60	166			
	Post 2	180.09	22.66	166	Quad= 3.53	1,165	.06
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	146.18	15.18	177	Linear= 277.98	1,176	.00
	Post 1	160.74	22.09	177			
	Post 2	179.76	34.45	177	Quad= 2.96	1,176	.09
Individualized Education Plan							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	146.12	23.36	17	Linear= 33.07	1,16	.00
	Post 1	154.12	21.63	17			
	Post 2	172.76	28.68	17	Quad= 2.03	1,16	.17
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	142.18	19.70	17	Linear= 1.16	1,16	.30
	Post 1	160.12	24.08	17			
	Post 2	155.12	36.18	17	Quad= 2.15	1,16	.16
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	139.61	21.70	18	Linear= 35.85	1,17	.00
	Post 1	156.56	20.79	18			
	Post 2	176.56	28.46	18	Quad= .37	1,17	.55
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	153.58	13.65	12	Linear= 80.14	1,11	.00
	Post 1	164.92	17.75	12			
	Post 2	187.83	16.29	12	Quad= 4.06	1,11	.07
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	147.14	15.97	14	Linear= 21.65	1,13	.00
	Post 1	157.07	26.48	14			
	Post 2	186.95	41.10	14	Quad= 2.65	1,13	.13

Race/Ethnicity

Table A14. Paired t-tests Results for Students by Race/Ethnicity

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
White							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	147.21	23.62	112	Linear= 296.10	1,111	.00
	Post 1	161.71	23.48	112			
	Post 2	183.39	25.63	112	Quad= 5.42	1,111	.02
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	150.05	26.47	113	Linear= 22.71	1,112	.00
	Post 1	166.34	25.42	113			
	Post 2	171.16	35.91	113	Quad= 8.47	1,112	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	143.59	24.17	114	Linear= 326.78	1,113	.00
	Post 1	161.80	23.83	114			
	Post 2	184.31	30.54	114	Quad= 3.54	1,113	.06
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	152.56	14.60	81	Linear= 159.83	1,80	.00
	Post 1	162.78	15.28	81			
	Post 2	180.33	24.46	81	Quad= 10.50	1,80	.00
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	148.88	16.43	81	Linear= 132.52	1,80	.00
	Post 1	164.95	19.55	81			
	Post 2	187.65	40.72	81	Quad= 3.15	1,80	.08
Hispanic							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	132.85	14.58	59	Linear= 150.47	1,58	.00
	Post 1	149.25	16.47	59			
	Post 2	162.81	20.34	59	Quad= .76	1,58	.39
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	134.36	19.02	59	Linear= 75.47	1,58	.00
	Post 1	156.76	26.40	59			
	Post 2	168.75	30.38	59	Quad= 3.10	1,58	.08
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	138.27	15.93	59	Linear= 183.05	1,58	.00
	Post 1	151.98	16.31	59			
	Post 2	165.54	19.41	59	Quad= .00	1,58	.96
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	148.39	13.26	38	Linear= 142.83	1,37	.00
	Post 1	160.32	18.97	38			
	Post 2	176.24	19.07	38	Quad= .90	1,37	.35
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	140.09	11.57	45	Linear= 85.82	1,44	.00
	Post 1	149.89	22.43	45			
	Post 2	168.67	22.60	45	Quad= 3.10	1,44	.09

Table A14 Cont. Paired t-tests Results for Students by Race/Ethnicity

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Black							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	141.04	18.51	79	Linear= 291.04	1,78	.00
	Post 1	160.23	18.31	79			
	Post 2	177.73	19.42	79	Quad= .321	1,78	.57
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	145.05	20.34	79	Linear= 56.80	1,78	.00
	Post 1	171.39	25.11	79			
	Post 2	175.67	29.86	79	Quad= 16.13	1,78	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	141.97	20.86	78	Linear= 237.10	1,77	.00
	Post 1	161.50	17.50	78			
	Post 2	177.72	24.34	78	Quad= 1.06	1,77	.31
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	154.16	12.97	51	Linear= 94.49	1,50	.00
	Post 1	169.96	14.13	51			
	Post 2	183.39	20.83	51	Quad= .38	1,50	.54
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	147.89	14.79	57	Linear= 75.40	1,50	.00
	Post 1	162.77	24.08	57			
	Post 2	179.66	32.77	57	Quad= .14	1,50	.71

Reading Levels

Table A15. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Reading/Language Arts Skill Level at Pretest

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Low Level (Bottom 33%)							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	128.13	11.70	107	Linear= 437.51	1,106	.00
	Post 1	146.95	15.94	107			
	Post 2	168.03	20.32	107	Quad= .62	1,106	.43
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	129.83	13.69	108	Linear= 397.22	1,107	.00
	Post 1	151.60	20.00	108			
	Post 2	168.96	23.88	108	Quad= 1.73	1,107	.19
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	121.13	11.36	107	Linear= 462.93	1,106	.00
	Post 1	145.64	13.22	107			
	Post 2	163.26	17.62	107	Quad= 8.07	1,106	.01
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	139.75	8.19	40	Linear= 39.54	1,39	.00
	Post 1	148.95	11.46	40			
	Post 2	163.63	22.55	40	Quad= 1.60	1,39	.21

Table A12 Continued. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Reading/Language Arts Skill Level at Pretest

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
ITBS Language Subtest	Pre	133.27	6.70	48	Linear= 79.52	1,47	.00
	Post 1	142.00	15.05	48			
	Post 2	158.44	20.28	48	Quad= 2.48	1,47	.12
Average Level (mid 33%)							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	135.34	9.85	73	Linear= 204.48	1,72	.00
	Post 1	154.08	15.85	73			
	Post 2	171.48	22.05	73	Quad= .15	1,72	.70
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	137.27	13.38	73	Linear= 130.36	1,72	.00
	Post 1	160.41	21.70	73			
	Post 2	174.67	27.97	73	Quad= 3.70	1,72	.06
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	141.59	3.60	74	Linear= 175.88	1,73	.00
	Post 1	154.27	10.60	74			
	Post 2	171.09	19.84	74	Quad= 3.23	1,73	.08
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	146.23	8.37	53	Linear= 134.60	1,52	.00
	Post 1	158.57	11.06	53			
	Post 2	173.42	16.44	53	Quad= .71	1,52	.41
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	139.47	9.91	57	Linear= 77.54	1,56	.00
	Post 1	152.93	15.65	57			
	Post 2	166.06	23.42	57	Quad= .00	1,56	.95
High level (top 33%)							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	163.01	18.72	87	Linear= 196.51	1,86	.00
	Post 1	176.11	17.91	87			
	Post 2	192.75	20.82	87	Quad= 1.37	1,86	.25
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	168.79	20.14	87	Linear= .86	1,86	.36
	Post 1	187.18	20.99	87			
	Post 2	174.25	43.32	87	Quad= 27.27	1,86	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	165.59	12.44	87	Linear= 190.55	1,86	.00
	Post 1	180.01	17.58	87			
	Post 2	200.68	26.00	87	Quad= 5.05	1,86	.03
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	161.62	12.64	85	Linear= 284.92	1,84	.00
	Post 1	175.16	12.44	85			
	Post 2	193.09	17.91	85	Quad= 2.88	1,84	.09
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	157.98	12.72	86	Linear= 181.36	1,85	.00
	Post 1	175.78	19.12	86			
	Post 2	201.91	35.45	86	Quad= 4.75	1,85	.03

Implementation Fidelity Levels

Table A16. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Level of Implementation

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
Low Fidelity of Implementation							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	129.94	14.47	47	Linear= 285.24	1,46	.00
	Post 1	153.70	14.19	47			
	Post 2	177.62	19.29	47	Quad= .00	1,46	.98
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	132.89	18.71	47	Linear= 308.93	1,46	.00
	Post 1	161.94	21.19	47			
	Post 2	177.68	23.76	47	Quad= 6.18	1,46	.02
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	125.75	19.24	48	Linear= 197.79	1,47	.00
	Post 1	151.10	16.42	48			
	Post 2	165.46	18.36	48	Quad= 8.45	1,47	.01
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	158.40	9.84	5	Linear= 29.91	1,4	.01
	Post 1	167.80	18.51	5			
	Post 2	185.00	11.40	5	Quad= .45	1,4	.54
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	158.00	19.61	5	Linear= 3.07	1,4	.16
	Post 1	170.60	17.94	5			
	Post 2	183.33	44.80	5	Quad= .00	1,4	.99
Moderate Fidelity of Implementation							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	149.60	25.54	97	Linear= 260.87	1,96	.00
	Post 1	165.71	23.33	97			
	Post 2	183.54	26.41	97	Quad= .29	1,96	.60
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	154.13	26.52	98	Linear= 4.31	1,97	.04
	Post 1	170.92	27.40	98			
	Post 2	165.29	38.02	98	Quad= 16.93	1,97	.00
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	150.70	21.26	98	Linear= 252.53	1,97	.00
	Post 1	167.66	22.65	98			
	Post 2	191.18	31.66	98	Quad= 6.55	1,97	.01
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	152.45	15.59	96	Linear= 360.91	1,95	.00
	Post 1	163.30	16.42	96			
	Post 2	184.22	20.01	96	Quad= 30.17	1,95	.00
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	147.83	17.32	96	Linear= 273.07	1,95	.00
	Post 1	164.65	21.44	96			
	Post 2	191.70	37.89	96	Quad= 10.87	1,95	.00

Table A16 Continued. Paired t-test Results for Treatment Students by Level of Implementation

Test	Time	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	F	df	Sig.
High Level of implementation							
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Pre	139.46	15.25	123	Linear= 334.01	1,122	.00
	Post 1	154.44	19.33	123			
	Post 2	171.67	21.57	123	Quad= .92	1,122	.34
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Pre	141.28	19.24	123	Linear= 194.51	1,122	.00
	Post 1	162.65	25.66	123			
	Post 2	175.69	29.60	123	Quad= 5.40	1,122	.02
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Pre	139.67	18.39	122	Linear= 360.09	1,121	.00
	Post 1	155.55	17.77	122			
	Post 2	171.40	19.99	122	Quad= .00	1,121	.99
ITBS Spelling subtest	Pre	151.31	12.35	77	Linear= 98.01	1,76	.00
	Post 1	165.39	15.59	77			
	Post 2	175.83	24.79	77	Quad= 1.28	1,76	.26
ITBS Language subtest	Pre	143.90	11.81	90	Linear= 87.15	1,89	.00
	Post 1	155.46	22.68	90			
	Post 2	167.94	26.14	90	Quad= .05	1,89	.83

Analysis of Program Effects

As described in more detail in the body of the main report, it is important to understand that there were several differences and similarities between *Journeys* and control curricula/classes. Given the similarities observed and the fact that the duration of the study and exposure to the program occurred during two school years, small to medium effect sizes, if any, were expected. Expanding the study over the course of two school years allowed for year 2 teachers to become better accustomed to the Journeys program and therefore, to be more familiar with the program, thereby reducing the learning curve experienced by teachers using a new curriculum during the first year. Indeed, it was for this reason that *cumulative* student exposure was examined to determine the sustainability of effects observed in Year 1.

Independent Sample t-tests

Table A17 describes the means for the treatment and control groups for the five outcomes at 2013 post-testing. Independent sample t-tests were conducted for each of the outcomes. Statistically significant differences in favor of the treatment group were obtained for two subtests. However, these differences do not account for clustering. The multilevel models described below incorporate dependency issues described above as a result of the hierarchical nature of the data.

Table A17. Sample Size, Means, Standard Deviations, and t-test (Student Level) Results for Assessments at 2013 Post-testing (Year 2)

Test	Group	Mean	Std. Deviation	N	t	df	Sig.
ITBS Vocabulary Subtest	Control	168.06	22.86	313	-3.17	697	.002*
	Journeys	173.72	23.99	386			
ITBS Word Analysis Subtest	Control	175.99	26.82	313	-0.79	697	.43
	Journeys	177.65	28.13	386			
ITBS Reading Comprehension Subtest	Control	171.76	23.35	313	-2.28	698	.02*
	Journeys	176.07	26.02	387			
ITBS Spelling subtest	Control	173.47	21.04	309	-1.35	681	.18
	Journeys	175.79	23.32	374			
ITBS Language subtest	Control	169.37	27.58	309	-0.78	682	.44
	Journeys	167.54	32.90	375			

* = $p < .05$

Multilevel Models

Three-level multilevel models were implemented to examine program impacts. The three level model focuses on both the *levels* in outcomes at baseline and *change* in outcomes from baseline to follow-ups²⁵. In this model, the first level incorporates changes over time for each individual. The second level includes student level covariates. The third level incorporates teacher/school level information. This first set of initial models examines only the direct effects of the program (see Appendix B for mathematical description of the model). Separate multilevel models were run for each of the following assessments.

Outcome measures in the model include:

- ITBS Reading Comprehension, Vocabulary, Word Analysis, Spelling, and Language
- Student level covariates in the model include:
- Group (Treatment=1; Control=0)

Other individual level covariates including Limited English Proficiency status, special education status and free/reduced lunch status were also available. However, due to small sample

²⁵ Note that no significant baseline differences were observed via the multilevel models for the final analytical sample.

sizes and/or missing data for these variables, these covariates were excluded from the multilevel analysis as this would reduce the analytical sample. Teacher level covariates were not included in the model given the similarities observed on various teacher characteristics measured at baseline, however school was included at level 3 to account for variations in school settings.

The direct effects multilevel model was run on each of the measures noted above. Table A18 summarizes the results of the main program effects. Note that each measure in Table A18 corresponds to the program effect coefficients estimated for that dependent variable from a separate multilevel model. Significant differences (at the .05 level) in the slope (growth rates) were observed between the treatment and control groups for the following measures: Reading Comprehension, Vocabulary, and Reading Words (from year 1 only²⁶). Marginally significant effects (at the .10 level) were observed for Spelling and Word Analysis. In all these cases, growth was greater in the treatment group as compared to the control group.

Note that unlike the results presented in Table A17, these analyses incorporate student and teacher/school level information. When this is done via multilevel modeling, significant differences are obtained as described above. The effect sizes are also calculated; the effect sizes for the effect of Journeys on student performance ranged from .15 to .39.

Table A18. Main Program Effects from Multilevel Models

Outcome Measures	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	df	Sig. Level	Effect Size ²⁷
ITBS Comprehension Scale Score - Pretest	2.95	4.27	0.690	639	0.49	
ITBS Comprehension Scale Score – Slope Year 1	2.44	1.61	1.513	809	0.13	
ITBS Comprehension Scale Score – Slope Year 2	3.23	1.42	2.277	809	0.02*	.17
ITBS Vocabulary Scale Score - Pretest	4.86	3.27	1.486	639	0.14	
ITBS Vocabulary Scale Score – Slope Year 1	3.18	1.80	1.769	809	0.08**	.16
ITBS Vocabulary Scale Score – Slope Year 2	3.66	1.58	2.316	809	0.02*	.19
ITBS Word Analysis Scale Score - Pretest	2.23	3.93	0.568	639	0.57	
ITBS Word Analysis Scale Score - Slope Year 1	8.21	2.10	3.417	809	<0.001*	.37
ITBS Word Analysis Scale Score - Slope Year 2	3.60	2.11	1.703	809	0.09**	.16
ITBS Spelling Scale Score - Pretest	-0.25	4.46	-0.056	639	0.96	
ITBS Spelling Scale Score– Slope Year 1	2.66	1.58	1.678	809	0.09**	.15
ITBS Spelling Scale Score– Slope Year 2	2.35	1.40	1.686	809	0.09**	.15
ITBS Language Scale Score - Pretest	0.93	5.22	0.178	639	0.86	
ITBS Language Scale Score – Slope Year 1	2.49	1.56	1.600	809	0.11	
ITBS Language Scale Score – Slope Year 2	-1.64	3.75	-0.436	809	0.66	
FROM YEAR1 ONLY (K): ITBS Reading Words Scale Score - Pretest	-1.08	2.85	-0.379	997	0.71	
FROM YEAR1 ONLY (K): ITBS Reading Words Scale Score – Slope Year 1	5.06	1.37	3.681	911	<0.001*	0.39

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$

²⁶ The Reading Words subtest is only administered at the Kindergarten grade level. Kindergarten classes were only examined in year 1.

²⁷ Formula for calculating the effect size is in Appendix A.

Multilevel Models of Subgroup Effects

Subgroup effects were analyzed via multilevel modeling. The main effects multilevel models were re-specified to re-estimate program effects for the following subgroups: gender (*female*), ethnicity, grade, free/reduced lunch status, special education status, Limited English Proficiency, and reading ability level. Given strong correlations between the various interaction terms, multicollinearities in the model and missing data, the subgroup effects were obtained by adding the interaction term(s) corresponding to each subgroup separately. Thus, separate models were run to obtain subgroup effects. As well, time was dummy coded so that growth estimates for year 1 (slope Post 1) and overall across both years (slope Post 2) could be determined. The focus of the present research was on the overall growth (slope Post 2).

It is important to view this analysis as exploratory for a number of reasons: (i) the treatment and control groups were not randomized by subgroups; (ii) the sample sizes for a number of the subgroups are quite small; and (iii) differences were obtained between the treatment and control groups at baseline for some of the subgroups. Tables A19-A23 summarize the results of the subgroup analyses for the key outcome measures. Only statistical significant results are presented. In addition, to ease in the presentation of findings, only coefficients associated with the interaction between subgroup designation and group are presented in the tables. Growth for both Year 1 (Post 1 coefficients) and overall growth across both study years (Post 2) are presented in the tables below.

In terms of overall growth (Post 2), significant effects (at the $p < .05$ or $p < .10$ levels) were obtained for the majority of subgroups in favor of the Journeys group. Specifically, Hispanics and African Americans showed positive effects on comprehension. White students showed positive effects on vocabulary and word analysis skills. First and third grade students showed positive program effects on spelling, 2nd grade students showed positive effects on vocabulary, and 3rd grade students showed positive effects on comprehension and word analysis. High reading level students (those performing over the 66th percentile at baseline) also showed positive effects on both the word analysis and spelling subtests. Among low level students, positive impacts were observed on vocabulary. And among average level students, positive effects were observed in vocabulary and comprehension. Students with Limited English Proficiency and those receiving free/reduced lunch showed positive program effects on comprehension and spelling. Results from Year 1 growth coefficients (Post 1) show additional significant program effects as shown below.

In sum, these results suggest that Journeys may be more effective with certain subgroups (e.g., free/reduced lunch students) as compared to other elementary programs. That said, due to the lack of consistency of results within subgroups (e.g., students in subgroups showed better performance on, at most, two of the five measures) and small sample sizes associated with some subgroups, no definitive conclusions about the impact of Journeys on subgroups of students should be made.

Table A19. Subgroup Effects from Multilevel Models: Reading Comprehension

	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
African American				
Baseline	1.81	3.82	0.473	0.64
Post 1	3.37	2.77	1.217	0.22
Post 2	4.42	2.65	1.668	0.09**
Hispanic				
Baseline	2.28	3.32	0.687	0.49
Post 1	3.95	1.86	2.130	0.03*
Post 2	4.78	2.84	1.681	0.09**
Grade (3rd)				
Baseline	3.91	3.47	1.126	0.26
Post 1	3.91	2.21	1.765	0.08**
Post 2	5.47	2.05	2.672	0.01*
Free-Reduced Lunch				
Baseline	-4.13	2.49	-1.661	0.10
Post 1	4.26	2.19	1.945	0.05**
Post 2	3.77	1.95	1.939	0.05**
Limited English Proficiency				
Baseline	-6.11	2.36	-2.582	0.01
Post 1	6.06	2.58	2.350	0.02*
Post 2	6.98	3.82	1.828	0.07**
Low Level Readers				
Baseline	-2.40	2.40	-1.001	0.32
Post 1	5.08	2.29	2.223	0.03*
Post 2	2.62	3.17	0.826	0.41
Average Level Readers				
Baseline	-1.06	1.64	-0.644	0.52
Post 1	1.90	1.83	1.043	0.30
Post 2	5.05	3.00	1.685	0.09**

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$

Table A20. Subgroup Effects from Multilevel Models: Vocabulary

	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
White				
Baseline	0.86	3.42	0.251	0.80
Post 1	0.57	2.93	0.193	0.85
Post 2	5.32	2.63	2.023	0.04*
Grade (2nd)				
Baseline	4.09	3.69	1.109	.27
Post 1	6.63	2.67	2.478	.01*
Post 2	6.44	2.35	2.74	.01*
Limited English Proficiency				
Baseline	-2.68	3.14	-0.853	0.39
Post 1	7.23	3.63	1.992	0.047*
Post 2	5.28	3.86	1.368	0.17
Female				
Baseline	-0.80	2.44	-0.329	0.74
Post 1	5.72	2.58	2.215	0.03*
Post 2	3.25	2.30	1.413	0.16
Low Level Readers				
Baseline	-2.78	2.97	-0.937	0.35
Post 1	9.19	3.57	2.571	0.01*
Post 2	7.41	2.93	2.531	0.01*
Average Level Readers				
Baseline	1.14	2.67	0.43	0.67
Post 1	3.50	3.24	1.080	0.28
Post 2	6.14	2.74	2.242	0.03*

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$ **Table A21. Subgroup Effects from Multilevel Models: Spelling (1-3)**

	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
African American				
Baseline	-1.59	2.83	-0.562	0.58
Post 1	6.05	2.59	2.340	0.02*
Post 2	2.30	3.11	0.737	0.46
Grade (1 st)				
Baseline	-8.71	7.01	-1.243	0.21
Post 1	20.01	10.46	1.913	0.06**
Post 2	10.54	5.30	1.989	0.047*
Grade (3 rd)				
Baseline	0.12	5.09	0.024	0.98
Post 1	3.66	2.18	1.675	0.09**
Post 2	4.17	2.02	2.060	0.04*
Limited English Proficiency				
Baseline	-3.73	2.23	-1.678	0.09
Post 1	6.32	2.33	2.709	0.007*
Post 2	8.40	4.00	2.099	0.04*
Free / Reduced Lunch				
Baseline	-1.41	2.36	-0.599	0.55
Post 1	4.25	2.14	1.984	0.048*
Post 2	3.73	1.90	1.960	0.050*
High Level Readers				
Baseline	-5.37	2.91	-1.847	0.07
Post 1	2.95	2.40	1.231	0.22
Post 2	5.93	2.18	2.715	0.01*

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$

Table A22. Subgroup Effects from Multilevel Models: Word Analysis

	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
White				
Baseline	-6.31	4.19	-1.505	0.133
Post 1	8.71	3.94	2.208	0.03*
Post 2	11.43	3.52	3.244	0.001*
African American				
Baseline	0.05	4.83	0.010	0.99
Post 1	9.01	5.01	1.800	0.07**
Post 2	-1.69	4.51	-0.374	0.71
Hispanic				
Baseline	1.77	4.70	0.377	0.71
Post 1	8.30	4.53	1.829	0.07**
Post 2	1.05	3.92	0.267	0.79
Grade (3 rd)				
Baseline	-6.67	4.38	-1.521	0.129
Post 1	17.32	3.28	5.287	<0.001*
Post 2	9.17	3.03	3.022	0.003*
Free-Reduced Lunch				
Baseline	-4.65	3.17	-1.467	0.14
Post 1	8.76	3.28	2.673	0.01*
Post 2	-0.26	2.91	-0.090	0.93
Female				
Baseline	-2.21	3.02	-0.730	0.466
Post 1	9.57	3.47	2.760	0.006*
Post 2	2.29	3.08	0.744	0.457
Limited English Proficiency				
Baseline	-0.11	4.71	-0.023	0.98
Post 1	13.47	5.84	2.305	0.02*
Post 2	5.31	4.98	1.066	0.29
High Level Readers				
Baseline	-3.32	3.44	-0.966	0.334
Post 1	15.41	3.60	4.277	<0.001*
Post 2	9.49	3.29	2.886	0.004*

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$

Table A23. Subgroup Effects from Multilevel Models: Language

	Coefficient	Std. Error	t-ratio	Sig. Level
Grade (1 st)				
Baseline	-3.42	7.21	-0.474	0.64
Post 1	29.87	11.73	2.547	0.01*
Post 2	4.68	5.88	0.795	0.43
Limited English Proficiency				
Baseline	-2.67	3.65	-0.621	0.54
Post 1	9.33	4.46	2.092	0.04*
Post 2	3.744	3.81	0.983	0.33
Low Level Readers				
Baseline	-0.31	3.84	-0.081	0.94
Post 1	4.57	2.63	1.735	0.08**
Post 2	-1.94	4.61	-0.421	0.67

* $p < .05$, ** $p < .10$

Appendix B

Mathematical Details of Multilevel Models

The Structure of the Three-level Multilevel Model for Program Effects

The three-level multilevel model had the following structure (note that the variable names are described in the text):

Level-1 Model

$$\text{OUTCOME}_{ij} = \pi_{0ij} + \pi_{1ij}*(\text{TIME2}_{ij}) + \pi_{2ij}*(\text{TIME3}_{ij}) + e_{ij}$$

Level-2 Model

$$\begin{aligned}\pi_{0ij} &= \beta_{00j} + \beta_{01j}*(\text{GROUP}_{ij}) + r_{0ij} \\ \pi_{1ij} &= \beta_{10j} + \beta_{11j}*(\text{GROUP}_{ij}) \\ \pi_{2ij} &= \beta_{20j} + \beta_{21j}*(\text{GROUP}_{ij})\end{aligned}$$

Level-3 Model

$$\begin{aligned}\beta_{00j} &= \gamma_{000} + \gamma_{001}(\text{SCHOOLA}_j) + \gamma_{002}(\text{SCHOOLB}_j) + \gamma_{003}(\text{SCHOOLC}_j) + \gamma_{004}(\text{SCHOOLD}_j) \\ &\quad + \gamma_{005}(\text{SCHOOLE}_j) + u_{00j} \\ \beta_{01j} &= \gamma_{010} \\ \beta_{10j} &= \gamma_{100} + \gamma_{101}(\text{SCHOOLA}_j) + \gamma_{102}(\text{SCHOOLB}_j) + \gamma_{103}(\text{SCHOOLC}_j) + \gamma_{104}(\text{SCHOOLD}_j) \\ &\quad + \gamma_{105}(\text{SCHOOLE}_j) \\ \beta_{11j} &= \gamma_{110} \\ \beta_{20j} &= \gamma_{200} + \gamma_{201}(\text{SCHOOLA}_j) + \gamma_{202}(\text{SCHOOLB}_j) + \gamma_{203}(\text{SCHOOLC}_j) + \gamma_{204}(\text{SCHOOLD}_j) \\ &\quad + \gamma_{205}(\text{SCHOOLE}_j) \\ \beta_{21j} &= \gamma_{210}\end{aligned}$$

Note that γ_{110} and γ_{210} are measures of program impact for Year 1 and Year 2 (overall) respectively.

Effect Size

Following the guidelines set forth by the What Works Clearinghouse (2008), the effect sizes were calculated using the following formula:

Hedges's g for intervention effects estimated from HLM analyses is defined in a similar way to that based on student-level ANCOVA: adjusted group mean difference divided by unadjusted pooled within-group SD. Specifically,

$$g = \frac{\gamma}{\sqrt{\frac{(n_1 - 1)S_1^2 + (n_2 - 1)S_2^2}{(n_1 + n_2 - 2)}}}$$

where γ is the HLM coefficient for the intervention's effect, which represents the group mean difference adjusted for both level-1 and level-2 covariates, if any; n_1 and n_2 are the student sample sizes, and S_1 and S_2 are the posttest student-level SDs for the intervention group and the comparison group, respectively.

Appendix C:

Journeys Implementation Guidelines

Journeys RCT Study ***Implementation Guidelines***

Introduction

Welcome and thank you for participating in the Randomized Control Trial being conducted by PRES Associates on the Houghton Mifflin Harcourt *Journeys* literacy program. We hope your experience with our study will be rewarding and enjoyable. Not only will you contribute to cutting-edge research, but you will also benefit from targeted professional development provided by Houghton Mifflin Harcourt professional training specialists.

We realize that it can be challenging to change former teaching practices, implement a new reading program and understand that there may be associated obstacles and challenges with the beginning of implementation of any new program. For these reasons, we want and need to hear from you so that we can help guide you through any initial challenges you might encounter. In fact, it is critical that any problems you come across be addressed as soon as possible to ensure that this program is being implemented to its full potential. Feel free to contact PRES Associates via e-mail at studies@presassociates.com if you have any questions, problems or concerns. We greatly appreciate the time and effort you will contribute towards making this study a success

The following provides answers to some common questions teachers may have related to this study. Please read through all of these and should you have further questions, please contact PRES Associates.

Why Is This Research Being Done?

As you are aware, the No Child Left Behind Act (NCLB) of 2001 requires that educational materials and strategies used by educators in the classroom *must be proven by scientific research to improve student achievement in the classroom*. Houghton Mifflin Harcourt has developed a strong research model for determining that their programs are scientifically-based. As part of this research agenda, Houghton Mifflin Harcourt has contracted with PRES Associates²⁸, an external educational research firm, to conduct a randomized control trial (RCT) focused on a rigorous evaluation the effectiveness of the *Journeys* Literacy program in helping elementary school students (grades K-3) attain critical reading/language arts skills.

²⁸ PRES Associates is an external, independent, educational research firm with an established track record in conducting large-scale, rigorous evaluations on the effectiveness of curriculum materials.

Why Do I Need Training?

It takes more than a good curricular program to provide effective and meaningful lessons in reading/language arts. It also takes good teachers with a thorough understanding of the curriculum, who are supported by professional development, school administrators, and parents/guardians. To this end, it is hoped that through the professional development training session provided by Houghton Mifflin Harcourt on the use of its reading/language arts program, all teachers participating in the study will gain the knowledge and skills to successfully implement this program right from the start.

As you will soon learn, this reading program provides numerous teaching resources, support services and materials. In order to implement this program successfully, it is essential that teachers have a thorough understanding of the resources provided by the *Journeys* program. Rather than having teachers figure it out on their own, professional trainers will guide you through this process, offering examples of when to use certain materials, how to manage and supplement classroom instruction, what types of assessments to administer, and so forth.

Why Do I Need To Follow These Implementation Guidelines?

The Teacher Implementation Guidelines were developed as part of the *Journeys* Randomized Control Trial (RCT). The guidelines are designed for teachers to use when implementing the new program in their class(es). The guidelines point out key program components that *must* be implemented during reading instruction. These core program components have the greatest influence on student learning and performance, and therefore should be implemented. In addition, it is critical to ensure that all teachers are implementing a similar instructional model. That is, if teachers are modifying the program to an extent that it no longer resembles the original program, the study will not provide accurate information on the effects of the *Journeys* program. In sum, by providing these implementation guidelines, we are attempting to (1) maximize the potential of this reading program to help your students, and (2) ensure that the program is being implemented with fidelity across all teachers using the program. To reiterate, *it is essential that all teachers using the program fully apply the following implementation guidelines as prescribed*. That being said, there are optional parts to the program as well as ancillary resources that provide you with the flexibility you need to address unique student needs or contexts. *We trust your professional judgment and ask that you try to implement the program as best you possibly can while meeting your students' instructional needs.*

Again, thank you for your participation in this study. You are an integral part of this endeavor and we appreciate your assistance. We look forward to working with you.

IMPLEMENTATION GUIDELINES

I. PACING

There are 6 Units. Each Unit in Journeys is organized into five lessons. Each lesson focuses on specific vocabulary words, a target skill and a target strategy. In general you should refer to the Suggested Weekly Plan in your TE as a guideline for pacing your lesson. **It is suggested that one lesson be completed in 5 days of regular classroom instruction.** If you have difficulty with this pacing, please inform PRES Associates so that we can arrange for support.

II. TEACHING THE LESSON

Each lesson is organized around Whole Group Reading activities, Small Group Reading activities and Whole Group Language Arts Activities. **Items in bold below are critical core instructional activities that have been identified as necessary for optimal use of the Journeys program and as a study participant we will need you to incorporate these instructional activities into your lessons. Note that for some components there is flexibility in how the material is covered.** *Items italicized below have been identified as optional activities, and are not required for use as part of the study.* If you are able to incorporate them great, if not, that's ok too. Review the Suggested Weekly Plan and refer to the daily activities to structure Whole Group and Small Group Instruction while paying attention to the items in the Grab n Go.

The following guidelines have been prepared for 1.5 hours (90 minutes) of reading activities (Whole Group and Small Group) and 30 minutes of language arts (grammar, writing, spelling). This is the minimum time allotted for these activities in typical elementary schools. However, if your school allows for more (or less) time, please communicate this with the trainer and PRES Associates so that suggestions can be provided on pacing. **Note: Times are approximations and are only provided to help your instruction.**

Note: The listing below may vary for different lessons (e.g., Phonics may come after Comprehension) or different grade levels (e.g., Daily High Frequency words not in 3rd grade). However, we ask that you complete these components as they appear in your TE.

A. Whole Group Reading Activities (Approximately 45 minutes)

- **The Big Idea and Essential Question** appear throughout each lesson. Make sure to discuss these when directed in your TE.

Day 1

- ➔ **Opening Routines** – This activity is meant as a quick “wake-up” for students, and should take no more than 5-10 minutes. Point out the day's goals and try to complete at least the Daily Phonemic Awareness/Phonics and Daily High Frequency words components, but if there is sufficient time also complete the Daily Vocabulary Boost.
- ➔ **Teacher Read Aloud** - There are typically three skill areas that appear: a) Modeling Fluency, b) Vocabulary, and c) Listening Comprehension. We ask that you

instruct/demonstrate at least one skill area. What is important is that the *teacher* read the entire selection, modeling fluency and then *following* the reading, the teacher can point out vocabulary and/or listening comprehension questions. In short, how this section is completed is left to the discretion of the teacher but should be based on student needs. This section should take approximately 10-15 minutes depending on how many skill areas are taught.

- ➔ **Words to Know / Vocabulary** – High Frequency words/Target vocabulary words are identified and repeated throughout the lesson and will follow the student through the Leveled Readers. There are several options for introducing the vocabulary (e.g., may use the Vocabulary in Context Cards and corresponding Routine Activities (Grab N Go), Practice Book, show words on Smart Board, etc.) – you may use any Journeys method for this section. This should take approximately 10 minutes.
- ➔ **Phonemic Awareness (Grades K-2; Letter Naming-K) and/or Phonics:** This section should also take approximately 10 minutes. Teachers may need to skip subsections (e.g., Apply or Guided Practice) depending on time – this is ok because Phonemic Awareness/Phonics is taught every day.
 - **NOTE:** A *Decodable Reader* (Grades K-2) lesson may also show in your TE. It is recommended that these activities be completed in small groups and only for those students in need of additional phonics practice. That said, if there is sufficient time left and you feel such skills are needed, you may teach this section as directed.

Day 2

- ➔ **Opening Routines** – Try to keep to 5 minutes.
- ➔ **Phonemic Awareness (Grades K-2; Letter Naming-K) and/or Phonics** – approximately 10 minutes.
- ➔ *Develop Background* – *While this activity is optional, please note that if you have struggling readers or do not have the background, it is strongly recommended that you cover this section (approximately 10-15 minutes).*
- ➔ **Comprehension Skills/Strategies** – This is a very important element of the program, follow the structure as outline in the TE. This should take approximately 10 minutes, and teachers may need to skip subsections (e.g., Apply) depending on time.
- ➔ **Main Selection Story** – NOTE: For upper grades (2-3), it may be that the entire section is not completed on Day 2. This is ok and can be made up on Day 3. Remember that the main purpose of this section is that students get through the selection, while developing comprehension; this should not be hurried. In addition, there are various ways that the selection can be read: for example, you may use teacher read aloud, partner reading, silent reading, use the audio CD or Digital Path (online). See “Reading the Selection” for ideas on how the reading can be completed.
 - **Develop Comprehension** – Throughout the selection, Develop Comprehension questions are numbered. **Teachers should ask all the questions that have a checkmark next to them** as these pertain to the Target Skill. Teachers should pick and choose from the remaining questions, based on student needs.
 - **Stop and Think** – (Grades 1-3) This applies the concept taught in the lesson to the selection. Complete these as they appear in your TE

- **Your Turn** – This section promotes critical thinking skills. Note that you can do this section (or portions of) in small groups.

Day 3

- ➔ **Opening Routines** – 5-10 minutes
- ➔ **Phonemic Awareness** (Grades K-2; **Letter Naming-K**) and/or **Phonics** – approximately 10 minutes.
- ➔ **Fluency** – **This section should take approximately 5-10 minutes.**
 - **NOTE:** A *Decodable Reader* (Grades K-2) lesson may also show in your TE. It is recommended that these activities be completed in small groups and only for those students in need of additional phonics practice. That said, if there is sufficient time left and you feel such skills are needed, you may teach this section as directed.
- ➔ **At this point, if you did not complete all the Day 2 activities (e.g., need to finish the reading, ask important Develop Comprehension questions, complete Stop and Think or Your Turn), please use this time to complete. It is very important that students comprehend the story and Target Skill prior to Deepening Comprehension.**
- ➔ **Deepen Comprehension** – This section reinforces the comprehension target skill/concept. This may take approximately 10-20 minutes (use less time if making up for Day 2).

Day 4

- ➔ **Opening Routines** – 5-10 minutes
- ➔ **Phonemic Awareness** (Grades K-2; **Letter Naming-K**) and/or **Phonics** – approximately 10 minutes.
- ➔ **Paired Selection** – This section is usually titled “Connect to...” and includes **Making Connections**. This section addresses the Common Core Standards (making connections between text to text, text to self, text to world, etc.). Activity should take approximately 15-20 minutes.
- ➔ **Vocabulary Strategies** – This section helps students develop strategies to learn vocabulary words in the lesson. It should take approximately 10 minutes to complete.

Day 5

Following the Opening Routine, you can use this day to: 1) Connect and Extend, 2) complete an assessment, 3) review or reinforce concepts that students are struggling with (e.g., use ancillary materials), 4) make-up work -- do lesson/activities that were not completed during the week, or 5) treat it as an “off” day (e.g., if there was a holiday during the week). You can also choose not to do a small group on this day for additional time.

- ➔ **Opening Routines** – 5-10 minutes
- ➔ *Connect and Extend* – Extends the concepts taught in the week’s lesson.
- ➔ *Assessment* – (see Assessment section below)

B. Small Group Reading Activities (Approximately 45 minutes)

Small Group activities are an important part of the Journeys program and should occur 5 days of the week. It is recommended that teachers have 3 groups (15 minute rotation) or 4 groups maximum (10 minute rotation). For lower primary, you may need to first model small group instruction, have students practice, and provide immediate feedback until a routine process has been established (note this may take a few weeks during the beginning of the school year). If you are having difficulties in implementing small groups, please contact PRES Associates so that support can be provided.

The TE has outlined options for small group time in the Suggested Small Group Plan. You are free to use the suggested Journeys activities or other Journeys materials, along with small group activities that have worked for your students in the past. However, we do ask that you incorporate the bolded readers below into your groups.

- ➔ **Leveled Readers** – (On, Above, Below and ELL): provide leveled text with reinforcement of the comprehension skills and vocabulary taught in the main selection. Note: If you find that your above level readers are quickly and easily getting through the advanced readers, you should have them read a more advanced, authentic text (e.g., from library, book room, etc). Remember that the goal is for students to read fluently, with comprehension, and enjoy reading – feel free to challenge your students with other reading texts. Similarly, if the low level readers are not low enough, feel free to select other texts (e.g., leveled readers from the grade level below).
- ➔ *Vocabulary Readers (K-3)* —provide another exposure to target vocabulary in context; one for each selection in core (teaching support found behind small group tab). These should be used as needed to benefit those who are struggling with vocabulary.
- ➔ *Decodable Readers* – provide for additional phonics practice. These should be used as needed.
- ➔ *Individualized Instruction with Struggling Readers* – It is recommended that you use small groups to individualize instruction for struggling readers.
- ➔ *Ready Made Work Stations* – 3 Flip books per level with Word Study, Think and Write and Comprehension, and Fluency activity stations. The Journeys Digital Center can also be used as a station during small group activities.
- ➔ *Leveled Practice* – using the Practice Book for On Level Readers and resources from the Grab and Go! Kit for Struggling, Advanced and English Language Learners

C. Language Arts (Approximately 30 minutes)

- ➔ Language Arts activities occur on Days 1-4 of each lesson. **We ask that you complete sections of the Grammar, Spelling and Writing activities** (if you do not have time to complete all, you can cut sections such as “Apply”). You may also use a combination of whole group and small group instruction to complete. For example, you may choose to do Grammar as whole group (full 30 minutes), and do the writing as a small group center activity.

III. ASSESSMENTS

The Journey’s program includes many options for student progress monitoring. The TE has outlined assessment options that can be used with this program. You may choose any of the assessments noted below, however, we ask that you administer the Unit Benchmark Assessment (3 times over the course of the year).

- ➔ **Unit Benchmark Assessments** –Group administered, criterion referenced tests that measures unit reading and writing skills. Benchmark test (3X per year, Units 1, 3 & 5) track progress in essential reading skills
- ➔ *Emerging Literacy Survey (K-1)*—use this Diagnostic instrument to assess basic reading skills
- ➔ *Diagnostic Assessment*—Individually Administered tests that diagnose basic reading skills plus passages for reading in context
- ➔ *Comprehensive Screening Assessment* – Group-administered tests that act as in initial screening of previous year’s skills (Language Arts, Phonics, and Writing, plus passages for Comprehension and Vocabulary)
- ➔ *Weekly Assessments* – (included in the Grab and Go kit) Assess assesses five essential elements. Comprehension is tied to main selection and includes cold reads.
- ➔ *Running Records* – optional (included in the Grab and Go kit)

IV. UNIT ACTIVITIES

- ➔ *Launch Unit* – Prior to the beginning of each Unit, you have the opportunity to “Launch the Unit” (see TE) which provides an introduction to the new Unit. This is an optional activity. If it is completed, it is recommended that it be done on the Friday *prior to* Lesson 1 of the new Unit.
- ➔ *Unit Project* – An engaging activity that can be used to tie concepts in Unit.
- ➔ *Reading Power*—The end of each unit has a test prep passage (6). This is a cold read with an extended-response question. This is found as a BLM in the Grab and Go.

OPTIONAL ANCILLIARIES

The following consists of a listing of additional ancillaries that you will have access to. However, these are considered **optional** – feel free to try them out but they are not required to be used.

JOURNEY'S DIGITAL

The Journey's digital online companion reinforces print resource activities and can be used for in class whole group/small group instruction as well as at home. Use of the digital activities and resources are considered optional.

COMPREHENSIVE LANGUAGE AND LITERACY GUIDE

A Readers Workshop Approach designed by consulting author Irene Fountas. A Grade level teaching guide that provides reading mini-lessons, interactive Read-Alouds (using Journeys literature) and genre study. Suggested Menu structures whole group, small group (guided reading) and independent options. Refers back to Journey's materials for whole group word work lessons (vocabulary and phonics, literature (core reader and TE read-aloud), leveled reader database (Journeys leveled readers).

INTERVENTION

Strategic intervention lessons for each Unit are found in the back of the TE under the Intervention tab. Use these materials to provide additional targeted instruction. Intervention activities and lessons should be used where applicable.

➔ Strategic Intervention: Tier II

- Journeys Write in Reader – Interactive Worktext for Skills Support
- Curious About Words – Intensive Oral Vocabulary

➔ Intensive Intervention Tier III

- Reading Tool Kit – Helps to provide a different approach for children who need Tier III intensive intervention

ENGLISH LANGUAGE LEARNERS

Use the ELL support materials to ensure that children acquire social and academic language proficiency. ELL lessons for each Unit are found in the back of the TE under the English Language Learners tab. ELL lessons and activities should be used where applicable.

- ➔ Language Support Card—Helps to pre-teach critical skills and support a variety of ELL vocabulary needs.
- ➔ Leveled Reader
- ➔ Scaffolded Support – Notes throughout the TE scaffold instruction to each language proficiency level
- ➔ Vocabulary in Context Cards – Provides visual support and additional practice for high-frequency words.

Appendix D:

Case Study of Site Visits

CASE STUDY OF SITE VISITS

Site visits are crucial in terms of helping us better understand the context in which a program is being used. In addition, environmental factors (e.g. school factors, local history effects) can influence the results of a study making it necessary, at the very least, to document such factors. The case study of site visits is accomplished by triangulating the data from the site/classroom observations, post-observation interviews, the implementation logs, and capturing the perspectives of various participants²⁹. The following provides information about each of the sites, collected from the participating teachers, school administrators, and our own school-related research.

School A

About the School: School A is a small public charter school located in a lower to middle class urban area in Arizona. The school is housed in a newer building and consists of students in grades K-8. During the 2011-2012 school year enrollment at School A was 317.

In 2013, Arizona used the Arizona's Instrument to Measure Standards (AIMS) to test students in grade 3 in reading and language arts; of the 3rd graders who took the AIMS reading and language arts test, 74% of 3rd graders were proficient compared to the state average of 75%. The student population is relatively diverse:

- 53% White, not Hispanic
- 32% Hispanic
- 4% American Indian/Alaskan Native
- 9% Black, not Hispanic
- 2% Asian/Pacific Islander

Approximately 57% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches and 7% were noted as Limited English Proficiency.

Study Participants: During year one, six teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at each grade level for kindergarten, first and second grades. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher. The six classes contained approximately 150 students, with an average class size of 25, and a range of 22 to 27.

During year two, five teachers participated in the study. There was one teacher in first grade and two teachers at each grade level for second and third grades. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher with the exception of first grade in which there was only a treatment teacher. The five classes contained approximately 132 students, with an average class size of 24.4 and a range of 21 to 31.

²⁹ It is important to note that, when interpreting information from such qualitative data collection techniques, the data reported consist of recurrent and shared themes that emerged. That is, comments from a single individual which are not reflective of a larger proportion of respondents are not identified as a finding or "theme."

In year two, teachers characterized their classes as a mix of students. Specifically, two classes were a mix of abilities with mostly low students, two were a mix of all levels of students, and there was one class of on level students with a mix of abilities. Classes were also noted as typical of the student population at the school. Technology was used in all of the treatment and control classes to some extent.

Reading and language arts Curriculum and Resources: In year one, the first grade control teacher used a basal reading and language arts program copyright 2001 as the main reading-writing curriculum. In general this teacher taught most of the themes/lessons included in the program but did not always cover each lesson completely as she would pull resources where needed. There was no participating 1st grade control teacher in year two of the study.

There were many similarities between the control program used and the Journeys program. Both programs are basal reading language arts programs organized by a weekly lesson plan structured around a five day school week, with daily emphasis on reading, comprehension, vocabulary and writing. Similar to Journeys, this program includes read aloud stories, leveled readers, vocabulary readers and decodable texts. Differences in the control program and the Journeys program include the Common Core Standards alignment and the strong emphasis on daily small group instruction. While the control program includes resources and ideas for small group instruction, the Journeys program contains structured daily small group lesson plans as well as ready-made work stations.

The Kindergarten, second and third grade control curricula consisted of a 2002 phonics based program that teachers used in conjunction with their own teacher created materials. Additionally the second grade control teacher supplemented with a comprehension tool kit that provides lessons around fundamental comprehension strategies. There were few similarities between the main control program and the Journeys program. Similarities included an emphasis on phonics, phonemic awareness and vocabulary. Unlike Journeys this program also emphasizes letter formation and handwriting practice. In general Journeys is a comprehensive reading language arts program while this control program is recommended to be used in conjunction with a literature based reading program.

While no school pacing guidelines were in place, all teachers reported following a regional pacing guideline that had been developed to follow the sequencing of the Journeys program. Use of technological resources in the treatment classes occurred more frequently in year two than year one. In year two of the study treatment teachers felt more comfortable with the Journeys program overall and therefore were more apt to utilizing the available technology. In contrast, each of the control teachers utilized technology in their reading and language arts programs via the computer lab where students used a variety of leveled online programs to practice reading, grammar and spelling games. This was done on a weekly or bi-weekly basis.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day depending on the teacher and took approximately 2-2.5 hours. Instruction occurred during the same time each day for the duration of the year. All students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources (e.g., student textbooks, worksheets, etc.).

Reading and language arts instruction in control classrooms was relatively consistent though some variations occurred by grade level. For example, Kindergarten classes focused more on phonemic awareness and phonics activities while 2nd grade classes placed more emphasis on grammar. In general however, teachers began instruction with high frequency words/vocabulary introduction or review followed by short phonics/phonemic awareness lesson. This was followed by a comprehension skills/strategy lesson and main story selection reading or independent reading. Teachers would then provide a language arts lesson that included grammar, spelling and writing. Small group centers often occurred in the afternoon and allowed teachers opportunity to work with groups of students in guided reading while other students completed literacy activities independently. Time was also set aside for silent, independent reading.

Lessons in the treatment reading and language arts classrooms were similar between classes, as teachers were following the Journeys program implementation guidelines to varying degrees. One treatment teacher was a high implementer (see Appendix C for a detailed description of implementation guidelines and lesson parameters) and followed the Journeys implementation guidelines explicitly with the exception of the Your Turn activity which was only completed sometimes. Another treatment teacher was a moderate implementer, skipping the Opening Routines and Writing components, which was considered key. The final treatment teacher was a low implementer due skipping the Your Turn, Stop and Think and Paired Selection activities.

Homework: Homework was fairly consistent between treatment and control classes. Students were given a packet at the beginning of the week containing homework assignments across a range of subjects (i.e. the packet contained homework related to reading and language arts, math, science, social studies, etc.) and were required to hand in the completed packet on Friday. The reading and language arts portion typically contained a reading log, site word practice, and grammar or comprehension worksheets. While all teachers, both control and treatment, assigned a similar range of reading and language arts related work as part of the weekly homework packet, two treatment teachers specifically included the leveled practice found in the Journeys program.

Assessment: In terms of assessment there were some similarities amongst treatment and control teachers, specifically both sets of teachers gave weekly spelling or vocab quizzes and administered the Galileo Benchmark assessments based on district/school requirements. Treatment teachers tended to give more unit tests and made use of the Running Records component of the Journeys program. Different than treatment teachers, control teachers at School A also tended to include monthly writing or dictation assessments.

Comparability: In terms of the comparability of control and Journeys program classrooms, teachers covered similar lessons related to reading and language arts, including independent reading, grammar, phonics, spelling and site words. Treatment classes tended to engage in a more structured reading and language arts schedule and included the introduction of advanced grammar at an earlier point in the year and focused to a greater extent on writing than the control classrooms.

Highlights: Teachers at site A did a very comparable job teaching both the control and treatment

programs to their students. Due to the structured nature of the Journeys program, the explicit implementation guidelines and availability of related materials, treatment teachers tended to have a more concise delivery method of reading and language arts instruction than their control counterparts. No contamination was noted.

School B

About the School: School B is a small public charter school located in a lower to middle class urban area in Arizona. The school is housed in a strip mall in a newer building adjacent to commercial businesses. The school consists of students in grades K-8, with enrollment during the 2011-2012 school year being 315.

In 2013, Arizona used the Arizona's Instrument to Measure Standards (AIMS) to test students in grade 3 in reading and language arts; of the 3rd graders who took the AIMS reading and language arts test, 61% of 3rd graders were proficient compared to the state average of 75%. The student population is relatively diverse:

- 32% White, not Hispanic
- 21% Hispanic
- 6% American Indian/Alaskan Native
- 37% Black, not Hispanic
- 4% Two or more races

Approximately 73% of the students were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches. No data was available regarding number of students noted as Limited English Proficiency.

Study Participants: During year one six teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at each grade level for kindergarten, first and second grades. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher. The six classes contained approximately 115 students, with an average class size of 19, and a range of 16 to 25.

During year two six teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at each grade level for first grade, second grade, and third grade. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher. The six classes contained approximately 116 students, with an average class size of 19.3, and a range of 17 to 22.

For the most part teachers characterized their classes as having a mix of abilities. Both treatment and control teachers had a greater number of students of average ability with one exception. One control class was characterized as having a mix of abilities with more low ability level students than average or low. Overall classes were noted as typical of the student population at School B.

Technology was utilized to a greater extent in control classrooms than treatment. Specifically the two of the control teachers had students work on leveled online reading and language arts games once a week in the computer lab or as a station during small group centers. One control teacher however reported the only technology used in the classroom was projectibles. Treatment

teachers utilized the interactive games (starting in the spring), listening stations and smartboards with one exception. One treatment teacher did not utilize technology in the classroom at all.

Reading and language arts Curriculum and Resources: All control teachers used a basal reading and language arts program copyright 2006 as their reading-writing curriculum. However, the second grade control teacher noted that she mostly used her own teacher created resources and pulled from this program where needed. There were many similarities between the control program used and the Journeys program. Both programs are basal reading language arts programs organized by a weekly lesson plan structured around a five day school week, with daily emphasis on reading, comprehension, vocabulary and writing. Similar to Journeys, this program includes read aloud stories, leveled readers, vocabulary readers and decodable texts. Differences in the control program and the Journeys program include the Common Core Standards alignment and the strong emphasis on daily small group instruction. While the control program includes resources and ideas for small group instruction, the Journeys program contains structured daily small group lesson plans as well as ready-made work stations. The Kindergarten, first and second grade teachers also supplemented their reading language arts instruction with the 2002 phonics based program described in the Site A site summary.

Both treatment and control teachers paced their classes based on a regional pacing guide that was developed on the sequencing of the Journeys program.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day depending on the teacher and took approximately 2.5-3 hours. Instruction occurred during the same time each day for the duration of the year. All students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources (e.g., student textbooks, worksheets, etc.).

Reading and language arts instruction in control classrooms was relatively consistent. Teachers began instruction with phonics/phonemic awareness or spelling/vocabulary review. This was followed by the reading lesson, including comprehension and fluency via a main story selection or 3rd grade trade book (30-45 minutes) – activities and focus of lesson varied depending on the day of the week (e.g., Monday would be introduction to the story, Tuesday would be focused on comprehension, and so forth). Centers followed with students practicing literacy concepts at different centers for 30 minutes to one hour. During this time, teachers worked with leveled groups to provide differentiated instruction. Writing was also incorporated for approximately 20-30 minutes.

Lessons in the treatment reading and language arts classrooms were similar between classes with a few exceptions, as teachers were very conscience about following the implementation guidelines explicitly (see Appendix C for detailed implementation guidelines and daily lesson structure). One treatment teacher implemented the Journeys program to the fullest extent possible, consistently implementing the key components, as well as those components deemed recommended and supplemental. The other two treatment teachers implemented to a moderate and low degree respectively. The moderate implementer used the Teacher Read Aloud, Your Turn and Deepen Comprehension with less frequency than prescribed and did not utilize the Writing. The low implementer did not utilize the Big Idea and Essential Question, Teacher Read Aloud, Your Turn and Fluency, which were considered a key elements of the Journeys program.

Homework: Homework was fairly consistent between treatment and control classes. Students were given a packet at the beginning of the week containing homework assignments across a range of subjects (i.e. the packet contained homework related to reading and language arts, math, science, social studies, etc.) and were required to hand in the completed packet on Friday. The reading and language portion usually consisted of a combination of reading comprehension, site word practice, grammar and phonics and changed somewhat depending on the week.

Assessment: In terms of assessment both treatment and control classes were given weekly spelling tests. However, treatment classes tended to receive more unit, chapter and weekly reading tests, in addition to the weekly spelling tests, versus control classes. Control classes lacked the unit and chapter tests, but were comparable to their treatment counterparts in terms of weekly spelling and site word tests. Both treatment and control classes also administered the Galileo Benchmark assessments based on district/school requirements.

Comparability: In terms of overall comparability, both the Journeys program and the control classrooms were somewhat similar. Both control and treatment teachers placed emphasis on basic reading, spelling and writing skills, but treatment classrooms tended to include more grammar and writing exercises. Lessons in the treatment classes were more structured and included distinct lesson components that were centralized around big ideas; while control lessons were less structured and varied from day to day and week-to-week. As noted above, treatment teachers did not engage in technology via leveled online reading and language arts games and practice the way control teachers did.

Highlights: The teachers at School B were very competent and dedicated. While teachers in both control and treatment classes were skilled in delivering the reading and language arts curriculum, overall treatment teachers were successful at implementing the Journeys program which caused their classes to cover a greater range of skills in a more organized and cohesive manner.

School C

About the School: School C is a small public charter school located in a lower class urban neighborhood in Arizona. The school consists of grades K-8, with grades 1-8 being housed at the main campus in an older converted public building and several outbuildings, and kindergarten located less than a mile away in a portion of a converted public building. Technological capabilities at this school were below average to non-existent. During the 2011-2012 school year enrollment at School C was 407.

In 2013, Arizona used the Arizona's Instrument to Measure Standards (AIMS) to test students in grade 3 in reading and language arts; of the 3rd graders who took the AIMS reading and language arts test, 71% of 3rd graders were proficient compared to the state average of 75%. The student population is predominantly Hispanic:

- 7% White, not Hispanic
- 88% Hispanic

- 0% American Indian/Alaskan Native
- 3% Black, not Hispanic
- 0% Asian/Pacific Islander

Approximately 75% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches, which is much higher than the state average of 46%. Approximately 28% of the student population was indicated as being of Limited English Proficiency, which is double the state average of 14%.

Study Participants: During year one, six teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at each grade level for kindergarten, first and second grades. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher. The six classes contained approximately 141 students, with an average class size of 24, and a range of 20 to 25.

During year two, six teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at each grade level for first, second and third grades. Each grade level had one treatment and one control teacher. The six classes contained approximately 161 students, with an average class size of 26.8, and a range of 23 to 34.

The majority of the classes in the study at School C were of mixed ability levels with a higher degree of average students than low or high with a few exceptions. There were two classes that contained a mix of abilities with more low and average students than high, and one class that was comprised of a mix of abilities with more students on the average to high side than low. All study classes at this school contained a greater degree of English language learners than other classes in the study. Classes in the study were representative of the general student population at School C.

Most control and treatment teachers did not have regular access to technology and therefore it was not utilized in either the treatment or control classes. While Site C did have a computer lab, the majority of teachers (both control and treatment) indicated they did not use it with one exception. One control teacher did have her students use an online reading and phonics program as a rotation during centers.

Reading and language arts Curriculum and Resources: The Kindergarten and 2nd grade control teachers utilized a comprehensive language arts program (2003) that could be used with other literature based reading programs. There were very few similarities between this control program and the Journeys program. The noted similarities include a focus on reading comprehension and integration of spelling and writing activities. The Journeys program is designed as an all-encompassing reading language arts program that includes a wide variety of rich literature resources whereas this control program does not contain literature. The Kindergarten control teacher supplemented this program with teacher made resources while the second grade control teacher incorporated a 2000 edition basal reading language arts program. Similar to Journeys this program was organized round unit themes with 5 day week lessons plans. As well, both programs focus on literature, with a variety of reading genres and reading opportunities. Unlike Journeys, however, this program does not integrate phonemic awareness and does not emphasize daily small group activities.

The first grade control teacher used a different basal reading language arts program published in 2003. Similar to Journeys this program emphasizes a variety of literature through a variety of resources. As well both programs integrate writing, grammar and spelling lessons. Unlike the Journeys program, however, this program does not integrate vocabulary strategies and does not include formal and informal assessment opportunities. This teacher also reported heavily supplementing with various teacher created activities and online resources. The third grade control teacher did not report following any published program but used a mixture of resources collected over the years, trade books and teacher created materials.

Treatment teachers followed the Journeys program and related pacing, while two of the control teachers used their main textbooks and the school pacing guide. One control teacher paced based on the Arizona state standards. Neither control nor treatment teachers used technology for instruction related to reading and language arts with the exception of one control teacher who had her class utilize an online reading and phonics program during centers. Teachers indicated that they did not readily have access to technology and therefore were unable to incorporate it into their lessons.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day and took approximately 2 – 2.5 hours. They occurred every day during the same time for the duration of the year. All students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources (e.g., student textbooks).

Reading and language arts instruction in the control classrooms was relatively consistent. Reading instruction typically consisted of an introduction, read aloud and class discussion to promote comprehension. Teachers also modeled fluency. Grammar and/or writing activities also occurred daily. Spelling, vocabulary and phonics also was introduced and reviewed throughout the week. Teachers also indicated that students worked in small groups 3-5 times per week.

Two of the three treatment teachers at School C followed the Journeys implementation guidelines to a high extent (see Appendix C for a detailed description of daily lesson structure), with one treatment teacher being a moderate implementer. While the moderately implementing teacher did use the Journeys program exclusively and followed the lesson plans of the program, she used the Your Turn and Fluency components with less frequency than directed.

Homework: Homework assignment was similar between treatment and control classes. Teachers assigned homework four days a week consisting of spelling, reading and vocabulary practice. Additionally both treatment and control teachers had students read at home and complete a reading log. Control teachers generally sent home worksheets that students would complete and return. Similarly treatment teachers sent worksheets, but also used the Journeys Practice Books to assign homework from.

Assessment: In terms of assessment, control and treatment classes were relatively similar. All teachers, both treatment and control did a weekly spelling test. In addition to the weekly spelling test treatment teachers also used the Journeys weekly assessments and unit tests. Control teachers, in addition to the weekly spelling test, also administered reading comprehension

assessments. All treatment and control teachers also utilized the DIBELS and Galileo Benchmark tests throughout the year. Informal assessment (i.e. observation, checking homework, discussion, etc.) occurred with equal regularity and in similar ways.

Comparability: Journeys program and control classrooms teachers covered similar lessons and topics including independent reading, grammar, phonics, spelling and site words. Treatment classes tended to engage in a more structured reading and language arts schedule and included the introduction of advanced grammar at an earlier point in the year and focused to a greater extent on writing than the control classrooms. As well, treatment rooms more consistently included center activities in their reading and language arts program and leveled readers were used with more regularity. Technology was not incorporated to a great extent in either control or treatment classrooms in terms of reading and language arts content.

Highlights: In general, the teachers at School C tended to lean towards a more traditional style of teaching and appeared comfortable with teaching practices they had employed over the years. Behavioral issues were relatively non-existent at this school and classroom engagement was relatively high. Technology was not a focus at this school in general and this was evident in the classrooms. No evidence of contamination was indicated.

School D

About the School: School D is located in a middle class residential neighborhood of Washington D.C. The school is housed in an older, newly renovated and currently houses grades PK-8. Enrollment was reported to be 524 for the 2011-2012 school year with a student to teacher ratio of 18 to 1 and 531 for the 2012-2013 school year with a student to teacher ratio of 18 to 1.

In 2012, the District of Columbia used the District of Columbia Comprehensive Assessment System (DC-CAS) to test students in grade 3 in reading and language arts; of the 3rd graders who took the DC-CAS reading and language arts test, 38% of 3rd graders were proficient compared to the state average of 42%. In 2013, the District of Columbia used the District of Columbia Comprehensive Assessment System (DC-CAS) to test students in grade 3 in reading and language arts; of the 3rd graders who took the DC-CAS reading and language arts test, 53% of 3rd graders were proficient compared to the state average of 44%. The student population is predominantly African-American:

- 62% Black;
- 36% Hispanic;
- 2% Other

During year one approximately 80% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches, which is slightly higher than the state average of 70%. Approximately 0% of the student population was indicated as being of Limited English Proficiency, which is less than the state average of 7%. During year two approximately 75% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches, which is slightly higher than the state

average of 70%. Approximately 0% of the student population was indicated as being of Limited English Proficiency, which is less than the state average of 7%.

Study Participants: Six teachers in grades K-2 participated in the first year of this study: three treatment and three control teachers, with one treatment and one control class at each grade level. The six classes contained approximately 143 students, with an average class size of 24, and a range of 22 to 26. Eight teachers in grades 1-3 participated in the second year of the study: five treatment and three control teachers, with two treatment and one control class in grades 1-2, and one treatment and control in 3rd grade. The eight classes contained approximately 202 students, with an average class size of 25, and a range of 23 to 26.

Classes were not grouped by ability level, and all teachers reported having a broad mix of low, average, and high performing students. All teachers had a teaching assistant present for the majority of the school day. The teaching assistant supported the teacher as needed and also assisted with planning and instructional purposes.

Most control and treatment teachers did not emphasize technology as part of their reading and language arts curriculum. While all students had weekly access to the computer lab, reading and language arts were not necessarily the focus of their computer lab time (i.e. students might be working on math, science or technical literacy related activities). As well, teachers indicated that the Internet was often slow or down and this prevented them from taking full advantage of the available Smartboards or other technology, specifically the Smartboards didn't work at the beginning of the first year and therefore by the time the Smartboards were working, teachers had become accustomed to teaching without them and did not modify teaching going forward to include much Smartboard use.

Reading and language arts Curriculum and Resources: Control teachers reported using a basal reading language arts program (2003) as the basis for planning and instruction. In general they moved sequentially through the book, but noted supplementing with various online resources or teacher-created materials.

There were many similarities between the control program used and the Journeys program. Both programs are basal reading language arts programs organized by a weekly lesson plan structured around a five day school week, with daily emphasis on reading, comprehension, vocabulary and writing. Similar to Journeys, this program includes read aloud stories, leveled readers, vocabulary readers and decodable texts. Differences in the control program and the Journeys program include the Common Core Standards alignment and the strong emphasis on daily small group instruction. While the control program includes resources and ideas for small group instruction, the Journeys program contains structured daily small group lesson plans as well as ready-made work stations.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day depending on the teacher. Classes lasted for 90-120 minute periods and occurred every day during the same time for the duration of the year. All students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources (e.g., student textbooks). In the first and second grades reading occurred at a time separate from language arts.

In terms of control classes there was some age related variation that occurred at each grade level; such as Kindergarten classes focused more on phonemic awareness and phonics activities using songs, while second grade classes placed more emphasis on grammar and writing. In general however, teachers began instruction with group reading and comprehension, followed by independent work in consumable workbooks related to the group read aloud. This was often done in centers or small homogenous groups. Centers or group work was followed by phonics and often included a reinforcement activity such as a related worksheet at the kindergarten level or writing worksheets at the first and second grade level. At the kindergarten level students had access to supplementary computer resources such as leveled online practice. As well, teachers at each grade included time for silent, independent reading. This was consistent both years of the study.

All of the treatment teachers at School D followed the Journeys implementation guidelines to a moderate degree (see Appendix C for implementation guidelines and a detailed description of daily lesson structure). During the first semester of year one treatment teachers implemented the program over a two week time period, versus the one week timeline indicated in the implementation guideline and therefore, while treatment teachers were using most of the key components, they did so with less frequency than was prescribed. During the second semester, after receiving additional training, all treatment teachers began implementing the Journeys program on a weekly basis as prescribed, but due to students needing somewhat slower pacing, continued to use some of the components with less frequency, specifically Stop and Think, Your Turn and Phonemic Awareness, which were all considered key components of the Journeys program. During the second year of the study teachers began implementing the program to a moderate degree at the start of the school year.

During year one and year two both control and treatment classes spent approximately one hour weekly in the computer lab, which sometimes included online, leveled games and practice related to reading and language arts. Beyond the weekly computer lab time, technology related to reading and language arts was limited, though control teachers tended to incorporate slightly more technology than treatment teachers. Specifically, one control teacher had students use leveled, online programs during centers and another control teacher used the audio CD from the main reading and language arts program along with the Smartboard to show reading and language arts related internet videos and PowerPoints. In contrast, only one of the three treatment teachers in both years utilized technology in relation to reading and language arts and this was done through the use of a Smartboard as a presentation tool.

Homework: Homework assignment was similar between treatment and control classes. Teachers assigned homework five days a week consisting of a weekly packet at the kindergarten level and nightly assignments at the first through third grade levels. Homework across treatment and control classrooms contained spelling, phonics, reading and/or writing exercises from a variety of resources for control teachers, including their main textbook, black line masters or teacher created materials, and for treatment teachers consisted of Journeys related reinforcement materials or from time to time teacher created worksheets. In addition homework at the third grade level included substantially more independent writing practice than at the other grade levels.

Assessment: In terms of assessment, control and treatment classes were similar based on the types of skills that were assessed, but differed in the types of assessments that were used. Control teachers used an assessment every three to four weeks that tested discrete skills related to phonics, comprehension and high-frequency words. In comparison treatment teachers gave weekly spelling and phonics tests, unit tests and used the Journeys Running Records with each lesson to assess oral fluency. In addition to the control assessments described above, one control teacher also utilized self-made quizzes. This was consistent in both years of the study.

Comparability: All study classes, both treatment and control, were comparable in terms of their reading and language arts lessons. Overall teachers covered similar topics such as, phonemic awareness, oral fluency, grammar, phonics, spelling and allowed plenty of time for group and independent reading. Because control teachers at School D mostly followed a basal textbook, their classes, like the treatment classes, tended to engage in a structured reading and language arts curriculum. Treatment classes were much more likely to introduce advanced grammar and writing opportunities earlier in the year, especially at the kindergarten level, than were control classrooms. As well, treatment classes used leveled readers and small group settings with more regularity. Technology was not incorporated to a great extent in either control or treatment classrooms in terms of reading and language arts content, however overall, control teachers utilized more technology than their treatment counterparts.

Highlights: Student engagement across both control and treatment classrooms was high and there were few behavioral problems. Teachers at school D, both treatment and control, were capable of providing meaningful and lasting instruction for their students and were observed in very effective instructional settings. No issues of contamination were present, although the commercially published basal program used by control teachers was similar in some aspects to the Journeys program.

School E

About the School: School E is a medium sized public charter school located in an urban neighborhood in Louisiana. The elementary school is housed in two locations, with two older buildings on the main campus consisting of grades K-6, and a secondary campus occupying the third floor of a local community building housing grades some K and first grade classes. During the 2011-2012 school year enrollment at School E was 1520, with a student to teacher ratio of 15 to 1, which is slightly higher than average for the state of 14 to 1.

In 2012 School E used the Integrated Louisiana Educational Assessment Program (iLEAP) to test students in grade 3 in English Language Arts; of 3rd graders who took the iLEAP English Language Arts test, 100% were proficient, which is significantly higher than the state average of 69%. The student population is relatively diverse:

- 56% White, not Hispanic
- 35% Black, not Hispanic
- 4% Asian/Pacific Islander
- 2% Two or more races

Approximately 27% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches. No data was available regarding number of students noted as Limited English Proficiency.

Study Participants: During year one, twelve teachers participated in the study. There were four teachers at each grade level for kindergarten, first and second grades. Each grade level had two treatment and two control teachers. The twelve classes contained approximately 273 students, with an average class size of 23, and a range of 19 to 24.

During year two of the study, fourteen teachers participated in the study. There were four teachers at each grade level for first and third grades. At the second grade level there were six participating teachers. Each grade level had two treatment and two control teachers with the exception of second grade which had four treatment and two control teachers. The fourteen classes contained approximately 308 students, with an average class size of 22, and a range of

Students in this school were relatively high performing with most students on or above grade level. Teachers characterized their classes as average with mixed abilities, with most classes being higher performing. Across treatment and control classes there was a relatively equal spread of slightly higher or lower performing students, but overall most classes contained a mix of abilities and performed at level for their grade with one exception. One treatment teacher had a class of mostly low level students. As well, most classes had students that were identified as gifted.

Technological resources were available in most classrooms, including smartboards, student computers and iPads. Both control and treatment teachers indicated they utilized their smartboards as part of reading and language arts instruction. Both control and treatment teachers indicated they used an online, leveled reading and language arts program with their students. All teachers emphasized technology in a similar fashion, with the exception of the second grade treatment teachers who utilized technology to a slightly greater degree than the other teachers.

Reading and language arts Curriculum and Resources: Teachers used the same research based elementary reading and language arts program copyright 2003 for K-1 and 2006 for 2-3 as their control curriculum. Teachers indicated they generally followed the pacing guidelines and lesson plans as outlined in the book, but sometimes added in special activities centered around a specific theme (like holidays) or included teacher selected reading materials they especially liked. Moreover, teachers indicated that they also used teacher created materials from time to time for additional reading and phonics practice, games, etc. on occasion or from resources collected over the years.

There were a few similarities between the control program used and the Journeys program. Similarities include the daily emphasis on reading, language arts and writing activities. As well both programs integrate fluency, phonics, reading comprehension and vocabulary in their daily lessons. Unlike Journeys, however, this program does not integrate phonemic awareness. Other differences between the control program and the Journeys program include the absence of activities for small group instruction and the opportunity for a variety of literature genres including non-fiction and informational text.

Use of technological resources was incorporated in both treatment and control classes; though the second grade treatment teachers used technology to a slightly larger degree than their counterparts. In treatment classes, teachers were observed following the Journeys program exclusively and adhering to the implementation guidelines to a strong degree. Treatment teachers at this school were overall high implementers, with the exception of one teacher who was a moderate to high implementer.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day and lasted for approximately 2.5 hours daily. All students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources (e.g., student textbooks) and the school's technology resources were able to support interactive and online instruction in classrooms. Of note, reading and language arts instruction were generally leveled though not exclusively (e.g., classes were classified as low-average or average-high). As such, students went to other classrooms for reading instruction. Note that comparable leveled groups were in the control and treatment condition.

Among control teachers, reading and language arts instruction varied somewhat according to the grade level. Kindergarten teachers began class with a morning message where they review what was done previously and what class was going to do today. They also worked on sentence structure and sounds. Typically, 1st grade teachers began classes with phonics instruction via whole group, which was followed by independent practice. At the 2nd and 3rd grade level, teachers began with "Daily Edit" which involves editing sentence(s) using grammar and spelling skills. This was followed by spelling and review of homework which entails reading and responding to reading selection. Reading of a main selection then occurred which incorporated comprehension questions. At 1st, 2nd and 3rd grades, this also involved partner reading or retelling stories to partners. Literacy centers also were held but only at the Kindergarten level and by one of the 3rd grade teachers. 1st, 2nd and the remaining 3rd grade classes used primarily paired groups. Language arts and writing typically occurred later in the day (e.g., journal writing).

Lessons in the treatment reading and language arts classrooms adhered to the Journeys implementation guidelines almost exclusively (see Appendix C for detailed implementation guidelines) with some exceptions. Among 1st grade teachers the Stop & Think, Making Connections, Develop Comprehension and Deepen Comprehension sections were used only sometimes and one of the 1st grade teachers reported omitting the Vocabulary Strategies section. In 2nd grade, the teachers reported using the Making Connections and Your Turn sections sometimes and omitting the Fluency piece. Additionally one of the 2nd grade teachers reported using the Paired Selection and Making Connections sections as enrichment activities only. In 3rd grade the Paired Selection, Fluency and Making Connections sections were used for only 50-75% of the lessons.

Homework: Homework was relatively consistent between treatment and control classes and occurred four days a week, Monday through Thursday, over the course of the year in first, second and third grade classrooms. In kindergarten classes, homework was not assigned during the first semester, but was assigned four days a week, Monday through Thursday, during the second semester. Control students were similar to treatment students in terms of the type of

homework that was assigned. That is control and treatment teachers assigned a combination of reading, word and spelling practice as homework. Sometimes reading was done as a “read and respond” exercise and/or incorporated leveled readers. Additionally some control teachers reported having students use an online state test preparation program or online skills practice program for homework.

Assessment: In terms of assessment, treatment teachers tended to give more unit and chapter tests, while control teachers gave quarterly tests with a combination of small spelling, reading and grammar related tests on a weekly basis. Informal assessments occurred in all classrooms (e.g., observations, discussions, etc.).

Comparability: In terms of comparability both the Journeys program and the control classrooms, with the exception of the program-based activities, were similar. For example, vocabulary, phonics, independent reading and comprehension were equally emphasized in both types of classes. In addition, both types of classes incorporated interactive technology into their reading and language arts programs. Some differences were also noted, specifically treatment classes tended to more frequently engage in small group center activities on a regular basis and instruction that included more rigorous grammar lessons related to reading and language arts. Teachers at School E were equal in their drive and desire to provide a comprehensive reading and language arts program for the students and worked well as a cohesive team. No evidence of contamination was apparent.

Highlights: Classes at School E were quite comparable and included a mix of mostly on-level students with a few classes having a mix of abilities ranging on the average to higher side, with one exception. One class was considered to be made up of lower performing students, however this class was significantly smaller than the average class sizes for other classrooms and allowed the teacher to spend more time working with each student, so while the class was lower, they were on pace with other classes at the school. Both control and treatment teachers at School E held themselves to a high standard of educational instruction and the administration was very supportive and hands on. No contamination was noted, though the structure of reading and language arts classes, whether treatment or control, was similar.

School F

About the Schools: School F is a medium sized public school located in a lower class, suburban neighborhood in Rhode Island. The school houses grades K-2 in a crowded, older building three blocks from the main campus, which houses grades 3-5. Prior to the 2012-13 school year, this school closed and relocated some of the K-2 students to the main campus which now houses students at K-5. During the 2011-2012 school year, enrollment at School F prior to closing was 215.

In 2012, Rhode Island used the New England Common Assessment Program (NECAP) to test students in 3rd grade in reading language arts. Of the 3rd graders who took the NECAP reading language arts test, 52% were proficient which is lower than the state average of 73%. The student population is relatively ethnically diverse:

- 27% White, not Hispanic
- 48% Hispanic
- 2% Two or more races
- 14% Black, not Hispanic
- 9% Asian/Pacific Islander

Approximately 84% of the students at the school were eligible for free or reduced-price lunches. No data was available regarding number of students noted as Limited English Proficiency.

Study Participants: During year one, seven teachers participated in the study. There were two teachers at the kindergarten level, one treatment teacher with one participating half day study class (a.m.) and one control teacher who had two participating half day study classes (a.m. and p.m.), and three teachers at both the first and second grade level, with one control teacher and two treatment teachers for each grade (first and second). The nine classes contained approximately 212 students, with an average class size of 24, and a range of 21 to 25.

During year two of the study, seven teachers participated in the study. There were three teachers at the first grade level, and two teachers each in second and third grades. In first grade there was two treatment and one control teachers and in second and third grades one treatment and one control teacher. The seven classes contained approximately 175 students, with an average class size of 25, and a range of 22 to 26.

For the most part teachers characterized their classes as low or of mixed ability leaning towards the low side, with two exceptions. One treatment teacher had a class made up of students with a mix of abilities ranging towards average on-level students and another treatment teacher had a mix of abilities ranging from low to high-level students. Of note, the three inclusion ELL classes were spread across the control teachers. Overall classes were noted as typical of the student population at School F and behavioral problems, to some extent, were considered normal in most classes.

Technology was non-existent and did not occur in any of the treatment or control classrooms. This was due to the fact that teachers did not have access to technology and not because they did not want to utilize these types of resources.

Reading and Language Arts Curriculum and Resources: Control teachers in grades K-2 used a mix of whatever resources they had collected over the years, both commercial and teacher made, for their reading and language arts program. While there was not a commercial program in place at School F, the third grade control teacher used a commercial elementary reading/language arts program copyright 2000. Both control and treatment teachers followed the district curriculum map in order to structure the scope and sequence of their reading and language arts program, with treatment teachers doing so within the organization of the Journeys program, that is, while they followed the district pacing map, they did so within the context of the Journeys scope and sequence.

There were a few similarities between the control program teachers created and the Journeys program. Similarities included opportunities for spelling practice, group and independent reading, vocabulary practice and phonics lessons. However, in general the Journeys program integrated more structure and writing to a larger degree than the control programs the teachers created. In addition, treatment teachers had very concise directions in terms of when and how to deliver reading and language arts lessons, while control teachers had to create and structure the lessons they taught based on what they considered necessary in order to follow the district curriculum map.

With regards to the control program used by the 3rd grade control teacher, there were similarities to Journeys in its emphasis a variety of literature through a variety of resources. As well both programs integrate writing, and grammar lessons. Unlike the Journeys program, however, this program does not include formal and informal assessment opportunities. This teacher also reported heavily supplementing with various teacher created activities.

The majority of the teachers paced their classes (treatment and control) based on the curriculum map and student needs. However, for the most part treatment teachers followed the Journeys program and associated pacing. In treatment classes, teachers were observed following the Journeys program and mostly adhering to the implementation guidelines.

Instructional Practices and Strategies: Reading and language arts instruction occurred throughout the day depending on the teacher. Classes lasted for 60 to 120 minutes and occurred every day during the same time. All treatment students had sufficient copies of reading and language arts resources, while control students did not always have the amount of resources that the treatment students did. As indicated above, the technology resources at School F were non-existent and therefore unable to support online instruction or supplemental technology resources in reading and language arts classrooms.

Reading and language arts instruction in control classrooms was relatively consistent. Overall teachers would begin instruction with whole group instruction which may have included phonics, vocabulary, skill, spelling, or introduction to the story depending on the day. Next some type of independent reading activities or independent work in small groups occurred for 20-40 minutes. The exception to this format was a control teacher who taught reading and language arts for 120 minutes each day and had a slightly different schedule than the other control teachers. This teacher started with a mini lesson followed by small group activities based on the mini lesson. This control teacher also incorporated additional reading and language arts activities following the small groups, which included a language and grammar lesson, journal writing and sharing, and fluency. Control teachers also stated that while writing was taught regularly it was much less structured than the reading lesson.

In the treatment classrooms lessons were relatively similar, in part because most participating teachers followed the implementation guidelines and prescribed pacing and therefore the structure of the treatment lessons was similar, with a few exceptions. The treatment teachers were moderate implementers (see Appendix C for a detailed description of implementation guidelines and lesson structure) and mostly adhered to the implementation guidelines. The 1st grade treatment teachers only used the “Develop Comprehension”, “Your Turn”, and “Making

Connections” components of the Journeys program sometimes, but otherwise followed it as prescribed. The 2nd grade treatment teacher only used the following key components of the Journeys program 50-75% of time: “Your Turn”, “Deepen Comprehension”, and “Making Connections”. The 3rd grade treatment teacher only used the “Develop Comprehension”, “Fluency”, “Deepen Comprehension” and “Making Connections” components of the Journeys program sometimes, which were considered key parts of the program.

Homework: Homework was somewhat consistent between treatment and control classes, with a few exceptions. Both treatment and control teachers assigned homework four nights a week, Monday through Thursday. Homework across all teachers generally consisted of reading and word practice, which often included spelling or site words. One control teacher indicated that a poetry assignment was included each week and two treatment teachers indicated that Journeys practice book activities would also be assigned for homework.

Assessment: In terms of assessment, control and treatment teachers were similar in some ways, but also had distinct differences. Specifically while both control and treatment teachers gave district prescribed diagnostic reading assessments and dictated sentence during the course of the year, the majority of treatment teachers also included Journeys chapter and unit tests, along with weekly spelling tests. Two of the control teachers also indicated administering a weekly spelling test. Both treatment and control teacher reported using informal assessments (observations, small group work) with equal regularity.

Comparability: In terms of comparability, the strategies and materials used in the control classrooms to teach reading and language arts, while encompassing some of the same concepts as the Journeys program, like reading, vocabulary, writing and phonics practice, was very different from the Journeys program in that there was no distinct structure or required consistency in terms of implementation, duration or delivery of strategies for the reading and language arts concepts being taught. As well, Journeys teachers were much more likely to incorporate writing and center activities on a more consistent basis than were control teachers. Journeys teachers were also more likely to introduce more advanced grammatical concepts earlier in the school year than their control counterparts. Journeys teachers also assessed their students more often and in greater variety of ways than did the control teachers. Because of technological constraints at the school, technology activities were not emphasized in either the control or treatment classrooms.

Highlights: Overall the school climate was one of uncertainty given changes in the district in terms of the recent school closure and potential future closures. As well, the majority of the student population was just at or below average compared to other schools in the study. Because students were grouped by ELL status, instructional techniques varied slightly between teachers, and different teachers handled the behavioral responses of their students differently. No contamination was noted.

Appendix E:

Key Features and Resources for Treatment and Control Programs

Table D1. Program Features and Pedagogy of Treatment and Control Programs

Journeys	Control Program 1: (2001, 2003, 2006)	Control Program 2: (2002)	Control Program 3: (2003)	Control Program 4: (2000)	Control Program 5: (2003)	Control program 6: (2003, 2006)	Control program 7: (2000)
Key Program Features and Pedagogy - Aligned to Common Core Standards "Big Ideas" and "Essential Question" serve as the overarching concept for each lesson. - Integrates 5 Reading Strategies: Fluency, phonics, phonemic awareness, reading comprehension, vocabulary - Series of Leveled Readers leveled by Irene Fountas - Decodable and vocabulary readers for additional reading selections 21st Century learning connections are emphasized - Organized into 6 themed units, each with 5 lessons - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Daily opening routines. - Engaging main story selections - Paired selection non-fiction/informational text - Vocabulary development - Sight word integration - Small Group Lessons - Comprehensive Spelling, Grammar and Writing activities - Diagnostic, formative and summative assessment opportunities	- Integrates Fluency, phonemic awareness, phonics, reading comprehension and vocabulary - Leveled Readers - Big books and decodable readers - Organized into theme units - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Daily opening routines - Main story selections - Vocabulary development - High frequency words - Small group resources - Spelling, writing and grammar activities - Diagnostic and ongoing informal assessment	- Integrates Fluency, phonics, phonemic awareness and vocabulary - Emphasizes handwriting and letter formation - Lessons typically consist of the following: - Letter-keyword-sound activities - Word sounds - Word work	- Integrates reading comprehension - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Spelling instruction - Writing instruction - Reading instruction	- Integrates Fluency, phonics, reading comprehension and vocabulary - Leveled Readers - Take home readers - Organized into theme units - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Main story selections - Spelling, grammar and writing activities - Cross curricular connections - Formal and informal assessments	- Integrates Fluency, phonics, phonemic awareness, and reading comprehension - Leveled readers - Decodable books - Organized around themed units - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Main story selections - Phonics and spelling - Writing and grammar activities - Daily language activities - Resources for small group instruction - Cross curricular connections	- Integrates fluency, phonics, reading comprehension and vocabulary - Emphasis on handwriting practice at primary levels - Lessons at primary levels consist of the following: - Shared story - Main Story - Language arts activities - Writing activities - Lessons at secondary levels consist of the following: - Vocabulary - Writing activities - Fluency practice - Trade books - Response to literature	- Integrates phonics, reading comprehension, and vocabulary - Leveled Readers - Phonics Readers - Trade Book Library - Lessons typically consist of the following elements: - Spelling and phonics - Writing and grammar activities - Main Story selections - Self-selected reading and read aloud - Oral Language

Table D2. Program Resources of Treatment and Control Programs

	Journeys	Control Program 1: (2001, 2003, 2006)	Control Program 2: (2002)	Control Program 3: (2003)	Control Program 4: (2000)	Control Program 5: (2003)	Control program 6 (2003, 2006)	Control program 7: (2000)
Program Resources	<u>Student Resources</u> ▪ Student Editions ▪ Leveled Readers <u>Teacher Resources</u> ▪ Teacher's Edition ▪ Grab n Go Blackline Masters and Additional Resources ▪ Decodable Reader Stories ▪ Vocabulary Reader ▪ Read Aloud Book (K) ▪ Big Book (K - 1) ▪ Interactive Instructional Flip Chart (K) ▪ Ready Made Work Stations ▪ Leveled Practice Book ▪ Vocabulary in Context Cards ▪ Focus Wall poster ▪ Progress Monitoring Assessments ▪ Benchmark Tests and Unit Tests (1-3) ▪ Diagnostic Assessment (1-3) ▪ Comprehensive Literacy Guide ▪ Language	▪ Teacher's Guide ▪ Student edition ▪ Leveled readers ▪ Decodable Readers	▪ Teachers Editions	▪ Teacher's Edition	▪ Teachers Editions ▪ Student Edition ▪ Leveled readers	▪ Teacher Editions ▪ Student Edition ▪ Leveled readers ▪ Decodable book	▪ Teachers edition ▪ Student trade books	▪ Teacher's Edition ▪ Student edition ▪ Leveled Readers ▪ Phonics Readers ▪ Trade books

	- Support Cards ▪ Student Book - Audio Text CD (1-3) ▪ Instructional Card Kit (1-3) ▪ Reading Tool Kit (1-3) ▪ ExamView CDROM (1-3) <u>Digital Resources</u> ▪ Student & Teacher Edition ▪ Teacher One-Stop ▪ Assessment Resources ▪ Phonemic Awareness/Phonics Activities ▪ Leveled Readers Online							
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*Note that while these are the program materials listed with the control program, it is unknown whether control teachers had access to all of these resources whether because they were not purchased initially or because items have been transferred from teacher to teacher and lost over time, etc. In general, however, control teachers had access to the Student Editions, Teacher Edition, and leveled readers/ trade books. In addition, control teachers may have incorporated other program materials (other than the primary program).

Appendix F:

Use of Journeys Resources

Table F1. Percent of Usage of Key Journeys Program Components

	Did not do for any lessons	Rarely (only did for a few of all lessons taught)	Some (did for about 50% of all lessons taught)	Often (did for about 75% of all lessons taught)	All lessons or almost all lessons
Opening Routines:DAY 1	5.5%	6.8%	5.0%	11.4%	71.4%
Teacher Read Aloud:DAY 1	3.2%	4.1%	6.3%	8.6%	77.9%
Words to Know/Vocabulary:DAY 1	0.9%	0.0%	0.0%	6.8%	92.3%
Vocabulary in Context Cards:DAY 1	1.4%	0.0%	0.9%	6.4%	91.3%
Phonemic Awareness/Phonics/Letter Naming (K):DAY 1	9.1%	2.7%	5.0%	17.7%	65.5%
Opening Routines:DAY 2	5.9%	8.2%	5.5%	8.2%	72.3%
Phonemic Awareness/Phonics/Letter Naming (K):DAY 2	9.1%	1.8%	9.6%	19.2%	60.3%
Develop Background:DAY 2	1.4%	0.9%	4.1%	19.0%	74.7%
Comprehension Skills/Strategies:DAY 2	0.9%	0.5%	0.9%	16.8%	80.9%
Main Selection Story:DAY 2	0.9%	0.0%	0.5%	6.4%	92.2%
Develop Comprehension:DAY 2	1.4%	2.3%	3.6%	20.8%	71.9%
Stop and Think:DAY 2	1.4%	2.7%	13.2%	23.7%	58.9%
Your Turn:DAY 2	4.6%	12.8%	34.7%	20.5%	27.4%
Opening Routines:DAY 3	5.9%	8.2%	5.5%	10.9%	69.5%
Phonemic Awareness/Phonics/Letter Naming (K):DAY 3	9.6%	1.4%	8.7%	18.7%	61.6%
Fluency:DAY 3	4.1%	4.1%	15.8%	23.1%	52.9%
Deepen Comprehension:DAY 3	2.3%	5.0%	11.8%	15.5%	65.5%
Opening Routines:DAY 4	5.9%	7.7%	6.8%	9.1%	70.5%
Phonemic Awareness/Phonics/Letter Naming (K):DAY 4	9.6%	1.8%	9.2%	20.2%	59.2%
Paired Selections:DAY 4	3.6%	8.2%	15.9%	23.6%	48.6%
Making Connections:DAY 4	4.5%	7.7%	20.9%	29.5%	37.3%
Vocabulary Strategies:DAY 4	0.9%	1.4%	11.4%	17.3%	69.1%
Opening Routines:DAY 5	7.3%	7.8%	4.6%	11.0%	69.4%
Connect and Extent:DAY 5	19.5%	21.7%	24.9%	18.1%	15.8%
Assessment:DAY 5	5.9%	2.7%	2.3%	6.8%	82.4%
Vocabulary Readers	7.2%	7.7%	16.3%	24.4%	44.3%
Decodable Readers	11.3%	6.8%	16.7%	20.8%	44.3%
Ready Made Workstations:	55.7%	15.4%	9.0%	5.4%	14.5%
Leveled Practice (from Grab & Go)	22.2%	14.0%	16.3%	15.8%	31.7%
Audio books (i.e., listening station)	45.7%	9.5%	10.4%	14.9%	19.5%
Journeys grammar or writing center	46.8%	13.9%	10.2%	12.5%	16.7%

*% reflects reported usage on monthly logs.

Table F2. Percent of Usage of Additional Journeys Program Components

	Percent Used*
Unit Benchmark Assessments	39.4%
Weekly Assessments included in the Grab and Go Kit	88.1%
Running Records included in the Grab and Go Kit	25.7%
Emerging Literacy Survey	1.3%
Diagnostic Assessment	7.1%
Comprehensive Screening Assessment	4.4%
Comprehensive Language and Literacy Guide	8.0%
Journeys Write in Reader	25.7%
Curious About Words	3.5%
Reading Tool Kit	11.5%
Language Support Card	32.3%
ELL Leveled Reader	32.7%
Scaffolded Support	12.4%
Vocabulary in Context Cards	87.2%

* Percent reflects % of teachers reporting use of component at least once (on monthly logs)

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